

Oedipus Rex

Sophocles · -429

Francis Storr translation (1912) as edited by Standard Ebooks (app text)

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

11 scene lessons plus 1 seminar day(s), a test day and an essay day: 16 class days of 90 minutes, 5 a week (block schedule), 3 weeks
Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

Liber et Libri · Lux et Libri LLC
Cover: Caspar David Friedrich, The Monk by the Sea (1808–1810). Public domain (Wikimedia Commons).

Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–11), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Sections follow the Greek structure (prologue, parodos, episodes, stasima, exodos). Line numbers are Storr's English lines, not Greek. Suicide-method lines 1278–1281 are cited by number only; self-blinding lines may be quoted as drama with context.

Grades: Grades 7–12 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). Scaffolded-support track (grade-9 floor): students work from teacher-selected passages with scaffolds, sentence starters and partial-credit probes. **Weeks:** 3. **Class days:** 16 × 90 minutes (11 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does Oedipus Rex suggest about knowledge and blindness?
- What does Oedipus Rex suggest about fate and responsibility?
- What does Oedipus Rex suggest about pride and fall?
- What does Oedipus Rex suggest about leadership and the city?
- What does Oedipus Rex suggest about mercy?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the play in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.
- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the scene quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily scene quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-book test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Scaffolded support through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Scene lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	We do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* Prologue (lines 1–155) Parodos (lines 156–213) Episode 1 (lines 214–479) Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511) Episode 2 (lines 512–880)	6 × 90 min (540 min)	*knowledge and blindness* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
2	Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921) Episode 3 (lines 922–1102) *Socratic seminar on knowledge and blindness* Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114) Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200) Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232) Exodos (lines 1233–1544)	7 × 90 min (630 min)	*fate and responsibility* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on knowledge and blindness • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
3	*Whole-book test (90 minutes)* *Final paper writing workshop (drafting in class; finish the draft as homework)* *Final paper: peer review, revision and submission*	3 × 90 min (270 min)	*pride and fall* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Whole-book test (90 minutes) • Final paper writing workshop (drafting in class; finish the draft as homework) • Final paper: peer review, revision and submission • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Whole-book test and final essay

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to Oedipus Rex

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about Sophocles's life or times connects to knowledge and blindness in “Oedipus Rex”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (knowledge and blindness, fate and responsibility, pride and fall).

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2

Author biography

Sophocles wrote his tragedies for the festivals of Dionysus at Athens in the fifth century B.C.E. An ancient summary of Antigone says he was chosen as one of Athens' generals for the war against Samos in 440 B.C.E.; Jebb treats the tradition with care and takes it to show that Antigone was known before the summer of 441 (Jebb, 1891, Introduction, § 20). He wrote Oedipus at Colonus in his last years, about 406 B.C.E., and it was brought out after his death by his grandson and namesake (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 18). His three Theban plays were not written in story order: Antigone came first and Oedipus at Colonus last (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 18). This app uses Francis Storr's English verse translation (1912) as edited by Standard Ebooks; line numbers are Storr's English lines, not the Greek.

Historical and cultural context

There is no outside record of the first performance. This unit cites the play as ca. 429 B.C.E., the catalog date; the Standard Ebooks colophon gives 430–426 B.C.E., and Jebb places the play after Antigone and before Oedipus at Colonus, roughly 439–412 B.C.E., and says that more than this we cannot say (Jebb, 1893/1902, Introduction, § 15). The Standard Ebooks range assumes a link to the plague that struck Athens in 430; some scholars read the plague of Thebes as that plague and Oedipus as Pericles, a theory Jebb sets aside, granting only that the unburied dead of lines 180–183 may echo what Thucydides records (Jebb, 1893/1902, Introduction, § 15). In Greek belief a killer carried pollution that could harm a whole city, which is why the oracle demands that Laius' killer be driven out. Slavery was legal and common; the herdsman is an enslaved man, and owning people was wrong.

Publication and reception, then and now

The play reached us as one of Sophocles' surviving tragedies. This app uses Francis Storr's 1912 verse translation as edited by Standard Ebooks (Sophocles, ca. 429 B.C.E./2025).

Then: An ancient tradition reported by Jebb says the play did not win first prize: Sophocles was beaten by Philocles, a nephew of Aeschylus (Jebb, 1893/1902, Introduction, § 15). Aristotle's Poetics uses it again and again as his model of tragic form, above all for the reversal brought by the Corinthian messenger (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI; Jebb, 1893/1902, Introduction, § 10).

Now: Later writers kept rewriting it: Corneille's Œdipe was first staged in Paris on 24 January 1659, and Dryden and Lee's Oedipus followed (staged 1678, printed 1679), each adding a love plot (Jebb, 1893/1902, Introduction, §§ 20–22). The original returned to the stage in 1881, in Greek at Harvard in May and in French at the Comédie-Française with Mounet-Sully (Jebb, 1893/1902, Introduction, §§ 29–30).

Overview (spoiler-free)

Thebes is dying of a plague. King Oedipus, who once saved the city by answering the Sphinx's riddle, promises to find the cause. Apollo's oracle says that the killer of the former king, Laius, is living in Thebes and must be driven out, and Oedipus begins a public investigation, cursing the unknown killer and calling on the blind prophet Teiresias.

Main themes

- knowledge and blindness: The seeing king cannot see the truth; the blind prophet Teiresias can (Episode 1).
- fate and responsibility: Oedipus names Apollo as the cause of his ruin and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346), and accepts the guilt as his to bear (lines 1418–1420).
- pride and fall: The Chorus warns that insolence breeds the tyrant (lines 890–893).
- leadership and the city: The play opens with a king answering his suffering people (lines 1–3).
- mercy: Creon does not mock the fallen king and brings his daughters to him (Exodos).

Why it matters

The play asks how much we can know about ourselves, whether we are responsible for what we did not knowingly do, and what a leader owes the people. Aristotle made it the model of tragic form (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI), and its structure, an investigation in which the investigator is the guilty man, is the shape of countless later stories.

Spoilers · teacher only

Oedipus learns that he killed Laius, his father, at the place where three roads meet and married Jocasta, his mother, fulfilling the oracle his parents tried to escape. Jocasta dies offstage (lines 1278–1281 are cited by line number only). Oedipus blinds himself, names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346), and asks to be exiled; Creon takes charge of Thebes and of his daughters.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Before we open Oedipus Rex: which matters more, knowledge and blindness or fate and responsibility? Write for five minutes.
Prompt: Before we open Oedipus Rex: which matters more, knowledge and blindness or fate and responsibility? Write for five minutes.

8–18 min · Key terms · We do (10 min)
Key literary terms for the unit.
Key terms for Oedipus Rex: knowledge and blindness, fate and responsibility, pride and fall, leadership and the city, mercy.

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)

Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).

About the author. Sophocles wrote his tragedies for the festivals of Dionysus at Athens in the fifth century B.C.E. An ancient summary of Antigone says he was chosen as one of Athens' generals for the war against Samos in 440 B.C.E.; Jebb treats the tradition with care and takes it to show that Antigone was known before the summer of 441 (Jebb, 1891, Introduction, § 20). He wrote Oedipus at Colonus in his last years, about 406 B.C.E., and it was brought out after his death by his grandson and namesake (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 18). His three Theban plays were not written in story order: Antigone came first and Oedipus at Colonus last (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 18). This app uses Francis Storr's English verse translation (1912) as edited by Standard Ebooks; line numbers are Storr's English lines, not the Greek. The world of the play. There is no outside record of the first performance. This unit cites the play as ca. 429 B.C.E., the catalog date; the Standard Ebooks colophon gives 430–426 B.C.E., and Jebb places the play after Antigone and before Oedipus at Colonus, roughly 439–412 B.C.E., and says that more than this we cannot say (Jebb, 1893/1902, Introduction, § 15). The Standard Ebooks range assumes a link to the plague that struck Athens in 430; some scholars read the plague of Thebes as that plague and Oedipus as Pericles, a theory Jebb sets aside, granting only that the unburied dead of lines 180–183 may echo what Thucydides records (Jebb, 1893/1902, Introduction, § 15). In Greek belief a killer carried pollution that could harm a whole city, which is why the oracle demands that Laius' killer be driven out. Slavery was legal and common; the herdsman is an enslaved man, and owning people was wrong. Publication and reception. The play reached us as one of Sophocles' surviving tragedies. This app uses Francis Storr's 1912 verse translation as edited by Standard Ebooks (Sophocles, ca. 429 B.C.E./2025). An ancient tradition reported by Jebb says the play did not win first prize: Sophocles was beaten by Philocles, a nephew of Aeschylus (Jebb, 1893/1902, Introduction, § 15). Aristotle's Poetics uses it again and again as his model of tragic form, above all for the reversal brought by the Corinthian messenger (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI; Jebb, 1893/1902, Introduction, § 10). Later writers kept rewriting it: Corneille's Œdipe was first staged in Paris on 24 January 1659, and Dryden and Lee's Oedipus followed (staged 1678, printed 1679), each adding a love plot (Jebb, 1893/1902, Introduction, §§ 20–22). The original returned to the stage in 1881, in Greek at Harvard in May and in French at the Comédie-Française with Mounet-Sully (Jebb, 1893/1902, Introduction, §§ 29–30).

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)
Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines Oedipus speaks at a turning point of the section, which is about a king who promises to find the truth. Next, craft. I notice how the lines use characterization, irony to make the audience feel the pressure of the moment on Oedipus. The strongest word is "suppliants": the word "suppliants" carries the weight of the lines and points to the section's big idea. Then, effect. What do lines 1–3 reveal about a king who promises to find the truth? My answer: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. These lines show a king who promises to find the truth, and that matters for what follows in the play.

> *My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool* (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines Oedipus speaks at a turning point of the section, which is about a king who promises to find the truth. Next, craft. I notice how the lines use characterization, irony to make the audience feel the pressure of the moment on Oedipus. The strongest word is "suppliants": the word "suppliants" carries the weight of the lines and points to the section's big idea. Then, effect. What do lines 1–3 reveal about a king who promises to find the truth? My answer: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. These lines show a king who promises to find the truth, and that matters for what follows in the play.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): Thebes is dying of a plague, and King Oedipus, who once saved the city by answering the Sphinx's riddle, promises to find the cause. The oracle says the killer of the former king, Laius, must be driven out, and Oedipus sets out to find him. Themes to track: knowledge and blindness: fate and responsibility: pride and fall: leadership and the city: mercy:

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Theme page, knowledge and blindness: my prediction is that the play will test this idea against a hard choice, and my question is whether anyone in it can see the whole truth before it is too late to act on it.
Task: Set up a reading journal for Oedipus Rex: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Theme page, knowledge and blindness: my prediction is that the play will test this idea against a hard choice, and my question is whether anyone in it can see the whole truth before it is too late to act on it.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
Why does Oedipus Rex still matter? The play asks how much we can know about ourselves, whether we are responsible for what we did not knowingly do, and what a leader owes the people. Its detective structure has shaped tragedy, psychology and crime fiction ever since.
Anchor question: Why might Oedipus Rex still be taught today?
Facilitation: The play asks how much we can know about ourselves, whether we are responsible for what we did not knowingly do, and what a leader owes the people. Its detective structure has shaped tragedy, psychology and crime fiction ever since.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
Sophocles staged Oedipus Rex in Athens around the time of the plague at Athens during the Peloponnesian War. How might an audience living through a plague in Athens hear the play's opening lines? Answer: Accept answers such as: they would recognise the dying city and the people begging their leader for help, so the play's questions about blame and leadership would feel urgent rather than distant.
Exit ticket: Sophocles staged Oedipus Rex in Athens around the time of the plague at Athens during the Peloponnesian War. How might an audience living through a plague in Athens hear the play's opening lines?
Answer: Accept answers such as: they would recognise the dying city and the people begging their leader for help, so the play's questions about blame and leadership would feel urgent rather than distant.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Preview the first reading.
Tomorrow we begin reading: Prologue (lines 1–155).

Teacher notes · sources: Jebb, R. C. (1902). Sophocles: The plays and fragments, with critical notes, commentary, and translation in English prose: Part I. The Oedipus Tyrannus (3rd ed., reprinted). Cambridge University Press. https://archive.org/details/playsfragmentspa0000unse_i8p4 (Original work published 1893) (https://archive.org/details/playsfragmentspa0000unse_i8p4); Aristotle. (1999). Poetics (S. H. Butcher, Trans.). Project Gutenberg. https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/1974 (Original work written ca. 335 B.C.E.) (https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/1974); Sophocles. (2025). Oedipus Rex (F. Storr, Trans.). Standard Ebooks. https://standardebooks.org/ebooks/sophocles/oedipus-rex/francis-storr (Original work performed ca. 429 B.C.E.; translation published 1912) (https://standardebooks.org/ebooks/sophocles/oedipus-rex/francis-storr)

Flags (verify before teaching):

- The date is uncertain: this unit cites ca. 429 B.C.E. (catalog date); the Standard Ebooks colophon gives 430–426 B.C.E.; Jebb gives only roughly 439–412 B.C.E.
- The defeat by Philocles is an ancient tradition, not a record.

Lesson 2: Prologue (lines 1–155)

Focus: a king who promises to find the truth

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “Prologue (lines 1–155)” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together.

Background: There is no outside record of the first performance; the Standard Ebooks edition dates it to about 429 B.C.E. (Sophocles, ca. 429 B.C.E./2025). Jebb reports the modern theory that the plague of Thebes reflects the Athenian plague of 430 B.C.E. and sets it aside (Jebb, 1893/1902, Introduction, § 15). Storr's line numbers are English lines, not Greek.

Significance: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Is a leader responsible for problems he did not knowingly cause? Why or why not? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to knowledge and blindness because....*
> **Prompt:** Is a leader responsible for problems he did not knowingly cause? Why or why not?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to knowledge and blindness because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: a king who promises to find the truth.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)**
> Two key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: surmise — a guess made without proof; suppliant — a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar.*
> **Words:** surmise: a guess made without proof · suppliant: a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
There is no outside record of the first performance; the Standard Ebooks edition dates it to about 429 B.C.E. (Sophocles, ca. 429 B.C.E./2025). Jebb reports the modern theory that the plague of Thebes reflects the Athenian plague of 430 B.C.E. and sets it aside (Jebb, 1893/1902, Introduction, § 15). Storr's line numbers are English lines, not Greek. The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. Look closely: Ask students to track every question Oedipus asks: the play is built as an investigation, and the investigator is the man he is looking for.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool?" slowly and put it in my own words: The king asks the young people of Thebes, descendants of the city's founder Cadmus, why they sit before him holding olive branches wrapped in wool, the sign of people begging for help. Next, craft. I notice the man famous for answering the Sphinx's riddle opens the play by asking a question, and he speaks to his people as a father to his children. The strongest word is "children": Oedipus speaks as the father of his city, yet he does not know who his own father is. Then, effect. Why does Oedipus call the suppliants his children? My answer: Oedipus calls the suppliants his children because he sees himself as the protecting father of Thebes; the audience, who knows the myth, hears the irony that this father has never known his own parents.

> *My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool?* *(Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool?" slowly and put it in my own words: The king asks the young people of Thebes, descendants of the city's founder Cadmus, why they sit before him holding olive branches wrapped in wool, the sign of people begging for help. Next, craft. I notice the man famous for answering the Sphinx's riddle opens the play by asking a question, and he speaks to his people as a father to his children. The strongest word is "children": Oedipus speaks as the father of his city, yet he does not know who his own father is. Then, effect. Why does Oedipus call the suppliants his children? My answer: Oedipus calls the suppliants his children because he sees himself as the protecting father of Thebes; the audience, who knows the myth, hears the irony that this father has never known his own parents.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: There is no outside record of the first performance; the Standard Ebooks edition dates it to about 429 B.C.E. (Sophocles, ca. 429 B.C.E./2025). Jebb reports the modern theory that the plague of Thebes reflects the Athenian plague of 430 B.C.E. and sets it aside (Jebb, 1893/1902, Introduction, § 15). Storr's line numbers are English lines, not Greek. Read closely: "Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, If men to man and guards to guard them fail." (Priest, lines 62–63). Ask: How does this line connect to knowledge and blindness? Expected: A king who promises to find the truth. (Priest, lines 62–63.)

> *Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and guards to guard them fail* *(Prologue (lines 1–155), Priest)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: There is no outside record of the first performance; the Standard Ebooks edition dates it to about 429 B.C.E. (Sophocles, ca. 429 B.C.E./2025). Jebb reports the modern theory that the plague of Thebes reflects the Athenian plague of 430 B.C.E. and sets it aside (Jebb, 1893/1902, Introduction, § 15). Storr's line numbers are English lines, not Greek. Read closely: "Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, If men to man and guards to guard them fail." (Priest, lines 62–63).
Ask: How does this line connect to knowledge and blindness?
Expected answer: A king who promises to find the truth. (Priest, lines 62–63.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about a king who promises to find the truth? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Prologue (lines 1–155) develops the idea of a king who promises to find the truth. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. When the text says "Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus), it shows this directly. Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together.

Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about a king who promises to find the truth? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Prologue (lines 1–155) develops the idea of a king who promises to find the truth. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. When the text says "Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus), it shows this directly. Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Is a leader responsible for problems he did not knowingly cause? Why or why not? Ask: Is a leader responsible for problems he did not knowingly cause? Why or why not?

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Facilitation: Ask: Is a leader responsible for problems he did not knowingly cause? Why or why not?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about a king who promises to find the truth? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. ("Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear", Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about a king who promises to find the truth? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. ("Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear", Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes a king who promises to find the truth. Key takeaway: a king who promises to find the truth.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together.
- **Irony:** Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together.
- **Setting:** Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together.

Themes and how they develop

- **knowledge and blindness:** a king who promises to find the truth.

Symbols and motifs

- **sight and blindness:** The section adds to the play's pattern of sight and blindness: a king who promises to find the truth.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 1–3.
- "Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and guards to guard them fail" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Priest) Priest, lines 62–63.
- "In this land, said the god; "who seeks shall find; / Who sits with folded hands or sleeps is blind" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Creon) Creon, lines 116–117.
- "Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 138–139.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony.
Evidence: "Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus)
Reasoning: Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Line 1
1 **Oedipus:** My children, latest born to Cadmus old,

Lines 1–3
1 **Oedipus:** My children, latest born to Cadmus old,
2 **Oedipus:** Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands
3 **Oedipus:** Branches of olive filleted with wool?

Lines 62–63
62 **Priest:** Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail,
63 **Priest:** If men to man and guards to guard them fail.

Lines 64–83
64 **Oedipus:** Ah! my poor children, known, ah, known too well,
65 **Oedipus:** The quest that brings you hither and your need.
66 **Oedipus:** Ye sicken all, well wot I, yet my pain,
67 **Oedipus:** How great soever yours, outtops it all.
68 **Oedipus:** Your sorrow touches each man severally,
69 **Oedipus:** Him and none other, but I grieve at once
70 **Oedipus:** Both for the general and myself and you.
71 **Oedipus:** Therefore ye rouse no sluggard from day-dreams.
72 **Oedipus:** Many, my children, are the tears I've wept,
73 **Oedipus:** And threaded many a maze of weary thought.
74 **Oedipus:** Thus pondering one clue of hope I caught,

75 **Oedipus:** And tracked it up; I have sent Menoeceus' son,
76 **Oedipus:** Creon, my consort's brother, to inquire
77 **Oedipus:** Of Pythian Phoebus at his Delphic shrine,
78 **Oedipus:** How I might save the State by act or word.
79 **Oedipus:** And now I reckon up the tale of days
80 **Oedipus:** Since he set forth, and marvel how he fares.
81 **Oedipus:** 'Tis strange, this endless tarrying, passing strange.
82 **Oedipus:** But when he comes, then I were base indeed,
83 **Oedipus:** If I perform not all the god declares.

Lines 66–67
66 **Oedipus:** Ye sicken all, well wot I, yet my pain,
67 **Oedipus:** How great soever yours, outtops it all.

Lines 84–85
84 **Priest:** Thy words are well timed; even as thou speakest
85 **Priest:** That shouting tells me Creon is at hand.

Lines 91–92
91 **Oedipus:** My royal cousin, say, Menoeceus' child,
92 **Oedipus:** What message hast thou brought us from the god?

Lines 93–94
93 **Creon:** Good news, for e'en intolerable ills,
94 **Creon:** Finding right issue, tend to naught but good.

Lines 97–98
97 **Creon:** If thou wouldst hear my message publicly,
98 **Creon:** I'll tell thee straight, or with thee pass within.

Lines 102–104
102 **Creon:** King Phoebus bids us straitly extirpate
103 **Creon:** A fell pollution that infests the land,
104 **Creon:** And no more harbour an inveterate sore.

Lines 106–107
106 **Creon:** Banishment, or the shedding blood for blood.
107 **Creon:** This stain of blood makes shipwreck of our state.

Line 107
107 **Creon:** This stain of blood makes shipwreck of our state.

Lines 116–117
116 **Creon:** In this land, said the god; "who seeks shall find;
117 **Creon:** Who sits with folded hands or sleeps is blind."

Lines 118–119
118 **Oedipus:** Was he within his palace, or afield,
119 **Oedipus:** Or traveling, when Laius met his fate?

Lines 130–131
130 **Oedipus:** Did any bandit dare so bold a stroke,
131 **Oedipus:** Unless indeed he were suborned from Thebes?

Lines 138–139
138 **Oedipus:** Well, I will start afresh and once again
139 **Oedipus:** Make dark things clear. Right worthy the concern

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
surmise (verb)	a guess made without proof	*As I surmise, 'tis welcome; else his head Had scarce been crowned with berry-laden bays.*	
suppliant (noun)	a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar	*Up, children, haste ye, quit these altar stairs, Take hence your suppliant wands, go summon hither The Theban commons.*	

Discussion questions

1. Is a leader responsible for problems he did not knowingly cause? Why or why not?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with knowledge and blindness?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Oedipus promise in lines 138–139? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To start afresh and "make dark things clear."
2. What is destroying Thebes at the start of the play? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A plague
3. Why do the people trust Oedipus to help? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He once freed the city from the Sphinx

4. Where has Creon been? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: At the oracle of Apollo at Delphi
5. What does the god say Thebes must do? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Banish or punish the killer of Laius
6. Why is "who seeks shall find" ironic? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Oedipus will find that he himself is the man he seeks
7. Retell the three most important events of “Prologue (lines 1–155)” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together.
8. Who is on stage in “Prologue (lines 1–155)”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Prologue (lines 1–155)” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “As I surmise, ’tis welcome; else his head Had scarce been crowned with berry-laden bays.” What does “surmise” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: surmise: a guess made without proof.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the Priest say walls and ships are useless without men (lines 62–63)? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A city is its people; Oedipus must act as a leader, not rely on defences.
2. What does “Prologue (lines 1–155)” suggest about a king who promises to find the truth? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the irony in this scene shape what we understand about a king who promises to find the truth? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. Useful evidence: “My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus):

Oedipus, lines 1–3. On irony: Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “My children, latest born to Cadmus old, Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands Branches of olive filleted with wool?”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Prologue (lines 1–155)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people…
7. As the opening scene, what does “Prologue (lines 1–155)” set up that the rest of Oedipus Rex will need? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. Useful evidence: “Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and guards to guard them fail” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Priest): Priest, lines 62–63. Theme link: a king who promises to find the truth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. Useful evidence: “In this land, said the god; “who seeks shall find; / Who sits with folded hands or sleeps is blind.”” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Creon): Creon, lines 116–117. On characterization: Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is a leader responsible for problems he did not knowingly cause? Why or why not?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does setting appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with knowledge and blindness? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more,

and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. Useful evidence: “Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 138–139. On setting: Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Oedipus a good king in the Prologue? Take a position using two quoted lines. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position citing evidence such as lines 1–3 and 138–139.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. Useful evidence: “My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1–3. Theme link: a king who promises to find the truth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. Useful evidence: “Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and guards to guard them fail” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Priest): Priest, lines 62–63. Theme link: a king who promises to find the truth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. Useful evidence: “In this land, said the god; “who seeks shall find; / Who sits with folded hands or sleeps is blind.”” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Creon): Creon, lines 116–117. On characterization: Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Prologue (lines 1–155)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of a king who promises to find the truth.

[DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. Useful evidence: “Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 138–139. Theme link: a king who promises to find the truth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Prologue (lines 1–155)”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. Useful evidence: “My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1–3. Theme link: a king who promises to find the truth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate and responsibility: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. Useful evidence: “Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and guards to guard them fail” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Priest): Priest, lines 62–63. Theme link: a king who promises to find the truth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. Useful evidence: “In this land, said the god; “who seeks shall find; / Who sits with folded hands or sleeps is blind.’” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Creon): Creon, lines 116–117. On characterization: Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Prologue (lines 1–155)” treats a king who promises to find the truth with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus Rex see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. Useful evidence: "Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 138–139. Theme link: a king who promises to find the truth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Parodos (lines 156–213)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. Useful evidence: "My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1–3. Theme link: a king who promises to find the truth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a king who promises to find the truth? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. Useful evidence: "Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and guards to guard them fail" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Priest): Priest, lines 62–63. Theme link: a king who promises to find the truth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why do the people trust Oedipus to help?

   A. He once freed the city from the Sphinx

   B. He is a priest of Apollo

   C. He is a famous general

   D. He is Creon's son

   Key: A (He once freed the city from the Sphinx)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "As I _____, 'tis welcome; else his head Had scarce been crowned with berry-laden bays." Word bank: suppliant, surmise

   Key: surmise

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus: "My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as _____, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool"

   Key: suppliants

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Up, children, haste ye, quit these altar stairs, Take hence your _____ wands, go summon hither The Theban commons."

   Word bank: surmise, suppliant

   Key: suppliant

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Prologue (lines 1–155), Creon: "In this land, said the god; 'who seeks shall find; / Who sits with _____ hands or sleeps is blind.'"

   Key: folded

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is destroying Thebes at the start of the play?

   A. A famine caused by war
   B. A foreign army
   C. A flood
   D. A plague

   Key: D (A plague)

7. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Oedipus promise in lines 138–139?

   Sample answer: To start afresh and "make dark things clear."

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus: "Well, I will start _____ and once again / Make dark things clear"

   Key: afresh

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where has Creon been?

   A. In Corinth
   B. At the Sphinx's rock
   C. On Mount Cithaeron
   D. At the oracle of Apollo at Delphi

   Key: D (At the oracle of Apollo at Delphi)

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the god say Thebes must do?

    A. Banish or punish the killer of Laius
    B. Crown Creon king
    C. Sacrifice to Athena
    D. Rebuild its walls

    Key: A (Banish or punish the killer of Laius)

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "As I surmise, 'tis welcome; else his head Had scarce been crowned with berry-laden bays.", what does "surmise" most nearly mean?

    A. knowledge of something before it happens
    B. a guess made without proof
    C. rude, arrogant disrespect; Storr's word for Greek hybris
    D. the killing of one's father, or the person who does it

Key: B (a guess made without proof)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and guards to guard them fail” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Priest) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Priest, lines 62–63. The evidence is “Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and guards to guard them fail” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Priest). This develops knowledge and blindness: a king who promises to find the truth.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the Priest say walls and ships are useless without men (lines 62–63)?

    Sample answer: A city is its people; Oedipus must act as a leader, not rely on defences. The evidence is “My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1–3.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus).

    Sample answer: Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together. The evidence is “Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 138–139. This develops knowledge and blindness: a king who promises to find the truth.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? A king who promises to find the truth.

    A. Knowledge and blindness
    B. Fate and responsibility
    C. Leadership and the city
    D. Pride and fall

    Key: A (Knowledge and blindness)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Oedipus a good king in the Prologue? Take a position using two quoted lines.

    Sample answer: A defended position citing evidence such as lines 1–3 and 138–139. The evidence is “My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1–3. This develops knowledge and blindness: a king who promises to find the truth. Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why is "who seeks shall find" ironic?

    A. Oedipus will find that he himself is the man he seeks
    B. The Priest already knows the killer
    C. The god refuses to answer
    D. Creon is lying about the oracle

    Key: A (Oedipus will find that he himself is the man he seeks)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Prologue (lines 1–155), lines 91–92: "My royal cousin, say, Menoeceus' child, What _____ hast thou brought us from the god?" Word bank: children, foretold, message, delivered

    Key: message

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Prologue (lines 1–155), stage direction before line 1? "Arriving at Thebes he answered the riddle of the Sphinx and the grateful Thebans made their _____ king."

    A. deliverer

    B. parentage

    C. pondering

    D. delivered

    Key: A (deliverer)

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Prologue (lines 1–155), line 107 reveal about the character or situation? "This stain of blood makes shipwreck of our state." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Prologue (lines 1–155), line 107) shows the situation turning on knowledge and blindness: the story keeps returning to knowledge and blindness. The words "shipwreck" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

21. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Prologue (lines 1–155), stage direction before line 1 reveal about the character or situation? "Again the oracle was consulted and it bade them purge themselves of blood-guiltiness." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Prologue (lines 1–155), stage direction before line 1) shows the situation turning on knowledge and blindness: the story keeps returning to knowledge and blindness. The words "themselves" and "guiltiness" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Prologue (lines 1–155), stage direction before line 1 shapes its tone: "So when in time a son was born the infant's feet were riveted together and he was left to die on Mount Cithaeron." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "together" and "riveted" (Prologue (lines 1–155), stage direction before line 1) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to leadership and the city: the story keeps returning to leadership and the city. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Prologue (lines 1–155), lines 118–119 shapes its tone: "Was he within his palace, or afield, Or traveling, when Laius met his fate?" Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "traveling" and "afield" (Prologue (lines 1–155), lines 118–119) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to leadership and the city: the story keeps returning to leadership and the city. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Prologue (lines 1–155), lines 93–94 to the story's treatment of pride and fall: "Good news, for e'en intolerable ills, Finding right issue, tend to naught but good." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Prologue (lines 1–155), lines 93–94) develops pride and fall: the story keeps returning to pride and fall. Its words "intolerable" and "naught" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "If thou wouldst

hear my message publicly, I'll tell thee straight, or with thee pass within." (Prologue (lines 1–155), lines 93–94), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating pride and fall as central.

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Prologue (lines 1–155), lines 64–83? "Thus _____ one clue of hope I caught, And tracked it up; I have sent Menoeceus' son, Creon, my consort's brother, to inquire Of Pythian Phoebus at his Delphic shrine, How I might save the State by act or word."

    A. delivered

    B. pondering

    C. inveterate

    D. prospered

    Key: B (pondering)

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Prologue (lines 1–155), lines 102–104? "King Phoebus bids us straitly extirpate A fell pollution that infests the land, And no more harbour an _____ sore."

    A. foretold

    B. prospered

    C. inveterate

    D. children

    Key: C (inveterate)

27. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Prologue (lines 1–155), Priest: "Nor _____ nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and guards to guard them fail"

    Key: battlements

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Prologue (lines 1–155), lines 130–131 shapes its tone: "Did any bandit dare so bold a stroke, Unless indeed he were suborned from Thebes?" Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "suborned" and "stroke" (Prologue (lines 1–155), lines 130–131) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and responsibility: the story keeps returning to fate and responsibility. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: "The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. "Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus) supports it: Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together. But "Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and guards to guard them fail" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Priest) complicates it: the line (Priest, lines 62–63) shows the same issue from another side, and its "Nor" marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. So the claim stands only in a qualified form: true of the scene's main pattern, but not of every moment in it.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Prologue (lines 1–155), stage direction before line 1 shapes its tone: "Suppliants of all ages are seated round the altar at the palace doors, at their head a Priest of Zeus." Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “seated” and “palace” (Prologue (lines 1–155), stage direction before line 1) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and responsibility: the story keeps returning to fate and responsibility. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Prologue (lines 1–155), lines 66–67 to the story's treatment of mercy: “Ye sicken all, well wot I, yet my pain, How great soever yours, outtops it all.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Prologue (lines 1–155), lines 66–67) develops mercy: the story keeps returning to mercy. Its words “outtops” and “soever” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Thy words are well timed; even as thou speakest That shouting tells me Creon is at hand.” (Prologue (lines 1–155), lines 66–67), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating mercy as central.
32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and guards to guard them fail” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Priest) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Priest, lines 62–63. The evidence is “Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and guards to guard them fail” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Priest). This develops knowledge and blindness: a king who promises to find the truth. The words “battlements” and “galleys” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together.
33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how knowledge and blindness develops from the opening of “Prologue (lines 1–155)” to its ending. Use one quotation from each part.
    Sample answer: Near the start, “My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1–3. Later, “Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 138–139. A king who promises to find the truth.
34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Prologue (lines 1–155)”? Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus…

    A. Tone / mood
    B. Characterization
    C. Imagery
    D. Theme

    Key: B (Characterization)
35. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “In this land, said the god; ‘who seeks shall find; / Who sits with folded hands or sleeps is blind.’” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Creon). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Creon, lines 116–117. The evidence is “In this land, said the god; ‘who seeks shall find; / Who sits with folded hands or sleeps is blind.’” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Creon). This develops knowledge and blindness: a king who promises to find the truth. The words “folded” and “sleeps” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.
36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive

filleted with wool" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1–3. The evidence is "My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus). This develops knowledge and blindness: a king who promises to find the truth. The words "suppliants" and "children" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together.

37. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Which choice best states a central concern of "Prologue (lines 1–155)"?

    A. A hopeful guess

    B. Good news that is not good

    C. A king who promises to find the truth

    D. Pride breeds the tyrant

    Key: C (A king who promises to find the truth)

38. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] What can you infer from this line? "My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1–3. The evidence is "My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus).

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	6, 5, 17, 18, 11, 3, 19, 7, 12, 20, 13, 21, 14, 22, 23, 24	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	11, 8, 25, 26, 10, 7, 27, 12, 20, 21, 13, 14, 23, 28, 29, 16	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	17, 6, 1, 18, 3, 26, 8, 13, 20, 21, 30, 28, 22, 14, 31, 32	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	2, 6, 27, 10, 11, 21, 12, 20, 13, 28, 15, 30, 14, 29, 33, 31	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	2, 11, 1, 27, 6, 20, 13, 34, 23, 35, 22, 14, 36, 24, 31, 29	recall 5, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	9, 25, 17, 2, 4, 21, 13, 30, 14, 22, 23, 15, 33, 24, 29, 16	recall 5, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	4, 17, 2, 6, 1, 9, 23, 28, 22, 14, 16, 36, 24, 31, 33, 32	recall 6, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 6
College Junior	27, 19, 2, 6, 37, 15, 22, 23, 28, 14, 30, 36, 31, 24, 16, 29	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 6, synthesis 5
College Senior	19, 2, 4, 6, 1, 23, 15, 22, 14, 28, 24, 16, 31, 36, 33, 29	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 6
Graduate / PhD	19, 2, 4, 6, 1, 38, 28, 23, 22, 15, 14, 16, 33, 24, 29, 31	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Prologue (lines 1–155)," how does Sophocles show a king who promises to

find the truth? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In Prologue (lines 1–155), how does Sophocles develop the idea of a king who promises to find the truth? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Prologue (lines 1–155) develops the idea of a king who promises to find the truth. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Prologue (lines 1–155) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of a king who promises to find the truth. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Prologue (lines 1–155) suggests about a king who promises to find the truth. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses characterization in Prologue (lines 1–155) to complicate the reader's understanding of a king who promises to find the truth. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Situate Prologue (lines 1–155) within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of a king who promises to find the truth responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Read Prologue (lines 1–155) alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of a king who promises to find the truth follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Prologue (lines 1–155) and its treatment of a king who promises to find the truth. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop a research argument that reads Prologue (lines 1–155) as evidence for a larger claim about a king who promises to find the truth in Oedipus Rex. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop an original argument that reads Prologue (lines 1–155) as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of a king who promises to find the truth. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Oedipus Rex.

SAT-style questions

1. *My children, latest born to Cadmus old, Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands Branches of olive filleted with wool? What means this reek of incense everywhere, And everywhere laments and litanies? Children, it were not meet that I should learn From others, and am hither come, myself, I Oedipus, your world-renownèd king. Ho! aged sire, whose venerable locks Proclaim thee spokesman of this company, Explain your mood and purport. Is it dread Of ill that moves you or a boon ye crave? My zeal in your behalf ye cannot doubt; Ruthless indeed were I and obdurate If such petitioners as you I spurned.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Prologue (lines 1–155)"?

   A. Pride breeds the tyrant

   B. A king who promises to find the truth

   C. Good news that is not good

   D. A hopeful guess

SAT key: 1. B (A king who promises to find the truth)

Lesson 3: Parodos (lines 156–213)

Focus: a city praying for rescue

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in "Parodos (lines 156–213)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athena, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away.

Background: The Chorus sang and danced in the orchestra. Its songs divide the play into episodes; this first entrance song is the parodos.

Significance: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead link this play to Antigone, where burial is the central conflict.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *How does a whole community react when it is afraid? Give a modern example. Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to knowledge and blindness because....*
> **Prompt:** How does a whole community react when it is afraid? Give a modern example.
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to knowledge and blindness because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: a city praying for rescue.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)**
> One key word in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: infection — the spread of disease. "infection": Origin: Old French infection; earlier Late Latin īnfectiō.*
> **Words:** infection: the spread of disease

> **18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
> Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
> *The Chorus sang and danced in the orchestra. Its songs divide the play into episodes; this first entrance song is the parodos. The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead link this play to Antigone, where burial is the central conflict. Look closely: Jebb notes that Thucydides also records the unburied dead of the Athenian plague of 430 B.C.E., the one detail he allows may reflect real experience (Jebb, 1893/1902, Introduction, § 15).*

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found." slowly and put it in my own words: The elders say the city is dying one death after another; bodies lie in the open spreading disease, and no one is left to care for them or mourn them. Next, craft. I notice short rhymed lines (death and perisheth, round and found) and the doubling in death on death make the song sound like a chant of grief. The strongest word is "mourn": for Greeks the dead were owed mourning and burial, so its absence is a sign that the city has broken down. Then, effect. Why do the elders stress that no one is left to mourn the dead? My answer: The elders stress the missing mourners because unmourned dead show a city that can no longer do its basic duty to its own people; the same duty to the dead drives the conflict of Antigone.

> *Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found.* *(Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found." slowly and put it in my own words: The elders say the city is dying one death after another; bodies lie in the open spreading disease, and no one is left to care for them or mourn them. Next, craft. I notice short rhymed lines (death and perisheth, round and found) and the doubling in death on death make the song sound like a chant of grief. The strongest word is "mourn": for Greeks the dead were owed mourning and burial, so its absence is a sign that the city has broken down. Then, effect. Why do the elders stress that no one is left to mourn the dead? My answer: The elders stress the missing mourners because unmourned dead show a city that can no longer do its basic duty to its own people; the same duty to the dead drives the conflict of Antigone.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The Chorus sang and danced in the orchestra. Its songs divide the play into episodes; this first entrance song is the parodos. Read closely: "Wailing on the altar stair Wives and grandams rend the air— Long-drawn moans and piercing cries Blent with prayers and litanies." (Chorus, lines 184–187). Ask: How does this line connect to knowledge and blindness? Expected: A city praying for rescue. (Chorus, lines 184–187.)

> *Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air— / Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers and litanies* *(Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The Chorus sang and danced in the orchestra. Its songs divide the play into episodes; this first entrance song is the parodos. Read closely: "Wailing on the altar stair Wives and grandams rend the air— Long-drawn moans and piercing cries Blent with prayers and litanies." (Chorus, lines 184–187).
Ask: How does this line connect to knowledge and blindness?
Expected answer: A city praying for rescue. (Chorus, lines 184–187.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for imagery, tone / mood (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about a city praying for rescue? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Parodos (lines 156–213) develops the idea of a city praying for rescue. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead link this play to Antigone, where burial is the central conflict. When the text says "Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found" (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus), it shows this directly. The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athena, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away.

Task: Annotate the scene for imagery, tone / mood (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about a city praying for rescue? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Parodos (lines 156–213) develops the idea of a city praying for rescue. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead link this play to Antigone, where burial is the central conflict. When the text says "Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found" (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus), it shows this directly. The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athena, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: How does a whole community react when it is afraid? Give a modern example. Ask: How does a whole community react when it is afraid? Give a modern example.

Anchor question: How does a whole community react when it is afraid? Give a modern example.

Facilitation: Ask: How does a whole community react when it is afraid? Give a modern example.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about a city praying for rescue? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead link this play to Antigone, where burial is the central conflict. ("Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found", Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about a city praying for rescue? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead link this play to Antigone, where burial is the central conflict. ("Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found", Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how imagery shapes a city praying for rescue. Key takeaway: a city praying for rescue.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Imagery:** The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athena, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away.
- **Tone / mood:** The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athena, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away.
- **Structure:** The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athena, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away.

Themes and how they develop

- **knowledge and blindness:** a city praying for rescue.

Symbols and motifs

- **sight and blindness:** The section adds to the play's pattern of sight and blindness: a city praying for rescue.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found" (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus) Chorus, lines 180–183.
- "Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air— / Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers and litanies" (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus) Chorus, lines 184–187.
- "Sweet-voiced daughter of Zeus from thy gold-paved Pythian shrine / Wafted to Thebes divine" (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus) Chorus, in this part of the section.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead link this play to Antigone, where burial is the central conflict.
Evidence: "Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found" (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus)
Reasoning: The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athena, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 1–3

1 **Oedipus:** My children, latest born to Cadmus old,
2 **Oedipus:** Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands
3 **Oedipus:** Branches of olive filleted with wool?

Lines 156–213

156 **Chorus:** Sweet-voiced daughter of Zeus from thy gold-paved Pythian shrine
157 **Chorus:** Wafted to Thebes divine,
158 **Chorus:** What dost thou bring me? My soul is racked and shivers with fear.
159 **Chorus:** (Healer of Delos, hear!)
160 **Chorus:** Hast thou some pain unknown before,
161 **Chorus:** Or with the circling years renewest a penance of yore?
162 **Chorus:** Offspring of golden Hope, thou voice immortal, O tell me.
163 **Chorus:** First on Athenè I call; O Zeus-born goddess, defend!
164 **Chorus:** Goddess and sister, befriend,
165 **Chorus:** Artemis, Lady of Thebes, high-throned in the midst of our mart!
166 **Chorus:** Lord of the death-winged dart!
167 **Chorus:** Your threefold aid I crave
168 **Chorus:** From death and ruin our city to save.
169 **Chorus:** If in the days of old when we nigh had perished, ye drave
170 **Chorus:** From our land the fiery plague, be near us now and defend us!
171 **Chorus:** Ah me, what countless woes are mine!
172 **Chorus:** All our host is in decline;
173 **Chorus:** Weaponless my spirit lies.

Chorus: Earth her gracious fruits denies;
Chorus: Women wail in barren throes;
Chorus: Life on life downstriken goes,
Chorus: Swifter than the wind bird's flight,
Chorus: Swifter than the Fire-God's might,
Chorus: To the westering shores of Night.
Chorus: Wasted thus by death on death
Chorus: All our city perisheth.
Chorus: Corpses spread infection round;
Chorus: None to tend or mourn is found.
Chorus: Wailing on the altar stair
Chorus: Wives and grandams rend the air—
Chorus: Long-drawn moans and piercing cries
Chorus: Blent with prayers and litanies.
Chorus: Golden child of Zeus, O hear
Chorus: Let thine angel face appear!
Chorus: And grant that Ares whose hot breath I feel,
Chorus: Though without targe or steel
Chorus: He stalks, whose voice is as the battle shout,
Chorus: May turn in sudden rout,
Chorus: To the unharboured Thracian waters sped,
Chorus: Or Amphitrite's bed.
Chorus: For what night leaves undone,
Chorus: Smit by the morrow's sun
Chorus: Perisheth. Father Zeus, whose hand
Chorus: Doth wield the lightning brand,
Chorus: Slay him beneath thy levin bold, we pray,
Chorus: Slay him, O slay!
Chorus: O that thine arrows too, Lycean King,
Chorus: From that taut bow's gold string,
Chorus: Might fly abroad, the champions of our rights;
Chorus: Yea, and the flashing lights
Chorus: Of Artemis, wherewith the huntress sweeps
Chorus: Across the Lycian steeps.
Chorus: Thee too I call with golden-snooded hair,
Chorus: Whose name our land doth bear,
Chorus: Bacchus to whom thy Maenads Evoē shout;
Chorus: Come with thy bright torch, rout,
Chorus: Blithe god whom we adore,
Chorus: The god whom gods abhor.

Lines 158–161

Chorus: What dost thou bring me? My soul is racked and shivers with fear.
Chorus: (Healer of Delos, hear!)

160 **Chorus:** Hast thou some pain unknown before,
161 **Chorus:** Or with the circling years renewest a penance of yore?

Lines 169–170
169 **Chorus:** If in the days of old when we nigh had perished, ye drave
170 **Chorus:** From our land the fiery plague, be near us now and defend us!

Lines 180–183
180 **Chorus:** Wasted thus by death on death
181 **Chorus:** All our city perisheth.
182 **Chorus:** Corpses spread infection round;
183 **Chorus:** None to tend or mourn is found.

Lines 184–187
184 **Chorus:** Wailing on the altar stair
185 **Chorus:** Wives and grandams rend the air—
186 **Chorus:** Long-drawn moans and piercing cries
187 **Chorus:** Blent with prayers and litanies.

Lines 196–198
196 **Chorus:** For what night leaves undone,
197 **Chorus:** Smit by the morrow's sun
198 **Chorus:** Perisheth. Father Zeus, whose hand

Lines 1237–1240
1237 **Second Messenger:** Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween,
1238 **Second Messenger:** Could wash away the blood-stains from this house,
1239 **Second Messenger:** The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light,
1240 **Second Messenger:** Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
infection (noun)	the spread of disease	*Corpses spread infection round; None to tend or mourn is found.*	"infection": Origin: Old French infection; earlier Late Latin īnfectiō. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/infection#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. How does a whole community react when it is afraid? Give a modern example.
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and responsibility?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does "None to tend or mourn is found" tell us about the city? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: So many have died that no one is left to care for the dead.
2. Who are the Chorus in this play? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Elders of Thebes
3. What do the Chorus describe in lines 180–183? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The dead lying untended and spreading infection
4. Whom do the elders pray to? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Gods such as Athena, Artemis and Apollo
5. What is the mood of the Parodos? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Fearful and pleading
6. What is a parodos? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Chorus's entrance song
7. Retell the three most important events of “Parodos (lines 156–213)” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athena, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away.
8. Who is on stage in “Parodos (lines 156–213)”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Parodos (lines 156–213)” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Corpses spread infection round; None to tend or mourn is found.” What does “infection” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: infection: the spread of disease.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why might Sophocles begin with the city's suffering before the investigation? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: It raises the stakes: finding the killer is a matter of life and death for everyone.
2. What does "Parodos (lines 156–213)" suggest about a city praying for rescue? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead link this play to Antigone, where burial is the central conflict.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the tone / mood in this scene shape what we understand about a city praying for rescue? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead link this play to Antigone, where burial is the central conflict. Useful evidence: "Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found" (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus): Chorus, lines 180–183. On tone / mood: The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athena, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Strophe 1 Sweet-voiced daughter of Zeus from thy gold-paved Pythian shrine Wafted to Thebes divine, What dost thou bring me?", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Parodos (lines 156–213)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athena, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away.
7. How does "Parodos (lines 156–213)" build on "Prologue (lines 1–155)"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead link this play to Antigone, where burial is the central conflict. Useful evidence: "Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air— / Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers and litanies" (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus): Chorus, lines 184–187. On structure: The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athena, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead link this play to Antigone, where burial is the central conflict. Useful evidence: “Sweet-voiced daughter of Zeus from thy gold-paved Pythian shrine / Wafted to Thebes divine” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: a city praying for rescue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How does a whole community react when it is afraid? Give a modern example.” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and responsibility? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead link this play to Antigone, where burial is the central conflict. Useful evidence: “Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus): Chorus, lines 180–183. On structure: The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athena, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the Chorus a character or a commentator? Argue with evidence from the Parodos. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position on the Chorus's role.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead link this play to Antigone, where burial is the central conflict. Useful evidence: “Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air— / Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers and litanies” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus): Chorus, lines 184–187. Theme link: a city praying for rescue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead link this play to Antigone, where burial is the central conflict.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead link this play to Antigone, where burial is the central conflict. Useful evidence: “Sweet-voiced daughter of Zeus from thy gold-paved Pythian shrine / Wafted to Thebes divine” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: a city praying for rescue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead link this play to Antigone, where burial is the central conflict. Useful evidence: “Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus): Chorus, lines 180–183. Theme link: a city praying for rescue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Parodos (lines 156–213)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of a city praying for rescue. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead link this play to Antigone, where burial is the central conflict. Useful evidence: “Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air— / Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers and litanies” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus): Chorus, lines 184–187. On structure: The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athena, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Parodos (lines 156–213)”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead link this play to Antigone, where burial is the central conflict. Useful evidence: “Sweet-voiced daughter of Zeus from thy gold-paved Pythian shrine / Wafted to Thebes divine” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: a city praying for rescue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to pride and fall: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead link this play to Antigone, where burial is the central conflict. Useful evidence: “Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus): Chorus, lines 180–183. Theme link: a city praying for rescue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead link

this play to Antigone, where burial is the central conflict. Useful evidence: “Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air— / Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers and litanies” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus): Chorus, lines 184–187. On imagery: The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athena, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Parodos (lines 156–213)” treats a city praying for rescue with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus Rex see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead link this play to Antigone, where burial is the central conflict. Useful evidence: “Sweet-voiced daughter of Zeus from thy gold-paved Pythian shrine / Wafted to Thebes divine” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: a city praying for rescue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Episode 1 (lines 214–479)” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead link this play to Antigone, where burial is the central conflict. Useful evidence: “Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus): Chorus, lines 180–183. Theme link: a city praying for rescue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a city praying for rescue? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead link this play to Antigone, where burial is the central conflict. Useful evidence: “Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air— / Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers and litanies” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus): Chorus, lines 184–187. Theme link: a city praying for rescue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is a parodos?
   A. A prayer spoken by the king
   B. A messenger's speech
   C. The Chorus's entrance song
   D. The final scene

   Key: C (The Chorus's entrance song)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the Chorus describe in lines 180–183?
   A. A victory feast
   B. A storm at sea
   C. The dead lying untended and spreading infection
   D. The Sphinx's riddle

   Key: C (The dead lying untended and spreading infection)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom do the elders pray to?
   A. The Sphinx
   B. The dead king Laius
   C. Gods such as Athena, Artemis and Apollo
   D. Oedipus alone

   Key: C (Gods such as Athena, Artemis and Apollo)
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who are the Chorus in this play?
   A. Soldiers of Corinth
   B. Servants of the palace
   C. Elders of Thebes
   D. Priests from Delphi

   Key: C (Elders of Thebes)
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is the mood of the Parodos?
   A. Joyful and calm
   B. Angry and mocking
   C. Fearful and pleading
   D. Bored and distant

   Key: C (Fearful and pleading)
6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus: "Wasted thus by death on death / All our city _____. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found"

   Key: perisheth
7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus: "Sweet-voiced _____ of Zeus from thy gold-paved Pythian shrine / Wafted to Thebes divine"

   Key: daughter

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Corpses spread infection round; None to tend or mourn is found.”, what does “infection” most nearly mean?

   A. the spread of disease

   B. (archaic adjective) foolish; carried away by passion

   C. the killing of one's father, or the person who does it

   D. overfed; having too much of something

   Key: A (the spread of disease)

9. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does "None to tend or mourn is found" tell us about the city?

   Sample answer: So many have died that no one is left to care for the dead.

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus: “Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and _____ rend the air— / Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers and litanies”

    Key: grandams

11. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Corpses spread _____ round; None to tend or mourn is found.” Word bank: infection

    Key: infection

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why might Sophocles begin with the city's suffering before the investigation?

    Sample answer: It raises the stakes: finding the killer is a matter of life and death for everyone. The evidence is “Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air— / Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers and litanies” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 184–187.

13. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “Sweet-voiced daughter of Zeus from thy gold-paved Pythian shrine / Wafted to Thebes divine” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Chorus, in this part of the section. The evidence is “Sweet-voiced daughter of Zeus from thy gold-paved Pythian shrine / Wafted to Thebes divine” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: a city praying for rescue. The words “daughter” and “shrine” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in “Parodos (lines 156–213)”? The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athena, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away.

    A. Imagery

    B. Conflict

    C. Point of view

    D. Plot

    Key: A (Imagery)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? A city praying for rescue.

    A. Fate and responsibility

    B. Pride and fall

C. Leadership and the city

D. Knowledge and blindness

Key: D (Knowledge and blindness)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how knowledge and blindness develops from Prologue (lines 1–155) to Parodos (lines 156–213). Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus, the text reads "My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool" — Oedipus, lines 1–3. In Parodos (lines 156–213), "Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found" (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 180–183. A city praying for rescue.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Parodos (lines 156–213), lines 156–213? "Strophe 2 Ah me, what _____ woes are mine!"

A. unharboured

B. threefold

C. countless

D. goddess

Key: C (countless)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Parodos (lines 156–213), lines 156–213: "Father Zeus, whose hand Doth wield the _____ brand, Slay him beneath thy levin bold, we pray, Slay him, O slay!" Word bank: snooded, lightning, circling, threefold
Key: lightning

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Parodos (lines 156–213), lines 169–170 reveal about the character or situation? "If in the days of old when we nigh had perished, ye drave From our land the fiery plague, be near us now and defend us!" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: The passage (Parodos (lines 156–213), lines 169–170) shows the situation turning on knowledge and blindness: the story keeps returning to knowledge and blindness. The words "perished" and "plague" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

20. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Parodos (lines 156–213)?

A. "Strophe 2 Ah me, what countless woes are mine!"

B. "Your threefold aid I crave From death and ruin our city to save."

C. "If in the days of old when we nigh had perished, ye drave From our land the fiery plague, be near us now and defend us!"

D. "All our host is in decline; Weaponless my spirit lies."

Key: B ("Your threefold aid I crave From death and ruin our city to save.")

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Parodos (lines 156–213), lines 158–161: "My soul is racked and shivers with fear. (Healer of Delos, hear!) Hast thou some pain unknown before, Or with the _____ years renewest a penance of yore?" Word bank: countless, circling, lightning, goddess
Key: circling

22. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air— / Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers

and litanies" (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 184–187. The evidence is "Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air— / Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers and litanies" (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus).

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Parodos (lines 156–213), lines 196–198 to the story's treatment of pride and fall: "For what night leaves undone, Smit by the morrow's sun Perisheth." Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (Parodos (lines 156–213), lines 196–198) develops pride and fall: the story keeps returning to pride and fall. Its words "undone" and "leaves" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Goddess and sister, befriend, Artemis, Lady of Thebes, high-throned in the midst of our mart!" (Parodos (lines 156–213), lines 196–198), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating pride and fall as central.

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is the Chorus a character or a commentator? Argue with evidence from the Parodos.

Sample answer: A defended position on the Chorus's role. The evidence is "Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found" (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 180–183. This develops knowledge and blindness: a city praying for rescue. The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athena, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away.

25. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? "Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found" (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 180–183. The evidence is "Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found" (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus).

26. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? "Sweet-voiced daughter of Zeus from thy gold-paved Pythian shrine / Wafted to Thebes divine" (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus)

    A. The letter's failure as a punishment.

    B. Chorus, in this part of the section.

    C. Second Messenger, lines 1237–1240.

    D. The lines describe a sea voyage to Troy.

    Key: B (Chorus, in this part of the section.)

27. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Parodos (lines 156–213)"?

    A. Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear

    B. A hopeful guess

    C. A city praying for rescue

    D. Good news that is not good

    Key: C (A city praying for rescue)

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air— / Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers and litanies" (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 184–187. The evidence is "Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air— /

Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers and litanies" (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: a city praying for rescue. The words "piercing" and "grandams" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athena, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found" (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 180–183. The evidence is "Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found" (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: a city praying for rescue. The words "infection" and "perisheth" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athena, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 1, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	11, 6, 5, 7, 9, 2, 17, 8, 18, 19, 12, 20, 14, 15, 13, 16	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	7, 4, 21, 11, 6, 8, 2, 22, 12, 19, 20, 14, 15, 13, 23, 24	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	18, 4, 1, 5, 3, 21, 7, 17, 20, 12, 19, 13, 14, 15, 16, 23	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Senior	8, 11, 9, 21, 2, 7, 19, 20, 12, 25, 14, 13, 15, 16, 24, 23	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 3
AP	3, 21, 1, 18, 2, 11, 26, 27, 20, 19, 12, 15, 28, 16, 24, 23	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 1, synthesis 4
College Freshman	8, 21, 10, 9, 3, 5, 1, 19, 20, 12, 15, 13, 14, 24, 23, 16	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 3
College Sophomore	11, 10, 8, 1, 17, 9, 20, 12, 19, 15, 14, 13, 24, 16, 29, 23	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 4
College Junior	11, 2, 17, 5, 7, 3, 12, 20, 19, 15, 14, 13, 28, 16, 23, 24	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 4
College Senior	7, 8, 11, 21, 9, 3, 20, 19, 27, 12, 15, 13, 16, 29, 24, 23	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	3, 9, 8, 18, 4, 10, 12, 20, 19, 14, 15, 13, 29, 16, 23, 24	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Parodos (lines 156–213)," how does Sophocles show a city praying for rescue? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): In Parodos (lines 156–213), how does Sophocles develop the idea of a city praying for rescue? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Parodos (lines 156–213) develops the idea of a city praying for rescue. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Parodos (lines 156–213) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of a city praying for rescue. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Parodos (lines 156–213) suggests about a city praying for rescue. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses imagery in Parodos (lines 156–213) to complicate the reader's understanding of a city praying for rescue. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Situate Parodos (lines 156–213) within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of a city praying for rescue responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Read Parodos (lines 156–213) alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of a city praying for rescue follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Parodos (lines 156–213) and its treatment of a city praying for rescue. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop a research argument that reads Parodos (lines 156–213) as evidence for a larger claim about a city praying for rescue in Oedipus Rex. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop an original

argument that reads Parodos (lines 156–213) as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of a city praying for rescue. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Oedipus Rex.

SAT-style questions

1. *Strophe 1 Sweet-voiced daughter of Zeus from thy gold-paved Pythian shrine Wafted to Thebes divine, What dost thou bring me? My soul is racked and shivers with fear. (Healer of Delos, hear!) Hast thou some pain unknown before, Or with the circling years renewest a penance of yore? Offspring of golden Hope, thou voice immortal, O tell me. Antistrophe 1 First on Athenè I call; O Zeus-born goddess, defend! Goddess and sister, befriend, Artemis, Lady of Thebes, high-throned in the midst of our mart! Lord of the death-winged dart! Your threefold aid I crave From death and ruin our city to save. If in the days of old when we nigh had perished, ye drave From our land the fiery plague, be near us now and defend us! Strophe 2 Ah me, what countless woes are mine! All our host is in decline; Weaponless my spirit lies. Earth her gracious fruits denies; Women wail in barren throes; Life on life downstriken goes, Swifter than the wind bird's flight, Swifter than the Fire-God's might, To the westering shores of Night. Antistrophe 2 Wasted thus by death on death All our city perisheth. Corpses spread infection round; None to tend or mourn is found. Wailing on the altar stair Wives and grandams rend the air— Long-drawn moans and piercing cries Blent with prayers and litanies. Golden child of Zeus, O hear Let thine angel face appear! Strophe 3 And grant that Ares whose hot breath I feel, Though without targe or steel He stalks, whose voice is as the battle shout, May turn in sudden rout, To the unharboured Thracian waters sped, Or Amphitrite's bed. For what night leaves undone, Smit by the morrow's sun Perisheth. Father Zeus, whose hand Doth wield the lightning brand, Slay him beneath thy levin bold, we pray, Slay him, O slay! Antistrophe 3 O that thine arrows too, Lycean King, From that taut bow's gold string, Might fly abroad, the champions of our rights; Yea, and the flashing lights Of Artemis, wherewith the huntress sweeps Across the Lycian steeps. Thee too I call with golden-snooded hair, Whose name our land doth bear, Bacchus to whom thy Maenads Evoē shout; Come with thy bright torch, rout, Blithe god whom we adore, The god whom gods abhor.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Parodos (lines 156–213)"?

   A. Responsibility, mercy and the end

   B. A city praying for rescue

   C. The hunted man

   D. The curse and the prophet

SAT key: 1. B (A city praying for rescue)

Lesson 4: Episode 1 (lines 214–479)

Focus: the curse and the prophet

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (mature themes): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently.
Student preview: This section deals with mature themes in the play.
Suggested language: "What does this passage make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne.

Background: Teiresias is the traditional blind seer of Theban myth. In Greek belief, a killer carried pollution (miasma) that could harm a whole city.

Significance: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why do people sometimes refuse to hear a truth they have asked for? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to knowledge and blindness because.... Content note before we start: This section deals with mature themes in the play.
Prompt: Why do people sometimes refuse to hear a truth they have asked for?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to knowledge and blindness because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the curse and the prophet.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Three key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: insolence — rude, arrogant disrespect; Storr's word for Greek hybris; polluter — one who makes something unclean; here, a person whose crime brings religious defilement on a city; proclamation — an official public announcement.
Words: insolence: rude, arrogant disrespect; Storr's word for Greek hybris · polluter: one who makes something unclean; here, a person whose crime brings religious defilement on a city · proclamation: an official public announcement

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Teiresias is the traditional blind seer of Theban myth. In Greek belief, a killer carried pollution (miasma) that could harm a whole city. The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. Look closely: In the next lines (249–251) Oedipus even includes himself in the curse if the killer shares his hearth; ask students to read those lines aloud after the reveal in Episode 4.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness!" slowly and put it in my own words: Oedipus lays a public curse on the unknown killer of Laius and on anyone who shared his guilt: may he waste away in misery. Next, craft. I notice the speech is solemn and almost legal, and the words in parentheses widen the curse to every partner in the crime. The strongest word is "wretchedness": Oedipus will later call himself an abject wretch, so the word he aims at the killer comes back to him. Then, effect. Why is the curse Oedipus lays on the murderer dramatic irony? My answer: The curse on the murderer is dramatic irony because the audience knows that Oedipus himself is the murderer, so every misery he wishes on the killer he is laying on his own head.

> *And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness! (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness!" slowly and put it in my own words: Oedipus lays a public curse on the unknown killer of Laius and on anyone who shared his guilt: may he waste away in misery. Next, craft. I notice the speech is solemn and almost legal, and the words in parentheses widen the curse to every partner in the crime. The strongest word is "wretchedness": Oedipus will later call himself an abject wretch, so the word he aims at the killer comes back to him. Then, effect. Why is the curse Oedipus lays on the murderer dramatic irony? My answer: The curse on the murderer is dramatic irony because the audience knows that Oedipus himself is the murderer, so every misery he wishes on the killer he is laying on his own head.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Teiresias is the traditional blind seer of Theban myth. In Greek belief, a killer carried pollution (miasma) that could harm a whole city. Read closely: "And for myself, if with my privity He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray The curse I laid on others fall on me." (Oedipus, lines 249–251). Ask: How does this line connect to knowledge and blindness? Expected: The curse and the prophet. (Oedipus, lines 249–251.)

> *And for myself, if with my privity / He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray / The curse I laid on others fall on me (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Teiresias is the traditional blind seer of Theban myth. In Greek belief, a killer carried pollution (miasma) that could harm a whole city. Read closely: "And for myself, if with my privity He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray The curse I laid on others fall on me." (Oedipus, lines 249–251).
Ask: How does this line connect to knowledge and blindness?
Expected answer: The curse and the prophet. (Oedipus, lines 249–251.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the curse and the prophet? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 1 (lines 214–479) develops the idea of the curse and the prophet. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. When the text says "Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of this land" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias), it shows this directly. Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne.
Task: Annotate the scene for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the curse and the prophet? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 1 (lines 214–479) develops the idea of the curse and the prophet. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. When the text says "Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of this land" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias), it shows this directly. Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why do people sometimes refuse to hear a truth they have asked for? Ask: Why do people sometimes refuse to hear a truth they have asked for?
Anchor question: Why do people sometimes refuse to hear a truth they have asked for?
Facilitation: Ask: Why do people sometimes refuse to hear a truth they have asked for?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the curse and the prophet? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. ("Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of t", Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the curse and the prophet? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. ("Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of t", Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes the curse and the prophet. Key takeaway: the curse and the prophet.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Irony:** Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne.
- **Characterization:** Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne.
- **Conflict:** Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne.

Themes and how they develop

- **knowledge and blindness:** the curse and the prophet.

Symbols and motifs

- **sight and blindness:** The section adds to the play's pattern of sight and blindness: the curse and the prophet.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 246–248.
- "And for myself, if with my privity / He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray / The curse I laid on others fall on me" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 249–251.
- "Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of this land" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias) Teiresias, lines 359–362.
- "Thus then I answer: since thou hast not spared / To twit me with my blindness—thou hast eyes, / Yet see'st not in what misery thou art fallen, / Nor where thou dwellest nor with whom for mate" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias) Teiresias, lines 424–427.
- "In reading riddles who so skilled as thou" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias) Teiresias, lines 455.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony.
Evidence: "Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of this land" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias)
Reasoning: Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 180–183
180 **Chorus:** Wasted thus by death on death
181 **Chorus:** All our city perisheth.
182 **Chorus:** Corpses spread infection round;
183 **Chorus:** None to tend or mourn is found.

Lines 246–248
246 **Oedipus:** And on the murderer this curse I lay
247 **Oedipus:** (On him and all the partners in his guilt):—
248 **Oedipus:** Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness!

Lines 249–251

249 **Oedipus:** And for myself, if with my privity
250 **Oedipus:** He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray
251 **Oedipus:** The curse I laid on others fall on me.

Lines 277–281

277 **Chorus:** The oath thou profferest, sire, I take and swear.
278 **Chorus:** I slew him not myself, nor can I name
279 **Chorus:** The slayer. For the quest, 'twere well, methinks
280 **Chorus:** That Phoebus, who proposed the riddle, himself
281 **Chorus:** Should give the answer—who the murderer was.

Line 285

285 **Oedipus:** Aye, if there be a third best, tell it too.

Lines 290–292

290 **Oedipus:** Here too my zeal has nothing lagged, for twice
291 **Oedipus:** At Creon's instance have I sent to fetch him,
292 **Oedipus:** And long I marvel why he is not here.

Lines 293–294

293 **Chorus:** I mind me too of rumors long ago—
294 **Chorus:** Mere gossip.

Line 301

301 **Oedipus:** Words scare not him who blenches not at deeds.

Lines 305–322

305 **Oedipus:** Teiresias, seer who comprehendest all,
306 **Oedipus:** Lore of the wise and hidden mysteries,
307 **Oedipus:** High things of heaven and low things of the earth,
308 **Oedipus:** Thou knowest, though thy blinded eyes see naught.
309 **Oedipus:** What plague infects our city; and we turn
310 **Oedipus:** To thee, O seer, our one defense and shield.
311 **Oedipus:** The purport of the answer that the God
312 **Oedipus:** Returned to us who sought his oracle,
313 **Oedipus:** The messengers have doubtless told thee—how
314 **Oedipus:** One course alone could rid us of the pest,
315 **Oedipus:** To find the murderers of Laius,
316 **Oedipus:** And slay them or expel them from the land.
317 **Oedipus:** Therefore begrudging neither augury
318 **Oedipus:** Nor other divination that is thine,
319 **Oedipus:** O save thyself, thy country, and thy king,
320 **Oedipus:** Save all from this defilement of blood shed.
321 **Oedipus:** On thee we rest. This is man's highest end,
322 **Oedipus:** To others' service all his powers to lend.

Lines 327–328

Teiresias: Let me go home; prevent me not; 'twere best
Teiresias: That thou shouldst bear thy burden and I mine.

Lines 333–335

Oedipus: Oh speak,
Oedipus: Withhold not, I adjure thee, if thou know'st,
Oedipus: Thy knowledge. We are all thy suppliants.

Lines 342–344

Oedipus: Monster! thy silence would incense a flint.
Oedipus: Will nothing loose thy tongue? Can nothing melt thee,
Oedipus: Or shake thy dogged taciturnity?

Lines 345–346

Teiresias: Thou blam'st my mood and seest not thine own
Teiresias: Wherewith thou art mated; no, thou taxest me.

Line 349

Teiresias: Well, it will come what will, though I be mute.

Lines 353–358

Oedipus: Yea, I am wroth, and will not stint my words,
Oedipus: But speak my whole mind. Thou methinks thou art he,
Oedipus: Who planned the crime, aye, and performed it too,
Oedipus: All save the assassination; and if thou
Oedipus: Hadst not been blind, I had been sworn to boot
Oedipus: That thou alone didst do the bloody deed.

Line 356

Oedipus: All save the assassination; and if thou

Lines 359–362

Teiresias: Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide
Teiresias: By thine own proclamation; from this day
Teiresias: Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man,
Teiresias: Thou the accursed polluter of this land.

Line 365

Teiresias: Yea, I am free, strong in the strength of truth.

Line 369

Teiresias: Didst miss my sense wouldst thou goad me on?

Lines 377–378

Teiresias: I say thou livest with thy nearest kin
Teiresias: In infamy, unwitting in thy shame.

Line 387

387 **Teiresias:** No, for thy weird is not to fall by me.

Lines 387–388

387 **Teiresias:** No, for thy weird is not to fall by me.
388 **Teiresias:** I leave to Apollo what concerns the god.

Lines 391–415

391 **Oedipus:** O wealth and empiry and skill by skill
392 **Oedipus:** Outwitted in the battlefield of life,
393 **Oedipus:** What spite and envy follow in your train!
394 **Oedipus:** See, for this crown the State conferred on me,
395 **Oedipus:** A gift, a thing I sought not, for this crown
396 **Oedipus:** The trusty Creon, my familiar friend,
397 **Oedipus:** Hath lain in wait to oust me and suborned
398 **Oedipus:** This mountebank, this juggling charlatan,
399 **Oedipus:** This tricksy beggar-priest, for gain alone
400 **Oedipus:** Keen-eyed, but in his proper art stone-blind.
401 **Oedipus:** Say, sirrah, hast thou ever proved thyself
402 **Oedipus:** A prophet? When the riddling Sphinx was here
403 **Oedipus:** Why hadst thou no deliverance for this folk?
404 **Oedipus:** And yet the riddle was not to be solved
405 **Oedipus:** By guess-work but required the prophet's art;
406 **Oedipus:** Wherein thou wast found lacking; neither birds
407 **Oedipus:** Nor sign from heaven helped thee, but I came,
408 **Oedipus:** The simple Oedipus; I stopped her mouth
409 **Oedipus:** By mother wit, untaught of auguries.
410 **Oedipus:** This is the man whom thou wouldst undermine,
411 **Oedipus:** In hope to reign with Creon in my stead.
412 **Oedipus:** Methinks that thou and thine abettor soon
413 **Oedipus:** Will rue your plot to drive the scapegoat out.
414 **Oedipus:** Thank thy grey hairs that thou hast still to learn
415 **Oedipus:** What chastisement such arrogance deserves.

Lines 402–403

402 **Oedipus:** A prophet? When the riddling Sphinx was here
403 **Oedipus:** Why hadst thou no deliverance for this folk?

Lines 424–427

424 **Teiresias:** Thus then I answer: since thou hast not spared
425 **Teiresias:** To twit me with my blindness—thou hast eyes,
426 **Teiresias:** Yet see'st not in what misery thou art fallen,
427 **Teiresias:** Nor where thou dwellest nor with whom for mate.

Line 455

455 **Teiresias:** In reading riddles who so skilled as thou?

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
insolence (noun)	rude, arrogant disrespect; Storr's word for Greek hybris	*Must I endure this fellow's insolence?*	
polluter (noun)	one who makes something unclean; here, a person whose crime brings religious defilement on a city	*Thou art the man, Thou the accursed polluter of this land.*	
proclamation (noun)	an official public announcement	*Which lacking (for too late Was I enrolled a citizen of Thebes) This proclamation I address to all:— Thebans, if any knows the man by whom Laius, son of Labdacus, was slain, I summon him to make clean shrift to me.*	

Discussion questions

1. Why do people sometimes refuse to hear a truth they have asked for?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with pride and fall?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Teiresias tell Oedipus in lines 359–362? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: That he is the man, the polluter of the land.
2. What does Oedipus wish on the unknown killer? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A life of utter wretchedness and exile
3. Why does Teiresias at first refuse to speak? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Knowing the truth brings only pain
4. Whom does Teiresias name as the polluter of the land? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Oedipus

5. Whom does Oedipus accuse of plotting with Teiresias? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Creon
6. What is ironic about the argument over blindness? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The blind prophet sees the truth while Oedipus, who can see, does not
7. Retell the three most important events of "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne.
8. Who is on stage in "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Must I endure this fellow's insolence?" What does "insolence" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: insolence: rude, arrogant disrespect; Storr's word for Greek hybris.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Oedipus turn on Creon instead of considering the prophecy? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Anger and fear for his power make him look for a plot.
2. What does "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)" suggest about the curse and the prophet? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the curse and the prophet? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. Useful evidence: "And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 246–248. On characterization: Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “The oath thou profferest, sire, I take and swear.”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Episode 1 (lines 214–479)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne.
7. How does “Episode 1 (lines 214–479)” build on “Parodos (lines 156–213)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. Useful evidence: “And for myself, if with my privity / He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray / The curse I laid on others fall on me” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 249–251. Theme link: the curse and the prophet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. Useful evidence: “Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of this land” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias): Teiresias, lines 359–362. On characterization: Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why do people sometimes refuse to hear a truth they have asked for?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with pride and fall? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. Useful evidence: “Thus then I answer: since thou hast not spared / To twit me with my blindness—thou hast eyes, / Yet see’st not in what misery thou art fallen, / Nor where thou dwellest nor with whom for mate” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias): Teiresias, lines 424–427. On conflict: Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names

Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Oedipus' anger a flaw or a reasonable response to an insult? Argue with lines 424–427 and 455. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position on character.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. Useful evidence: “In reading riddles who so skilled as thou” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias): Teiresias, lines 455. Theme link: the curse and the prophet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. Useful evidence: “And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 246–248. Theme link: the curse and the prophet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. Useful evidence: “And for myself, if with my privity / He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray / The curse I laid on others fall on me” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 249–251. On characterization: Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Episode 1 (lines 214–479)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the curse and the prophet. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. Useful evidence: “Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of this land” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias):

Teiresias, lines 359–362. Theme link: the curse and the prophet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. Useful evidence: "Thus then I answer: since thou hast not spared / To twit me with my blindness—thou hast eyes, / Yet see'st not in what misery thou art fallen, / Nor where thou dwellest nor with whom for mate" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias): Teiresias, lines 424–427. Theme link: the curse and the prophet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to leadership and the city: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. Useful evidence: "In reading riddles who so skilled as thou" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias): Teiresias, lines 455. Theme link: the curse and the prophet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. Useful evidence: "And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 246–248. On irony: Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)" treats the curse and the prophet with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus Rex see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. Useful evidence: "And for myself, if with my privity / He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray / The curse I laid on others fall on me" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 249–251. Theme link: the curse and the prophet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the

class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. Useful evidence: "Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of this land" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias): Teiresias, lines 359–362. Theme link: the curse and the prophet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the curse and the prophet? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. Useful evidence: "Thus then I answer: since thou hast not spared / To twit me with my blindness—thou hast eyes, / Yet see'st not in what misery thou art fallen, / Nor where thou dwellest nor with whom for mate" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias): Teiresias, lines 424–427. Theme link: the curse and the prophet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Teiresias tell Oedipus in lines 359–362?
   Sample answer: That he is the man, the polluter of the land.
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does Teiresias name as the polluter of the land?
   A. Creon
   B. Jocasta
   C. A robber from Corinth
   D. Oedipus

   Key: D (Oedipus)
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 342–344: "Can nothing melt thee, Or shake thy dogged _____?" Word bank: profits, infects, taciturnity, begrudging
   Key: taciturnity
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 293–294? "I mind me too of _____ long ago— Mere gossip."
   A. insolently
   B. profferest
   C. methinks
   D. rumors

Key: D (rumors)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus: "And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter _____"

   Key: wretchedness

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias: "Thus then I answer: since thou hast not spared / To twit me with my _____—thou hast eyes, / Yet see'st not in what misery thou art fallen, / Nor where thou dwellest nor with whom for mate"

   Key: blindness

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is ironic about the argument over blindness?

   A. No one mentions sight

   B. The blind prophet sees the truth while Oedipus, who can see, does not

   C. Oedipus is already blind

   D. Teiresias pretends to be blind

   Key: B (The blind prophet sees the truth while Oedipus, who can see, does not)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Thou art the man, Thou the accursed _____ of this land." Word bank: proclamation, polluter, insolence

   Key: polluter

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Must I endure this fellow's _____?" Word bank: proclamation, polluter, insolence

   Key: insolence

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Oedipus turn on Creon instead of considering the prophecy?

    Sample answer: Anger and fear for his power make him look for a plot. The evidence is "And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 246–248.

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), line 369 reveal about the character or situation? "Didst miss my sense wouldst thou goad me on?" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), line 369) shows the situation turning on knowledge and blindness: the story keeps returning to knowledge and blindness. The words "wouldst" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Episode 1 (lines 214–479)?

    A. "My liege, if any man sees eye to eye With our lord Phoebus, 'tis our prophet, lord Teiresias; he of all men best might guide A searcher of…"

    B. "Aye, if there be a third best, tell it too."

    C. "Here too my zeal has nothing lagged, for twice At Creon's instance have I sent to fetch him, And long I marvel why he is not here."

    D. "May I then say what seems next best to me?"

    Key: D ("May I then say what seems next best to me?")

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), line 301 reveal about the character or situation? "Words scare not him who blenches not at deeds." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), line 301) shows the situation turning on knowledge and blindness: the story keeps returning to knowledge and blindness. The words "blenches" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.
14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 333–335 shapes its tone: "Oh speak, Withhold not, I adjure thee, if thou know'st, Thy knowledge." Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "knowledge" and "adjure" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 333–335) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and responsibility: the story keeps returning to fate and responsibility. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 377–378 shapes its tone: "I say thou livest with thy nearest kin In infamy, unwitting in thy shame." Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "unwitting" and "nearest" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 377–378) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to leadership and the city: the story keeps returning to leadership and the city. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 402–403 to the story's treatment of mercy: "When the riddling Sphinx was here Why hadst thou no deliverance for this folk?" Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 402–403) develops mercy: the story keeps returning to mercy. Its words "deliverance" and "riddling" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "I slew him not myself, nor can I name The slayer." (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 402–403), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating mercy as central.
17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 327–328? "Let me go home; prevent me not; 'twere best That thou _____ bear thy burden and I mine."
    A. shouldst
    B. miseries
    C. rumors
    D. profferest

    Key: A (shouldst)
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why does Teiresias at first refuse to speak?
    A. He is afraid of the Chorus
    B. Knowing the truth brings only pain
    C. Creon paid him to stay silent
    D. He does not know the answer

    Key: B (Knowing the truth brings only pain)
19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 305–322: "What plague _____ our city; and we turn To thee, O seer, our one defense and shield." Word bank:

begrudging, insolently, infects, miseries

Key: infects

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Oedipus wish on the unknown killer?

    A. A quick pardon

    B. A fair trial

    C. A reward for confessing

    D. A life of utter wretchedness and exile

    Key: D (A life of utter wretchedness and exile)

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), line 387 shapes its tone: "No, for thy weird is not to fall by me." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words its wording (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), line 387) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and responsibility: the story keeps returning to fate and responsibility. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The curse and the prophet.

    A. Leadership and the city

    B. Fate and responsibility

    C. Pride and fall

    D. Knowledge and blindness

    Key: D (Knowledge and blindness)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)"? Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon…

    A. Imagery

    B. Structure

    C. Irony

    D. Metaphor

    Key: C (Irony)

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how knowledge and blindness develops from Parodos (lines 156–213) to Episode 1 (lines 214–479). Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus, the text reads "Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found" — Chorus, lines 180–183. In Episode 1 (lines 214–479), "And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 246–248. The curse and the prophet.

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does Oedipus accuse of plotting with Teiresias?

    A. Polybus

    B. The Priest

    C. Creon

    D. The Chorus

Key: C (Creon)

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 277–281: "The oath thou _____, sire, I take and swear." Word bank: insolently, profferest, length, rumors
Key: profferest

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), line 285 to the story's treatment of pride and fall: "Aye, if there be a third best, tell it too." Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), line 285) develops pride and fall: the story keeps returning to pride and fall. Its words its wording carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Here too my zeal has nothing lagged, for twice At Creon's instance have I sent to fetch him, And long I marvel why he…" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), line 285), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating pride and fall as central.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), line 356 to the story's treatment of pride and fall: "Thou methinks thou art he, Who planned the crime, aye, and performed it too, All save the assassination; and if thou Hadst not been blind, I had been sworn to boot That thou alone didst do the bloody deed." Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), line 356) develops pride and fall: the story keeps returning to pride and fall. Its words "assassination" and "performed" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Yea, I am free, strong in the strength of truth." (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), line 356), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating pride and fall as central.

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] In the line "Which lacking (for too late Was I enrolled a citizen of Thebes) This proclamation I address to all:— Thebans, if any knows the man by whom Laius, son of Labdacus, was slain, I summon him to make clean shrift to me.", what does "proclamation" most nearly mean?

A. the spread of disease

B. mixed together

C. an official public announcement

D. a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar

Key: C (an official public announcement)

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Is Oedipus' anger a flaw or a reasonable response to an insult? Argue with lines 424–427 and 455.
Sample answer: A defended position on character: Oedipus, lines 249–251. The evidence is "And for myself, if with my privity / He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray / The curse I laid on others fall on me" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus). This develops knowledge and blindness: the curse and the prophet. Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne.

31. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)"?

A. The shadow of a shade

B. The curse and the prophet

C. Responsibility, mercy and the end

D. The hunted man

Key: B (The curse and the prophet)

32. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “And for myself, if with my privity / He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray / The curse I laid on others fall on me” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 249–251. The evidence is “And for myself, if with my privity / He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray / The curse I laid on others fall on me” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus).
33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 305–322 shapes its tone: “This is man’s highest end, To others’ service all his powers to lend.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “service” and “highest” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 305–322) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to leadership and the city: the story keeps returning to leadership and the city. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
34. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] In the line “Thou art the man, Thou the accursed polluter of this land.”, what does “polluter” most nearly mean?
    A. an official public announcement
    B. (archaic adjective) foolish; carried away by passion
    C. rude, arrogant disrespect; Storr's word for Greek hybris
    D. one who makes something unclean; here, a person whose crime brings religious defilement on a city

    Key: D (one who makes something unclean; here, a person whose crime brings religious defilement on a city)
35. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Complete the quotation from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias: “Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own _____; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of this land”
    Key: proclamation
36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of this land.” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias) supports it: Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne. But “Thus then I answer: since thou hast not spared / To twit me with my blindness—thou hast eyes, / Yet see’st not in what misery thou art fallen, / Nor where thou dwellest nor with whom for mate.” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias) complicates it: the line (Teiresias, lines 424–427) shows the same issue from another side, and its “not” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. The claim is therefore a strong reading, not a complete one, and a careful answer says where it stops applying.
37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Connect this passage from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 345–346 to the story's treatment of mercy: “Thou blam’st my mood and seest not thine own Wherewith thou art mated; no, thou taxest me.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 345–346) develops mercy: the story keeps returning to mercy. Its words “taxest” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Well, it will come what will, though I be mute.” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 345–346), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating mercy as central.

38. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What can you infer from this line? “And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 246–248. The evidence is “And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus).
39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “And for myself, if with my privity / He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray / The curse I laid on others fall on me” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 249–251. The evidence is “And for myself, if with my privity / He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray / The curse I laid on others fall on me” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus). This develops knowledge and blindness: the curse and the prophet. The words “admittance” and “privity” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne.
40. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Analyze the word choice in “Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of this land” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Teiresias, lines 359–362. The evidence is “Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the…” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias). This develops knowledge and blindness: the curse and the prophet. The words “proclamation” and “polluter” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.
41. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 246–248. The evidence is “And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus). This develops knowledge and blindness: the curse and the prophet. The words “wretchedness” and “murderer” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne.
42. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Claim: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of this land” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias).
    Sample answer: Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne. The evidence is “Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the…” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias) — Teiresias, lines 359–362. This develops knowledge and blindness: the curse and the prophet.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix

Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 19, 20, 9, 1, 3, 6, 11, 13, 10, 12, 21, 22, 23, 24	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	9, 7, 4, 25, 5, 19, 26, 10, 13, 12, 11, 21, 22, 23, 27, 28	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	8, 2, 3, 29, 4, 6, 12, 13, 10, 11, 23, 15, 22, 14, 30, 24	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	20, 8, 29, 9, 31, 11, 12, 10, 13, 21, 15, 22, 14, 30, 24, 27	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	20, 8, 9, 18, 32, 11, 10, 22, 23, 21, 33, 15, 27, 24, 30, 28	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	5, 34, 20, 35, 10, 11, 31, 14, 21, 22, 33, 15, 36, 28, 16, 37	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	6, 29, 8, 13, 12, 38, 14, 23, 21, 33, 22, 28, 37, 30, 24, 39	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	26, 17, 5, 20, 12, 15, 33, 40, 22, 14, 37, 28, 30, 36, 39, 24	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	6, 9, 20, 12, 22, 15, 23, 40, 14, 16, 30, 27, 28, 41, 37, 24	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	18, 9, 8, 12, 23, 22, 33, 42, 39, 36, 37, 24, 30, 16, 28, 27	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 4, synthesis 8

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)," how does Sophocles show the curse and the prophet? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1): In Episode 1 (lines 214–479), how does Sophocles develop the idea of the curse and the prophet? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Episode 1 (lines 214–479) develops the idea of the curse and the prophet. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Episode 1 (lines 214–479) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the curse and the prophet. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Episode 1 (lines 214–479) suggests about the curse and the prophet. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses irony in Episode 1 (lines 214–479) to complicate the reader's understanding of the curse and the prophet. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Situate Episode 1 (lines 214–479) within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the curse and the prophet responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Read Episode 1 (lines 214–479) alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the curse and the prophet follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Episode 1 (lines 214–479) and its treatment of the curse and the prophet. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop a research argument that reads Episode 1 (lines 214–479) as evidence for a larger claim about the curse and the prophet in Oedipus Rex. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop an original argument that reads Episode 1 (lines 214–479) as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the curse and the prophet. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Oedipus Rex.

SAT-style questions

1. *The oath thou profferest, sire, I take and swear. I slew him not myself, nor can I name The slayer. For the quest, 'twere well, methinks That Phoebus, who proposed the riddle, himself Should give the answer—who the murderer was.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)"?

A. A king who promises to find the truth

B. The curse and the prophet

C. The herdsman and the recognition

D. Responsibility, mercy and the end

SAT key: 1. B (The curse and the prophet)

Lesson 5: Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)

Focus: the hunted man

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511) (the hunted man) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1

Teacher only · spoilers

The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof.

Background: A stasimon is a choral ode sung between episodes. Delphi was believed to be the centre ("mid shrine") of the earth.

Significance: The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How much evidence should we need before we believe an accusation against someone we trust? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to knowledge and blindness because....
Prompt: How much evidence should we need before we believe an accusation against someone we trust?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to knowledge and blindness because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the hunted man.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
One key word in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: assayed — tested to measure quality, as gold is tested.
Words: assayed: tested to measure quality, as gold is tested

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
A stasimon is a choral ode sung between episodes. Delphi was believed to be the centre ("mid shrine") of the earth. The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community. Look closely: The elders refuse to believe Teiresias without proof (lines 503–504); ask whether that is loyalty, fairness or blindness.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice divine, / From Earth's mid shrine." slowly and put it in my own words: The elders picture the unknown killer as a sullen bull roaming wild country, trying in vain to escape a doom that hovers over him, driven on by Apollo's voice from Delphi. Next, craft. I notice a simile and a run of short rhymed lines keep the doom always just overhead. The strongest word is "doom": the fate that follows the killer wherever he runs. Then, effect. Why is the Chorus' picture of the hunted bull ironic? My answer: The Chorus' picture of the hunted bull is ironic because the elders mean an unknown killer far away, but the audience knows the hunted man is Oedipus himself, the king they are loyal to.

> *Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice divine, / From Earth's mid shrine.* *(Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), lines 490–497)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice divine, / From Earth's mid shrine." slowly and put it in my own words: The elders picture the unknown killer as a sullen bull roaming wild country, trying in vain to escape a doom that hovers over him, driven on by Apollo's voice from Delphi. Next, craft. I notice a simile and a run of short rhymed lines keep the doom always just overhead. The strongest word is "doom": the fate that follows the killer wherever he runs. Then, effect. Why is the Chorus' picture of the hunted bull ironic? My answer: The Chorus' picture of the hunted bull is ironic because the elders mean an unknown killer far away, but the audience knows the hunted man is Oedipus himself, the king they are loyal to.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Read closely: "Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King's good name, / How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame?" (Chorus, lines 503–504). Ask: Where does "the voice divine" come from? Expected: From Delphi, "Earth's mid shrine." Ask: Why are the elders torn? Expected: They respect the prophet but also owe Oedipus loyalty for saving the city.

> *Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King's good name, / How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame?* *(Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus)*

Ask: Where does "the voice divine" come from?
Expected answer: From Delphi, "Earth's mid shrine."
Ask: Why are the elders torn?
Expected answer: They respect the prophet but also owe Oedipus loyalty for saving the city.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the ode for imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this ode suggest about the hunted man? Exemplar: The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community. The lines "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice divine, / From Earth's mid shrine." (lines 490–497) are the evidence.
Task: Annotate the ode for imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this ode suggest about the hunted man?
Exemplar: The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community. The lines "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice divine, / From Earth's mid shrine." (lines 490–497) are the evidence.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How much evidence should we need before we believe an accusation against someone we trust? Ask: Are the Chorus wise or naive to wait for proof? Defend your view.
Anchor question: How much evidence should we need before we believe an accusation against someone we trust?
Facilitation: Ask: Are the Chorus wise or naive to wait for proof? Defend your view. · Ask for the line that proves each answer.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: Why is the Chorus' picture of the hunted bull ironic? Model answer: The Chorus' picture of the hunted bull is ironic because the elders mean an unknown killer far away, but the audience knows the hunted man is Oedipus himself, the king they are loyal to.
Exit ticket: Why is the Chorus' picture of the hunted bull ironic?
Answer: The Chorus' picture of the hunted bull is ironic because the elders mean an unknown killer far away, but the audience knows the hunted man is Oedipus himself, the king they are loyal to.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how imagery shapes the hunted man. Key takeaway: the hunted man.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Imagery:** The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof.
- **Theme:** The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof.
- **Tone / mood:** The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof.

Themes and how they develop

- **knowledge and blindness:** the hunted man.

Symbols and motifs

- **sight and blindness:** The section adds to the play's pattern of sight and blindness: the hunted man.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice divine, / From Earth's mid shrine" (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus) Chorus, lines 490–497.
- "Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King's good name, / How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame" (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus) Chorus, lines 503–504.
- "Who is he by voice immortal named from Pythia's rocky cell, / Doer of foul deeds of bloodshed, horrors that no tongue can tell" (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus) Chorus, in this part of the section.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community.
Evidence: "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice divine, / From Earth's mid shrine" (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus)
Reasoning: The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 156–213

Chorus: Sweet-voiced daughter of Zeus from thy gold-paved Pythian shrine
Chorus: Wafted to Thebes divine,
Chorus: What dost thou bring me? My soul is racked and shivers with fear.
Chorus: (Healer of Delos, hear!)
Chorus: Hast thou some pain unknown before,

Chorus: Or with the circling years renewest a penance of yore?
Chorus: Offspring of golden Hope, thou voice immortal, O tell me.
Chorus: First on Athenè I call; O Zeus-born goddess, defend!
Chorus: Goddess and sister, befriend,
Chorus: Artemis, Lady of Thebes, high-throned in the midst of our mart!
Chorus: Lord of the death-winged dart!
Chorus: Your threefold aid I crave
Chorus: From death and ruin our city to save.
Chorus: If in the days of old when we nigh had perished, ye drave
Chorus: From our land the fiery plague, be near us now and defend us!
Chorus: Ah me, what countless woes are mine!
Chorus: All our host is in decline;
Chorus: Weaponless my spirit lies.
Chorus: Earth her gracious fruits denies;
Chorus: Women wail in barren throes;
Chorus: Life on life downstriken goes,
Chorus: Swifter than the wind bird's flight,
Chorus: Swifter than the Fire-God's might,
Chorus: To the westering shores of Night.
Chorus: Wasted thus by death on death
Chorus: All our city perisheth.
Chorus: Corpses spread infection round;
Chorus: None to tend or mourn is found.
Chorus: Wailing on the altar stair
Chorus: Wives and grandams rend the air—
Chorus: Long-drawn moans and piercing cries
Chorus: Blent with prayers and litanies.
Chorus: Golden child of Zeus, O hear
Chorus: Let thine angel face appear!
Chorus: And grant that Ares whose hot breath I feel,
Chorus: Though without targe or steel
Chorus: He stalks, whose voice is as the battle shout,
Chorus: May turn in sudden rout,
Chorus: To the unharboured Thracian waters sped,
Chorus: Or Amphitrite's bed.
Chorus: For what night leaves undone,
Chorus: Smit by the morrow's sun
Chorus: Perisheth. Father Zeus, whose hand
Chorus: Doth wield the lightning brand,
Chorus: Slay him beneath thy levin bold, we pray,
Chorus: Slay him, O slay!
Chorus: O that thine arrows too, Lycean King,
Chorus: From that taut bow's gold string,
Chorus: Might fly abroad, the champions of our rights;

205 **Chorus:** Yea, and the flashing lights
206 **Chorus:** Of Artemis, wherewith the huntress sweeps
207 **Chorus:** Across the Lycian steeps.
208 **Chorus:** Thee too I call with golden-snooded hair,
209 **Chorus:** Whose name our land doth bear,
210 **Chorus:** Bacchus to whom thy Maenads Evoē shout;
211 **Chorus:** Come with thy bright torch, rout,
212 **Chorus:** Blithe god whom we adore,
213 **Chorus:** The god whom gods abhor.

Lines 188–189
188 **Chorus:** Golden child of Zeus, O hear
189 **Chorus:** Let thine angel face appear!

Lines 246–248
246 **Oedipus:** And on the murderer this curse I lay
247 **Oedipus:** (On him and all the partners in his guilt):—
248 **Oedipus:** Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness!

Lines 277–281
277 **Chorus:** The oath thou profferest, sire, I take and swear.
278 **Chorus:** I slew him not myself, nor can I name
279 **Chorus:** The slayer. For the quest, 'twere well, methinks
280 **Chorus:** That Phoebus, who proposed the riddle, himself
281 **Chorus:** Should give the answer—who the murderer was.

Line 285
285 **Oedipus:** Aye, if there be a third best, tell it too.

Lines 290–292
290 **Oedipus:** Here too my zeal has nothing lagged, for twice
291 **Oedipus:** At Creon's instance have I sent to fetch him,
292 **Oedipus:** And long I marvel why he is not here.

Lines 293–294
293 **Chorus:** I mind me too of rumors long ago—
294 **Chorus:** Mere gossip.

Line 301
301 **Oedipus:** Words scare not him who blenches not at deeds.

Lines 305–322
305 **Oedipus:** Teiresias, seer who comprehendest all,
306 **Oedipus:** Lore of the wise and hidden mysteries,
307 **Oedipus:** High things of heaven and low things of the earth,
308 **Oedipus:** Thou knowest, though thy blinded eyes see naught.

309 **Oedipus:** What plague infects our city; and we turn
310 **Oedipus:** To thee, O seer, our one defense and shield.
311 **Oedipus:** The purport of the answer that the God
312 **Oedipus:** Returned to us who sought his oracle,
313 **Oedipus:** The messengers have doubtless told thee—how
314 **Oedipus:** One course alone could rid us of the pest,
315 **Oedipus:** To find the murderers of Laius,
316 **Oedipus:** And slay them or expel them from the land.
317 **Oedipus:** Therefore begrudging neither augury
318 **Oedipus:** Nor other divination that is thine,
319 **Oedipus:** O save thyself, thy country, and thy king,
320 **Oedipus:** Save all from this defilement of blood shed.
321 **Oedipus:** On thee we rest. This is man's highest end,
322 **Oedipus:** To others' service all his powers to lend.

Lines 327–328
327 **Teiresias:** Let me go home; prevent me not; 'twere best
328 **Teiresias:** That thou shouldst bear thy burden and I mine.

Lines 333–335
333 **Oedipus:** Oh speak,
334 **Oedipus:** Withhold not, I adjure thee, if thou know'st,
335 **Oedipus:** Thy knowledge. We are all thy suppliants.

Lines 342–344
342 **Oedipus:** Monster! thy silence would incense a flint.
343 **Oedipus:** Will nothing loose thy tongue? Can nothing melt thee,
344 **Oedipus:** Or shake thy dogged taciturnity?

Lines 345–346
345 **Teiresias:** Thou blam'st my mood and seest not thine own
346 **Teiresias:** Wherewith thou art mated; no, thou taxest me.

Line 349
349 **Teiresias:** Well, it will come what will, though I be mute.

Lines 353–358
353 **Oedipus:** Yea, I am wroth, and will not stint my words,
354 **Oedipus:** But speak my whole mind. Thou methinks thou art he,
355 **Oedipus:** Who planned the crime, aye, and performed it too,
356 **Oedipus:** All save the assassination; and if thou
357 **Oedipus:** Hadst not been blind, I had been sworn to boot
358 **Oedipus:** That thou alone didst do the bloody deed.

Line 356
356 **Oedipus:** All save the assassination; and if thou

Line 365

365 **Teiresias:** Yea, I am free, strong in the strength of truth.

Line 369

369 **Teiresias:** Didst miss my sense wouldst thou goad me on?

Lines 377–378

377 **Teiresias:** I say thou livest with thy nearest kin
378 **Teiresias:** In infamy, unwitting in thy shame.

Line 387

387 **Teiresias:** No, for thy weird is not to fall by me.

Lines 387–388

387 **Teiresias:** No, for thy weird is not to fall by me.
388 **Teiresias:** I leave to Apollo what concerns the god.

Lines 391–415

391 **Oedipus:** O wealth and empiry and skill by skill
392 **Oedipus:** Outwitted in the battlefield of life,
393 **Oedipus:** What spite and envy follow in your train!
394 **Oedipus:** See, for this crown the State conferred on me,
395 **Oedipus:** A gift, a thing I sought not, for this crown
396 **Oedipus:** The trusty Creon, my familiar friend,
397 **Oedipus:** Hath lain in wait to oust me and suborned
398 **Oedipus:** This mountebank, this juggling charlatan,
399 **Oedipus:** This tricksy beggar-priest, for gain alone
400 **Oedipus:** Keen-eyed, but in his proper art stone-blind.
401 **Oedipus:** Say, sirrah, hast thou ever proved thyself
402 **Oedipus:** A prophet? When the riddling Sphinx was here
403 **Oedipus:** Why hadst thou no deliverance for this folk?
404 **Oedipus:** And yet the riddle was not to be solved
405 **Oedipus:** By guess-work but required the prophet's art;
406 **Oedipus:** Wherein thou wast found lacking; neither birds
407 **Oedipus:** Nor sign from heaven helped thee, but I came,
408 **Oedipus:** The simple Oedipus; I stopped her mouth
409 **Oedipus:** By mother wit, untaught of auguries.
410 **Oedipus:** This is the man whom thou wouldst undermine,
411 **Oedipus:** In hope to reign with Creon in my stead.
412 **Oedipus:** Methinks that thou and thine abettor soon
413 **Oedipus:** Will rue your plot to drive the scapegoat out.
414 **Oedipus:** Thank thy grey hairs that thou hast still to learn
415 **Oedipus:** What chastisement such arrogance deserves.

Lines 402–403

402 **Oedipus:** A prophet? When the riddling Sphinx was here
403 **Oedipus:** Why hadst thou no deliverance for this folk?

Lines 480–511

480 **Chorus:** Who is he by voice immortal named from Pythia's rocky cell,
481 **Chorus:** Doer of foul deeds of bloodshed, horrors that no tongue can tell?
482 **Chorus:** A foot for flight he needs
483 **Chorus:** Fleeter than storm-swift steeds,
484 **Chorus:** For on his heels doth follow,
485 **Chorus:** Armed with the lightnings of his Sire, Apollo.
486 **Chorus:** Like sleuth-hounds too
487 **Chorus:** The Fates pursue.
488 **Chorus:** Yea, but now flashed forth the summons from Parnassus' snowy peak,
489 **Chorus:** "Near and far the undiscovered doer of this murder seek!"
490 **Chorus:** Now like a sullen bull he roves
491 **Chorus:** Through forest brakes and upland groves,
492 **Chorus:** And vainly seeks to fly
493 **Chorus:** The doom that ever nigh
494 **Chorus:** Flits o'er his head,
495 **Chorus:** Still by the avenging Phoebus sped,
496 **Chorus:** The voice divine,
497 **Chorus:** From Earth's mid shrine.
498 **Chorus:** Sore perplexèd am I by the words of the master seer.
499 **Chorus:** Are they true, are they false? I know not and bridle my tongue for fear,
500 **Chorus:** Fluttered with vague surmise; nor present nor future is clear.
501 **Chorus:** Quarrel of ancient date or in days still near know I none
502 **Chorus:** Twixt the Labdacidan house and our ruler, Polybus' son.
503 **Chorus:** Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King's good name,
504 **Chorus:** How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame?
505 **Chorus:** All wise are Zeus and Apollo, and nothing is hid from their ken;
506 **Chorus:** They are gods; and in wits a man may surpass his fellow men;
507 **Chorus:** But that a mortal seer knows more than I know—where
508 **Chorus:** Hath this been proven? Or how without sign assured, can I blame
509 **Chorus:** Him who saved our State when the wingèd songstress came,
510 **Chorus:** Tested and tried in the light of us all, like gold assayed?
511 **Chorus:** How can I now assent when a crime is on Oedipus laid?

Lines 490–497

490 **Chorus:** Now like a sullen bull he roves
491 **Chorus:** Through forest brakes and upland groves,
492 **Chorus:** And vainly seeks to fly
493 **Chorus:** The doom that ever nigh
494 **Chorus:** Flits o'er his head,

495 **Chorus:** Still by the avenging Phoebus sped,
496 **Chorus:** The voice divine,
497 **Chorus:** From Earth's mid shrine.

Lines 503–504
503 **Chorus:** Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King's good name,
504 **Chorus:** How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame?

Line 511
511 **Chorus:** How can I now assent when a crime is on Oedipus laid?

Lines 1237–1240
1237 **Second Messenger:** Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween,
1238 **Second Messenger:** Could wash away the blood-stains from this house,
1239 **Second Messenger:** The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light,
1240 **Second Messenger:** Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
assayed (verb)	tested to measure quality, as gold is tested	*All wise are Zeus and Apollo, and nothing is hid from their ken; They are gods; and in wits a man may surpass his fellow men; But that a mortal seer knows more than I know—where Hath this been proven? Or how without sign assured, can I blame Him who saved our State when the wingèd songstress came, Tested and tried in the light of us all, like gold assayed?*	

Discussion questions

1. How much evidence should we need before we believe an accusation against someone we trust?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with leadership and the city?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where does "the voice divine" come from? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: From Delphi, "Earth's mid shrine."

2. To what animal do the Chorus compare the killer? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A bull
3. Who is pursuing the killer in the ode? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The voice of Apollo (Phoebus)
4. How do the Chorus respond to Teiresias' accusation? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: They will not believe it without proof
5. What is a stasimon? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A choral ode between episodes
6. Why is the bull image ironic? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: It describes Oedipus without the Chorus knowing it
7. Retell the three most important events of "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof.
8. Who is on stage in "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Or how without sign assured, can I blame Him who saved our State when the wingèd songstress came, Tested and tried in the light of us all, like gold assayed?" What does "assayed" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: assayed: tested to measure quality, as gold is tested.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why are the elders torn? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: They respect the prophet but also owe Oedipus loyalty for saving the city.
2. What does "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)" suggest about the hunted man? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the theme in this scene shape what we understand about the hunted man? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community. Useful evidence: "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly

seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice " (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus): Chorus, lines 490–497. On theme: The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins "Strophe 1 Who is he by voice immortal named from Pythia's rocky cell, Doer of foul deeds of bloodshed, horrors that no tongue can tell?", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof.
7. How does "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)" build on "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community. Useful evidence: "Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King's good name, / How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame" (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus): Chorus, lines 503–504. Theme link: the hunted man. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community. Useful evidence: "Who is he by voice immortal named from Pythia's rocky cell, / Doer of foul deeds of bloodshed, horrors that no tongue can tell" (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: the hunted man. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: "How much evidence should we need before we believe an accusation against someone we trust?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with leadership and the city? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community. Useful evidence: "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The

voice ” (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus): Chorus, lines 490–497. On tone / mood: The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Are the Chorus wise or naive to wait for proof? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community. Useful evidence: “Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King’s good name, / How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame” (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus): Chorus, lines 503–504. On theme: The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community. Useful evidence: “Who is he by voice immortal named from Pythia’s rocky cell, / Doer of foul deeds of bloodshed, horrors that no tongue can tell” (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. On theme: The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community. Useful evidence: “Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o’er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice ” (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus): Chorus, lines 490–497. Theme link: the hunted man. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the hunted man. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1,

RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community. Useful evidence: “Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King’s good name, / How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame” (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus): Chorus, lines 503–504. Theme link: the hunted man. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community. Useful evidence: “Who is he by voice immortal named from Pythia’s rocky cell, / Doer of foul deeds of bloodshed, horrors that no tongue can tell” (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. On theme: The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to mercy: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community. Useful evidence: “Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o’er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice ” (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus): Chorus, lines 490–497. On theme: The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community. Useful evidence: “Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King’s good name, / How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame” (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus): Chorus, lines 503–504. On imagery: The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)” treats the hunted man with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus Rex see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2]

Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community. Useful evidence: “Who is he by voice immortal named from Pythia’s rocky cell, / Doer of foul deeds of bloodshed, horrors that no tongue can tell” (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. On theme: The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Episode 2 (lines 512–880)” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community. Useful evidence: “Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o’er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice ” (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus): Chorus, lines 490–497. Theme link: the hunted man. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the hunted man? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community. Useful evidence: “Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King’s good name, / How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame” (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus): Chorus, lines 503–504. On theme: The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Or how without sign assured, can I blame Him who saved our State when the wingèd songstress came, Tested and tried in the light of us all, like gold _____?” Word bank: assayed

   Key: assayed

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus: "Who is he by voice immortal named from Pythia's rocky cell, / Doer of foul deeds of _____, horrors that no tongue can tell"

   Key: bloodshed

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How do the Chorus respond to Teiresias' accusation?

   A. They demand Oedipus be killed

   B. They accept it at once

   C. They ignore it completely

   D. They will not believe it without proof

   Key: D (They will not believe it without proof)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] To what animal do the Chorus compare the killer?

   A. A snake

   B. A lion

   C. A bull

   D. An eagle

   Key: C (A bull)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus: "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er his head, / Still by the _____ Phoebus sped, / The voice divine, / From Earth's mid shrine"

   Key: avenging

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is a stasimon?

   A. A choral ode between episodes

   B. The prologue

   C. A soliloquy

   D. A messenger speech

   Key: A (A choral ode between episodes)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus: "Proof is there none: how then can I _____ our King's good name, / How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame"

   Key: challenge

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why is the bull image ironic?

   A. The Chorus means Creon

   B. It describes Oedipus without the Chorus knowing it

   C. Oedipus owns many bulls

   D. It refers to the Sphinx

   Key: B (It describes Oedipus without the Chorus knowing it)

9. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does "the voice divine" come from?

   Sample answer: From Delphi, "Earth's mid shrine."

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who is pursuing the killer in the ode?

    A. Teiresias

    B. The army of Corinth

    C. The voice of Apollo (Phoebus)

    D. Creon's guards

    Key: C (The voice of Apollo (Phoebus))

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why are the elders torn?

    Sample answer: They respect the prophet but also owe Oedipus loyalty for saving the city. The evidence is "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er…" (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 490–497.

12. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)"? The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof.

    A. Hyperbole

    B. Imagery

    C. Point of view

    D. Foreshadowing

    Key: B (Imagery)

13. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The hunted man.

    A. Knowledge and blindness

    B. Fate and responsibility

    C. Pride and fall

    D. Leadership and the city

    Key: A (Knowledge and blindness)

14. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: "The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice divine, / From Earth's mid shrine." (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus) supports it: The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof. But "Who is he by voice immortal named from Pythia's rocky cell, / Doer of foul deeds of bloodshed, horrors that no tongue can tell" (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus) complicates it: Chorus, in this part of the section, and its "no" marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. Weighing the two passages, the claim survives, but only once it admits the tension the second passage creates.

15. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how knowledge and blindness develops from Episode 1 (lines 214–479) to Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511). Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus, the text reads "And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness" — Oedipus, lines 246–248. In

Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er…" (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 490–497. The hunted man.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Are the Chorus wise or naive to wait for proof? Defend your view.

    Sample answer: A defended position: Chorus, lines 490–497. The evidence is "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er…" (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: the hunted man. The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Parodos (lines 156–213), lines 156–213? "Strophe 3 And grant that Ares whose hot breath I feel, Though without targe or steel He stalks, whose voice is as the battle shout, May turn in sudden rout, To the _____ Thracian waters sped, Or Amphitrite's bed."

    A. lightning

    B. downstriken

    C. snooded

    D. unharboured

    Key: D (unharboured)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 305–322: "What plague _____ our city; and we turn To thee, O seer, our one defense and shield." Word bank: begrudging, insolently, infects, miseries

    Key: infects

19. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Parodos (lines 156–213)?

    A. "Offspring of golden Hope, thou voice immortal, O tell me."

    B. "My soul is racked and shivers with fear. (Healer of Delos, hear!) Hast thou some pain unknown before, Or with the circling years renewest a…"

    C. "Goddess and sister, befriend, Artemis, Lady of Thebes, high-throned in the midst of our mart!"

    D. "Antistrophe 1 First on Athenè I call; O Zeus-born goddess, defend!"

    Key: B ("My soul is racked and shivers with fear. (Healer of Delos, hear!) Hast thou some pain unknown before, Or with the circling years renewest a…")

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), line 369 reveal about the character or situation? "Didst miss my sense wouldst thou goad me on?" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), line 369) shows the situation turning on knowledge and blindness: the story keeps returning to knowledge and blindness. The words "wouldst" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Episode 1 (lines 214–479)?

    A. "My liege, if any man sees eye to eye With our lord Phoebus, 'tis our prophet, lord Teiresias; he of all men best might guide A searcher of…"

B. “Aye, if there be a third best, tell it too.”

C. “Here too my zeal has nothing lagged, for twice At Creon’s instance have I sent to fetch him, And long I marvel why he is not here.”

D. “May I then say what seems next best to me?”

Key: D (“May I then say what seems next best to me?”)

22. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), line 301 reveal about the character or situation? “Words scare not him who blenches not at deeds.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), line 301) shows the situation turning on knowledge and blindness: the story keeps returning to knowledge and blindness. The words “blenches” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)?

A. “Quarrel of ancient date or in days still near know I none Twixt the Labdacidan house and our ruler, Polybus’ son.”

B. “I know not and bridle my tongue for fear, Fluttered with vague surmise; nor present nor future is clear.”

C. “Strophe 2 Sore perplexèd am I by the words of the master seer.”

D. “A foot for flight he needs Fleeter than storm-swift steeds, For on his heels doth follow, Armed with the lightnings of his Sire, Apollo.”

Key: D (“A foot for flight he needs Fleeter than storm-swift steeds, For on his heels doth follow, Armed with the lightnings of his Sire, Apollo.”)

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Parodos (lines 156–213), lines 156–213 shapes its tone: “Antistrophe 3 O that thine arrows too, Lycean King, From that taut bow’s gold string, Might fly abroad, the champions of our rights; Yea, and the flashing lights Of Artemis, wherewith the huntress sweeps Across the Lycian steeps.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “champions” and “wherewith” (Parodos (lines 156–213), lines 156–213) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and responsibility: the story keeps returning to fate and responsibility. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 377–378 shapes its tone: “I say thou livest with thy nearest kin In infamy, unwitting in thy shame.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “unwitting” and “nearest” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 377–378) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to leadership and the city: the story keeps returning to leadership and the city. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 333–335 shapes its tone: “Oh speak, Withhold not, I adjure thee, if thou know’st, Thy knowledge.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “knowledge” and “adjure” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 333–335) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and responsibility: the story keeps returning to fate and responsibility. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), line 285 to the story's treatment of pride and fall: “Aye, if there be a third best, tell it too.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), line 285) develops pride and fall: the story keeps returning to pride and fall. Its words its wording carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Here too my zeal has nothing lagged, for twice At Creon’s instance have I sent to fetch him, And long I marvel why he…” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), line 285), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating pride and fall as central.

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 327–328? “Let me go home; prevent me not; ’twere best That thou _____ bear thy burden and I mine.”

    A. shouldst

    B. miseries

    C. rumors

    D. profferest

    Key: A (shouldst)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 305–322 shapes its tone: “This is man’s highest end, To others’ service all his powers to lend.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “service” and “highest” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 305–322) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to leadership and the city: the story keeps returning to leadership and the city. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Parodos (lines 156–213), lines 188–189 to the story's treatment of mercy: “Golden child of Zeus, O hear Let thine angel face appear!” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Parodos (lines 156–213), lines 188–189) develops mercy: the story keeps returning to mercy. Its words “appear” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “If in the days of old when we nigh had perished, ye drave From our land the fiery plague, be near us now and defend us!” (Parodos (lines 156–213), lines 188–189), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating mercy as central.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 345–346 to the story's treatment of mercy: “Thou blam’st my mood and seest not thine own Wherewith thou art mated; no, thou taxest me.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 345–346) develops mercy: the story keeps returning to mercy. Its words “taxest” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Well, it will come what will, though I be mute.” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 345–346), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating mercy as central.

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 277–281: “The oath thou _____, sire, I take and swear.” Word bank: insolently, profferest, length, rumors
    Key: profferest

33. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 342–344: “Can nothing melt thee, Or shake thy dogged _____?” Word bank: profits, infects, taciturnity, begrudging
    Key: taciturnity

34. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 293–294? “I mind me too of _____ long ago— Mere gossip.”

    A. insolently

    B. profferest

    C. methinks

    D. rumors

    Key: D (rumors)

35. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Who is he by voice immortal named from Pythia’s rocky cell, / Doer of foul deeds of bloodshed, horrors that no tongue can tell” (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus)

    A. He knows it is imaginary.

    B. The title character, who will die halfway through.

    C. Second Messenger, lines 1237–1240.

    D. Chorus, in this part of the section.

    Key: D (Chorus, in this part of the section.)

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), line 387 shapes its tone: “No, for thy weird is not to fall by me.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words its wording (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), line 387) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and responsibility: the story keeps returning to fate and responsibility. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o’er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice divine, / From Earth’s mid shrine” (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus).

    Sample answer: The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof. The evidence is “Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o’er…” (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 490–497. This develops knowledge and blindness: the hunted man.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), line 511 to the story's treatment of pride and fall: “Strophe 2 Sore perplexèd am I by the words of the master seer.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), line 511) develops pride and fall: the story keeps returning to pride and fall. Its words “perplex” and “master” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “How can I now assent when a crime is on Oedipus laid?” (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), line 511), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating pride and fall as central.

39. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Complete the quotation from Parodos (lines 156–213), lines 156–213: “Your _____ aid I crave From death and ruin our city to save.” Word bank: threefold, countless, unharboured, goddess

    Key: threefold

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King's good name, / How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame" (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 503–504. The evidence is "Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King's good name, / How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame" (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: the hunted man. The words "untracked" and "challenge" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof.

41. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 402–403 to the story's treatment of mercy: "When the riddling Sphinx was here Why hadst thou no deliverance for this folk?" Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 402–403) develops mercy: the story keeps returning to mercy. Its words "deliverance" and "riddling" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "I slew him not myself, nor can I name The slayer." (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), lines 402–403), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating mercy as central.

42. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), line 356 to the story's treatment of pride and fall: "Thou methinks thou art he, Who planned the crime, aye, and performed it too, All save the assassination; and if thou Hadst not been blind, I had been sworn to boot That thou alone didst do the bloody deed." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), line 356) develops pride and fall: the story keeps returning to pride and fall. Its words "assassination" and "performed" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Yea, I am free, strong in the strength of truth." (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), line 356), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating pride and fall as central.

43. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice divine, / From Earth's mid shrine" (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 490–497. The evidence is "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er…" (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: the hunted man. The words "avenging" and "forest" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 1, analysis 2, synthesis 3
HS Freshman	10, 4, 2, 7, 8, 9, 6, 1, 5, 3, 11, 13, 12, 16, 15, 14	recall 10, inference 1, analysis 2, synthesis 3
HS Sophomore	17, 18, 6, 9, 8, 7, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2

HS Junior	28, 18, 4, 2, 9, 19, 22, 20, 23, 11, 29, 25, 26, 13, 30, 31	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	32, 18, 1, 2, 19, 21, 20, 11, 23, 24, 25, 26, 12, 30, 16, 15	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	33, 34, 1, 21, 11, 23, 35, 24, 26, 29, 36, 37, 30, 27, 16, 38	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	39, 17, 32, 4, 20, 35, 11, 29, 25, 26, 37, 13, 27, 14, 38, 40	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	4, 1, 5, 21, 22, 35, 24, 26, 29, 36, 13, 30, 31, 41, 14, 38	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	32, 10, 1, 19, 23, 24, 36, 26, 25, 12, 31, 41, 42, 15, 14, 38	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	1, 7, 4, 19, 35, 25, 29, 36, 13, 27, 41, 42, 15, 38, 43, 14	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	32, 1, 23, 35, 24, 25, 12, 13, 30, 31, 41, 42, 15, 38, 40, 16	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 8

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)," how does Sophocles show the hunted man? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): In Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), how does Sophocles develop the idea of the hunted man? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511) develops the idea of the hunted man. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the hunted man. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511) suggests about the hunted man. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses imagery in Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511) to complicate the reader's understanding of the hunted man. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Situate Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511) within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the hunted man responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Read Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511) alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the hunted man follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511) and its treatment of the hunted man. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop a research argument that reads Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511) as evidence for a larger claim about the hunted man in Oedipus Rex. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop an original argument that reads Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511) as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the hunted man. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Oedipus Rex.

SAT-style questions

1. *Strophe 1 Who is he by voice immortal named from Pythia's rocky cell, Doer of foul deeds of bloodshed, horrors that no tongue can tell? A foot for flight he needs Fleeter than storm-swift steeds, For on his heels doth follow, Armed with the lightnings of his Sire, Apollo. Like sleuth-hounds too The Fates pursue. Antistrophe 1 Yea, but now flashed forth the summons from Parnassus' snowy peak, "Near and far the undiscovered doer of this murder seek!" Now like a sullen bull he roves Through forest brakes and upland groves, And vainly seeks to fly The doom that ever nigh Flits o'er his head, Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, The voice divine, From Earth's mid shrine. Strophe 2 Sore perplexèd am I by the words of the master seer. Are they true, are they false? I know not and bridle my tongue for fear, Fluttered with vague surmise; nor present nor future is clear. Quarrel of ancient date or in days still near know I none Twixt the Labdacidan house and our ruler, Polybus' son. Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King's good name, How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame? Antistrophe 2 All wise are Zeus and Apollo, and nothing is hid from their ken; They are gods; and in wits a man may surpass his fellow men; But that a mortal seer knows more than I know—where Hath this been proven? Or how without sign assured, can I blame Him who saved our State when the*

wingèd songstress came, Tested and tried in the light of us all, like gold assayed? How can I now assent when a crime is on Oedipus laid?

Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)"?

A. The hunted man

B. Pride breeds the tyrant

C. A king who promises to find the truth

D. The herdsman and the recognition

SAT key: 1. A (The hunted man)

Lesson 6: Episode 2 (lines 512–880)

Focus: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in "Episode 2 (lines 512–880)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (mature themes, alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently. This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…stirred. A roisterer at some banquet, flown with wine, Shouted "Thou art not true son of thy…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: This section deals with mature themes in the play.
Suggested language: "What does this passage make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth after an oracle that he would kill his father and marry his mother, and of killing an old man and his servants at a crossroads. One hope remains: the surviving witness said "robbers."

Background: Exposing (abandoning) unwanted infants happened in the ancient Greek world. It was cruel and wrong; the play treats it as the root of the disaster.

Significance: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
When someone tries to reassure you, can it make things worse? Give an example. Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to knowledge and blindness because.... Content note before we start: This section deals with mature themes in the play.
Prompt: When someone tries to reassure you, can it make things worse? Give an example.
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to knowledge and blindness because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Two key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: infatuate — (archaic adjective) foolish; carried away by passion; prophetic — foretelling the future.
Words: infatuate: (archaic adjective) foolish; carried away by passion · prophetic: foretelling the future

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Exposing (abandoning) unwanted infants happened in the ancient Greek world. It was cruel and wrong; the play treats it as the root of the disaster. Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. Look closely: Jocasta's story of the three roads (lines 726–729 and after) is meant to comfort; ask students to note each detail that frightens Oedipus instead.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast." slowly and put it in my own words: Creon says he would be foolish to trade the real comforts he already has for the empty show of being king. Next, craft. I notice creon answers Oedipus' anger with a calm argument built on one contrast, shadow against substance. The strongest word is "shadow": the Chorus will later call all human life the shadow of a shade (line 1203). Then, effect. How does Creon's contrast between shadow and substance answer the charge that he is plotting? My answer: Creon's contrast answers the charge by arguing that a man who already holds the substance of power without its burdens has no motive to plot for its shadow, the crown; the calm reasoning shows up Oedipus' suspicion.

> *I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast.* *(Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Creon)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast." slowly and put it in my own words: Creon says he would be foolish to trade the real comforts he already has for the empty show of being king. Next, craft. I notice creon answers Oedipus' anger with a calm argument built on one contrast, shadow against substance. The strongest word is "shadow": the Chorus will later call all human life the shadow of a shade (line 1203). Then, effect. How does Creon's contrast between shadow and substance answer the charge that he is plotting? My answer: Creon's contrast answers the charge by arguing that a man who already holds the substance of power without its burdens has no motive to plot for its shadow, the crown; the calm reasoning shows up Oedipus' suspicion.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Exposing (abandoning) unwanted infants happened in the ancient Greek world. It was cruel and wrong; the play treats it as the root of the disaster. Read closely: "Listen and I'll convince thee that no man Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art." (Jocasta, lines 715–716). Ask: How does this line connect to knowledge and blindness? Expected: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. (Jocasta, lines 715–716.)

> *Listen and I'll convince thee that no man / Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art* *(Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Exposing (abandoning) unwanted infants happened in the ancient Greek world. It was cruel and wrong; the play treats it as the root of the disaster. Read closely: "Listen and I'll convince thee that no man Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art." (Jocasta, lines 715–716).
Ask: How does this line connect to knowledge and blindness?
Expected answer: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. (Jocasta, lines 715–716.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for irony, plot (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 2 (lines 512–880) develops the idea of Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. When the text says "As for the child, it was but three days old, / When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned / Together, gave it to be cast away / By others on the trackless mountain side" (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta), it shows this directly. Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth after an oracle that he would kill his father and marry his mother, and of killing an old man and his servants at a crossroads. One hope remains: the surviving witness said "robbers."

Task: Annotate the scene for irony, plot (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 2 (lines 512–880) develops the idea of Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. When the text says "As for the child, it was but three days old, / When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned / Together, gave it to be cast away / By others on the trackless mountain side" (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta), it shows this directly. Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth after an oracle that he would kill his father and marry his mother, and of killing an old man and his servants at a crossroads. One hope remains: the surviving witness said "robbers."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: When someone tries to reassure you, can it make things worse? Give an example. Ask: When someone tries to reassure you, can it make things worse? Give an example.

Anchor question: When someone tries to reassure you, can it make things worse? Give an example.

Facilitation: Ask: When someone tries to reassure you, can it make things worse? Give an example.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. ("As for the child, it was but three days old, / When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned / Together, gave it to be cast away / By others on the trackless mounta", Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. ("As for the child, it was but three days old, / When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned / Together, gave it to be cast away / By others on the trackless mounta", Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Key takeaway: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Irony:** Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth after an oracle that he would kill his father and marry his mother, and of killing an old man and his servants at a crossroads. One hope remains: the surviving witness said "robbers."
- **Plot:** Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth after an oracle that he would kill his father and marry his mother, and of killing an old man and his servants at a crossroads. One hope remains: the surviving witness said "robbers."
- **Characterization:** Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth after an oracle that he would kill his father and marry his mother, and of killing an old man and his servants at a crossroads. One hope remains: the surviving witness said "robbers."

Themes and how they develop

- **knowledge and blindness:** Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear.

Symbols and motifs

- **sight and blindness:** The section adds to the play's pattern of sight and blindness: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast" (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Creon) Creon, lines 596–597.
- "Listen and I'll convince thee that no man / Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art" (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta) Jocasta, lines 715–716.
- "As for the child, it was but three days old, / When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned / Together, gave it to be cast away / By others on the trackless mountain side" (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta) Jocasta, lines 726–729.
- "Yet was I quits with him and more; one stroke / Of my good staff sufficed to fling him clean / Out of the chariot seat and laid him prone. / And so I slew them every one" (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 827–830.
- "And this same curse / Was laid on me, and laid by none but me" (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 836–837.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly.
Evidence: "As for the child, it was but three days old, / When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned / Together, gave it to be cast away / By others on the trackless mountain side" (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta)
Reasoning: Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth after an oracle that he would kill his father and marry his mother, and of killing an old man and his servants at a crossroads. One hope remains: the surviving witness said "robbers."

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 490–497
490 **Chorus:** Now like a sullen bull he roves
491 **Chorus:** Through forest brakes and upland groves,
492 **Chorus:** And vainly seeks to fly
493 **Chorus:** The doom that ever nigh
494 **Chorus:** Flits o'er his head,
495 **Chorus:** Still by the avenging Phoebus sped,

496 **Chorus:** The voice divine,
497 **Chorus:** From Earth's mid shrine.

Lines 512–521

512 **Creon:** Friends, countrymen, I learn King Oedipus
513 **Creon:** Hath laid against me a most grievous charge,
514 **Creon:** And come to you protesting. If he deems
515 **Creon:** That I have harmed or injured him in aught
516 **Creon:** By word or deed in this our present trouble,
517 **Creon:** I care not to prolong the span of life,
518 **Creon:** Thus ill-reputed; for the calumny
519 **Creon:** Hits not a single blot, but blasts my name,
520 **Creon:** If by the general voice I am denounced
521 **Creon:** False to the State and false by you my friends.

Lines 522–523

522 **Chorus:** This taunt, it well may be, was blurted out
523 **Chorus:** In petulance, not spoken advisedly.

Line 529

529 **Chorus:** I know not; to my sovereign's acts I am blind.

Lines 529–530

529 **Chorus:** I know not; to my sovereign's acts I am blind.
530 **Chorus:** But lo, he comes to answer for himself.

Line 530

530 **Chorus:** But lo, he comes to answer for himself.

Lines 531–542

531 **Oedipus:** Sirrah, what mak'st thou here? Dost thou presume
532 **Oedipus:** To approach my doors, thou brazen-facèd rogue,
533 **Oedipus:** My murderer and the filcher of my crown?
534 **Oedipus:** Come, answer this, didst thou detect in me
535 **Oedipus:** Some touch of cowardice or witlessness,
536 **Oedipus:** That made thee undertake this enterprise?
537 **Oedipus:** I seemed forsooth too simple to perceive
538 **Oedipus:** The serpent stealing on me in the dark,
539 **Oedipus:** Or else too weak to scotch it when I saw.
540 **Oedipus:** This thou art witless seeking to possess
541 **Oedipus:** Without a following or friends the crown,
542 **Oedipus:** A prize that followers and wealth must win.

Line 543

543 **Creon:** Attend me. Thou hast spoken, 'tis my turn

Lines 543–544

543 **Creon:** Attend me. Thou hast spoken, 'tis my turn
544 **Creon:** To make reply. Then having heard me, judge.

Lines 545–546

545 **Oedipus:** Thou art glib of tongue, but I am slow to learn
546 **Oedipus:** Of thee; I know too well thy venomous hate.

Lines 553–554

553 **Creon:** Therein thou judgest rightly, but this wrong
554 **Creon:** That thou allegest—tell me what it is.

Line 563

563 **Creon:** Yes, skilled as now and in no less repute.

Line 564

564 **Oedipus:** Did he at that time ever glance at me?

Line 570

570 **Oedipus:** This much thou knowest and canst surely tell.

Lines 572–573

572 **Oedipus:** But for thy prompting never had the seer
573 **Oedipus:** Ascribed to me the death of Laius.

Line 576

576 **Oedipus:** Question and prove me murderer if thou canst.

Line 580

580 **Oedipus:** I grant her freely all her heart desires.

Line 582

582 **Oedipus:** Yea, and it is that proves thee a false friend.

Lines 596–597

596 **Creon:** I am not so infatuate as to grasp
597 **Creon:** The shadow when I hold the substance fast.

Lines 626–627

626 **Oedipus:** I would not have thee banished, no, but dead,
627 **Oedipus:** That men may mark the wages envy reaps.

Lines 642–647

642 **Jocasta:** Misguided princes, why have ye upraised
643 **Jocasta:** This wordy wrangle? Are ye not ashamed,
644 **Jocasta:** While the whole land lies striken, thus to voice
645 **Jocasta:** Your private injuries? Go in, my lord;

646 **Jocasta:** Go home, my brother, and forebear to make
647 **Jocasta:** A public scandal of a petty grief.

Line 658
658 **Chorus:** Hearken, King, reflect, we pray thee, but not stubborn but relent.

Lines 669–676
669 **Chorus:** No, by the leader of the host divine!
670 **Chorus:** Witness, thou Sun, such thought was never mine,
671 **Chorus:** Unblest, unfriended may I perish,
672 **Chorus:** If ever I such wish did cherish!
673 **Chorus:** But O my heart is desolate
674 **Chorus:** Musing on our striken State,
675 **Chorus:** Doubly fall'n should discord grow
676 **Chorus:** Twixt you twain, to crown our woe.

Lines 715–716
715 **Jocasta:** Listen and I'll convince thee that no man
716 **Jocasta:** Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art.

Lines 726–729
726 **Jocasta:** As for the child, it was but three days old,
727 **Jocasta:** When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned
728 **Jocasta:** Together, gave it to be cast away
729 **Jocasta:** By others on the trackless mountain side.

Lines 827–830
827 **Oedipus:** Yet was I quits with him and more; one stroke
828 **Oedipus:** Of my good staff sufficed to fling him clean
829 **Oedipus:** Out of the chariot seat and laid him prone.
830 **Oedipus:** And so I slew them every one. But if

Lines 836–837
836 **Oedipus:** To harry from their homes. And this same curse
837 **Oedipus:** Was laid on me, and laid by none but me.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
infatuate (adjective)	(archaic adjective) foolish; carried away by passion	*I am not so infatuate as to grasp The shadow when I hold the substance fast.*	
prophetic (adjective)	foretelling the future	*Listen and I'll convince thee that no man Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art.*	

Discussion questions

1. When someone tries to reassure you, can it make things worse? Give an example.
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with mercy?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What did the oracle tell Oedipus in Corinth? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: That he would kill his father and marry his mother (lines 805–809).
2. Why does Creon say he would not want the throne? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He already has power and ease without its burdens
3. Why does Jocasta tell the story of Laius' oracle? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To prove that prophecies cannot be trusted
4. What detail about Laius' death alarms Oedipus? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He was killed where three roads meet
5. What did happen to the infant in Jocasta's story? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: His ankles were pinned and he was given to be cast away on a mountain
6. What is Oedipus' remaining hope at the end of the episode? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The witness said Laius was killed by robbers, more than one
7. Retell the three most important events of "Episode 2 (lines 512–880)" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth after an oracle that he would kill his father and marry his mother, and of killing an old man and…
8. Who is on stage in "Episode 2 (lines 512–880)", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when does “Episode 2 (lines 512–880)” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “I am not so infatuate as to grasp The shadow when I hold the substance fast.” What does “infatuate” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: infatuate: (archaic adjective) foolish; carried away by passion.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Jocasta's comfort backfire? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Her details match Oedipus' own memory of the crossroads.
2. What does “Episode 2 (lines 512–880)” suggest about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the plot in this scene shape what we understand about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. Useful evidence: “I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Creon): Creon, lines 596–597. On plot: Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth after an oracle that he would kill his father and marry his mother, and of killing an old man and his servants at a crossroads. One hope remains: the surviving witness said "robbers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Friends, countrymen, I learn King Oedipus Hath laid against me a most grievous charge, And come to you protesting.”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Episode 2 (lines 512–880)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth…
7. How does “Episode 2 (lines 512–880)” build on “Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. Useful evidence: “Listen and I'll convince thee that no man / Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta): Jocasta, lines 715–716. Theme link: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. Useful evidence: “As for the child, it was but three days old, / When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned / Together, gave it to be cast away / By others on the trackless mountain side” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta): Jocasta, lines 726–729. On characterization: Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth after an oracle that he would kill his father and marry his mother, and of killing an old man and his servants at a crossroads. One hope remains: the surviving witness said "robbers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “When someone tries to reassure you, can it make things worse? Give an example.” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with mercy? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. Useful evidence: “Yet was I quits with him and more; one stroke / Of my good staff sufficed to fling him clean / Out of the chariot seat and laid him prone. / And so I slew them every one” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 827–830. On characterization: Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth after an oracle that he would kill his father and marry his mother, and of killing an old man and his servants at a crossroads. One hope remains: the surviving witness said "robbers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the killing at the crossroads (lines 827–830) self-defence, rage or fate? Argue with evidence. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys

them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. Useful evidence: “And this same curse / Was laid on me, and laid by none but me” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 836–837. Theme link: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. Useful evidence: “I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Creon): Creon, lines 596–597. Theme link: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. Useful evidence: “Listen and I'll convince thee that no man / Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta): Jocasta, lines 715–716. On characterization: Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth after an oracle that he would kill his father and marry his mother, and of killing an old man and his servants at a crossroads. One hope remains: the surviving witness said "robbers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Episode 2 (lines 512–880)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. Useful evidence: “As for the child, it was but three days old, / When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned / Together, gave it to be cast away / By others on the trackless mountain side” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta): Jocasta, lines 726–729. Theme link: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Episode 2 (lines 512–880)”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. Useful evidence: “Yet was I quits with him and more; one stroke / Of my good staff sufficed to fling him clean / Out of the chariot seat and laid him prone. / And so I slew them every one” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines

827–830. Theme link: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to knowledge and blindness: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. Useful evidence: “And this same curse / Was laid on me, and laid by none but me” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 836–837. Theme link: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. Useful evidence: “I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Creon): Creon, lines 596–597. On irony: Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth after an oracle that he would kill his father and marry his mother, and of killing an old man and his servants at a crossroads. One hope remains: the surviving witness said "robbers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Episode 2 (lines 512–880)” treats Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus Rex see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. Useful evidence: “Listen and I'll convince thee that no man / Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta): Jocasta, lines 715–716. Theme link: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. Useful evidence: “As for the child, it was but three days old, / When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned / Together, gave it to be cast away / By others on the trackless mountain side” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta): Jocasta, lines 726–729. Theme link: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. Useful evidence: "Yet was I quits with him and more; one stroke / Of my good staff sufficed to fling him clean / Out of the chariot seat and laid him prone. / And so I slew them every one" (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 827–830. Theme link: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What did happen to the infant in Jocasta's story?

    A. He was raised in the palace

    B. He was given to Creon

    C. His ankles were pinned and he was given to be cast away on a mountain

    D. He was sent to Delphi

    Key: C (His ankles were pinned and he was given to be cast away on a mountain)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why does Creon say he would not want the throne?

    A. He fears the Sphinx

    B. The oracle forbids it

    C. He already has power and ease without its burdens

    D. He is too old

    Key: C (He already has power and ease without its burdens)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Oedipus: "Yet was I quits with him and more; one stroke / Of my good staff _____ to fling him clean / Out of the chariot seat and laid him prone. / And so I slew them every one"

    Key: sufficed

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta: "Listen and I'll convince thee that no man / Hath scot or lot in the _____ art"

    Key: prophetic

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why does Jocasta tell the story of Laius' oracle?

    A. To accuse Creon

    B. To prove that prophecies cannot be trusted

    C. To confess a crime

D. To praise Apollo

Key: B (To prove that prophecies cannot be trusted)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta: "As for the child, it was but three days old, / When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned / Together, gave it to be cast away / By others on the _____ mountain side"

   Key: trackless

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "I am not so _____ as to grasp The shadow when I hold the substance fast." Word bank: infatuate, prophetic

   Key: infatuate

8. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What did the oracle tell Oedipus in Corinth?

   Sample answer: That he would kill his father and marry his mother (lines 805–809).

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What detail about Laius' death alarms Oedipus?

   A. He was killed in Corinth

   B. He died of plague

   C. He was killed by the Sphinx

   D. He was killed where three roads meet

   Key: D (He was killed where three roads meet)

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is Oedipus' remaining hope at the end of the episode?

    A. The witness said Laius was killed by robbers, more than one

    B. Teiresias will take back his words

    C. Polybus will come to help

    D. Jocasta will lie for him

    Key: A (The witness said Laius was killed by robbers, more than one)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Jocasta's comfort backfire?

    Sample answer: Her details match Oedipus' own memory of the crossroads. The evidence is "Yet was I quits with him and more; one stroke / Of my good staff sufficed to fling him clean / Out of the chariot seat and laid him prone…." (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 827–830.

12. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in "Episode 2 (lines 512–880)"? Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads…

    A. Tone / mood

    B. Irony

    C. Diction / vocabulary

    D. Hyperbole

    Key: B (Irony)

13. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear.

    A. Leadership and the city

    B. Fate and responsibility

C. Pride and fall

D. Knowledge and blindness

Key: D (Knowledge and blindness)

14. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how knowledge and blindness develops from Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511) to Episode 2 (lines 512–880). Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus, the text reads “Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o’er…” — Chorus, lines 490–497. In Episode 2 (lines 512–880), “I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Creon) — Creon, lines 596–597. Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear.

15. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is the killing at the crossroads (lines 827–830) self-defence, rage or fate? Argue with evidence.
Sample answer: A defended position: Jocasta, lines 715–716. The evidence is “Listen and I’ll convince thee that no man / Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta). This develops knowledge and blindness: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth after an oracle that he would kill his father and marry his mother, and of killing an old man and his servants at a crossroads. One hope remains: the surviving witness said "robbers.".

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Creon) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Creon, lines 596–597. The evidence is “I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Creon). This develops knowledge and blindness: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. The words “infatuate” and “substance” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth after an oracle that he would kill his father and marry his mother, and of killing an old man and his servants at a crossroads. One hope remains: the surviving witness said "robbers.".

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Creon: “I am not so _____ as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast”
Key: infatuate

18. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Creon) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Creon, lines 596–597. The evidence is “I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Creon). This develops knowledge and blindness: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear.

19. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “As for the child, it was but three days old, / When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned / Together, gave it to be cast away / By others on the trackless mountain side.” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880),

Jocasta) supports it: Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth after an oracle that he would kill his father and marry his mother, and of killing an old man and his servants at a crossroads. One hope remains: the surviving witness said "robbers.". But “I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Creon) complicates it: the line (Creon, lines 596–597) shows the same issue from another side, and its “not” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. So the claim stands only in a qualified form: true of the scene's main pattern, but not of every moment in it.

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 530? “But lo, he comes to answer for _____.”

    A. himself

    B. venomous

    C. kinsman

    D. witlessness

    Key: A (himself)

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 563? “Yes, _____ as now and in no less repute.”

    A. kinsman

    B. question

    C. failed

    D. skilled

    Key: D (skilled)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 570: “This much thou _____ and canst surely tell.” Word bank: question, monstrous, skilled, knowest

    Key: knowest

23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), lines 626–627 reveal about the character or situation? “I would not have thee banished, no, but dead, That men may mark the wages envy reaps.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), lines 626–627) shows the situation turning on knowledge and blindness: the story keeps returning to knowledge and blindness. The words “banished” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

24. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 543 reveal about the character or situation? “Thou hast spoken, ’tis my turn To make reply.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 543) shows the situation turning on knowledge and blindness: the story keeps returning to knowledge and blindness. The words “spoken” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Episode 2 (lines 512–880)?

    A. “But lo, he comes to answer for himself.”

    B. “I know not; to my sovereign’s acts I am blind.”

    C. “Were not his wits and vision all astray When upon me he fixed this monstrous charge?”

D. “Dost thou presume To approach my doors, thou brazen-facèd rogue, My murderer and the filcher of my crown?”

Key: C (“Were not his wits and vision all astray When upon me he fixed this monstrous charge?”)

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 658 shapes its tone: “Strophe 1 Hearken, King, reflect, we pray thee, but not stubborn but relent.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “stubborn” and “reflect” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 658) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and responsibility: the story keeps returning to fate and responsibility. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), lines 642–647 shapes its tone: “Are ye not ashamed, While the whole land lies striken, thus to voice Your private injuries?” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “injuries” and “private” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), lines 642–647) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to leadership and the city: the story keeps returning to leadership and the city. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Listen and I’ll convince thee that no man / Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Jocasta, lines 715–716. The evidence is “Listen and I’ll convince thee that no man / Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta). This develops knowledge and blindness: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. The words “prophetic” and “convince” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth after an oracle that he would kill his father and marry his mother, and of killing an old man and his servants at a crossroads. One hope remains: the surviving witness said "robbers.".

29. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), lines 545–546: “Thou art glib of tongue, but I am slow to learn Of thee; I know too well thy _____ hate.” Word bank: knowest, failed, witlessness, venomous
Key: venomous

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), lines 553–554 shapes its tone: “Therein thou judgest rightly, but this wrong That thou allegest—tell me what it is.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “allegest” and “rightly” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), lines 553–554) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to leadership and the city: the story keeps returning to leadership and the city. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), lines 572–573 to the story's treatment of mercy: “But for thy prompting never had the seer Ascribed to me the death of Laius.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), lines 572–573) develops mercy: the story keeps returning to mercy. Its words “prompting” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Question and prove me murderer if thou canst.” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), lines 572–573), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating mercy as central.

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), lines 512–521: “Friends, _____, I learn King Oedipus Hath laid against me a most grievous charge, And come to you protesting.” Word bank: failed, countrymen, venomous, question

    Key: countrymen

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “As for the child, it was but three days old, / When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned / Together, gave it to be cast away / By others on the trackless mountain side” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta).

    Sample answer: Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth after an oracle that he would kill his father and marry his mother, and of killing an old man and his servants at a crossroads. One hope remains: the surviving witness said "robbers.". The evidence is “As for the child, it was but three days old, / When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned / Together, gave it to be cast away / By others on…” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta) — Jocasta, lines 726–729. This develops knowledge and blindness: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 529 to the story's treatment of pride and fall: “I know not; to my sovereign’s acts I am blind.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 529) develops pride and fall: the story keeps returning to pride and fall. Its words “sovereign” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Dost thou presume To approach my doors, thou brazen-facèd rogue, My murderer and the filcher of my crown?” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 529), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating pride and fall as central.

35. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Episode 2 (lines 512–880)”?

    A. Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear

    B. The herdsman and the recognition

    C. A king who promises to find the truth

    D. The curse and the prophet

    Key: A (Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear)

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 564 shapes its tone: “Did he at that time ever glance at me?” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “glance” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 564) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and responsibility: the story keeps returning to fate and responsibility. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), lines 522–523 to the story's treatment of mercy: “Strophe 2 Witness, thou Sun, such thought was never mine, Unblest, unfriended may I perish, If ever I such wish did cherish!” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), lines 522–523) develops mercy: the story keeps returning to mercy. Its words “unfriended” and “thought” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “This taunt, it well may

be, was blurted out In petulance, not spoken advisedly." (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), lines 522–523), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating mercy as central.

38. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Listen and I'll convince thee that no man Hath scot or lot in the _____ art." Word bank: prophetic, infatuate
    Key: prophetic

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 580 to the story's treatment of pride and fall: "I grant her freely all her heart desires." Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 580) develops pride and fall: the story keeps returning to pride and fall. Its words "desires" and "freely" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Yea, and it is that proves thee a false friend." (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 580), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating pride and fall as central.

40. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Analyze the word choice in "As for the child, it was but three days old, / When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned / Together, gave it to be cast away / By others on the trackless mountain side" (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Jocasta, lines 726–729. The evidence is "As for the child, it was but three days old, / When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned / Together, gave it to be cast away / By others on…" (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta). This develops knowledge and blindness: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. The words "trackless" and "mountain" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 1, analysis 2, synthesis 3
HS Freshman	10, 4, 8, 5, 1, 6, 9, 2, 17, 3, 18, 11, 12, 13, 19, 14	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 2
HS Sophomore	6, 20, 2, 9, 21, 22, 23, 24, 11, 18, 25, 26, 27, 13, 19, 28	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	29, 20, 1, 6, 9, 3, 25, 11, 24, 23, 26, 12, 13, 30, 15, 31	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	2, 22, 10, 32, 5, 23, 11, 24, 25, 27, 30, 26, 33, 34, 15, 14	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	17, 29, 21, 2, 11, 35, 23, 26, 36, 30, 13, 27, 14, 31, 19, 37	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	3, 7, 2, 5, 35, 25, 11, 33, 30, 26, 36, 27, 14, 15, 37, 28	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	9, 17, 38, 25, 11, 24, 13, 26, 36, 12, 30, 31, 39, 15, 19, 37	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	5, 20, 17, 3, 25, 27, 13, 30, 40, 36, 15, 37, 31, 19, 14, 39	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	17, 6, 2, 5, 9, 12, 27, 26, 36, 15, 19, 37, 31, 16, 28, 14	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	3, 17, 2, 5, 9, 13, 36, 27, 15, 39, 37, 19, 14, 31, 34, 16	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 3, synthesis 8

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Episode 2 (lines 512–880)," how does Sophocles show Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1): In Episode 2 (lines 512–880), how does Sophocles develop the idea of Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Episode 2 (lines 512–880) develops the idea of Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Episode 2 (lines 512–880) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Episode 2 (lines 512–880) suggests about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and plot), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses irony in Episode 2 (lines 512–880) to complicate the reader's understanding of Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Situate Episode 2 (lines 512–880) within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Read Episode 2 (lines 512–880) alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Episode 2 (lines 512–

880) and its treatment of Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and plot, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop a research argument that reads Episode 2 (lines 512–880) as evidence for a larger claim about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear in Oedipus Rex. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop an original argument that reads Episode 2 (lines 512–880) as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Oedipus Rex.

SAT-style questions

1. *Friends, countrymen, I learn King Oedipus Hath laid against me a most grievous charge, And come to you protesting. If he deems That I have harmed or injured him in aught By word or deed in this our present trouble, I care not to prolong the span of life, Thus ill-reputed; for the calumny Hits not a single blot, but blasts my name, If by the general voice I am denounced False to the State and false by you my friends.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 2 (lines 512–880)"?

   A. A hopeful guess

   B. A city praying for rescue

   C. Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear

   D. A king who promises to find the truth

SAT key: 1. C (Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear)

Lesson 7: Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)

Focus: pride breeds the tyrant

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921) (pride breeds the tyrant) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1

Teacher only · spoilers

The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing.

Background: "Tyrant" (Greek tyrannos) first meant a ruler who took power by his own means, not necessarily a cruel one; the word's meaning darkened over time (Online Etymology Dictionary, n.d.-e).

Significance: The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What is the difference between confidence and arrogance? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to knowledge and blindness because....
Prompt: What is the difference between confidence and arrogance?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to knowledge and blindness because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: pride breeds the tyrant.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Two key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: tyrant — in ancient Greece, a ruler who held power by his own means; today, a cruel ruler. surfeited — overfed; having too much of something.
Words: tyrant: in ancient Greece, a ruler who held power by his own means; today, a cruel ruler · surfeited: overfed; having too much of something

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
"Tyrant" (Greek tyrannos) first meant a ruler who took power by his own means, not necessarily a cruel one; the word's meaning darkened over time (Online Etymology Dictionary, n.d.-e). The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold. Look closely: Tyrant (Greek tyrannos) first meant a ruler who took power by his own means, not necessarily a cruel one (Online Etymology Dictionary, n.d.-e).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne." slowly and put it in my own words: The elders say that insolence, arrogant pride, breeds the tyrant; swollen with empty wealth, it climbs a steep height and seizes the throne. Next, craft. I notice insolence is personified as a climber, and the steep height already suggests the fall. The strongest word is "insolence": Storr's word for the Greek hubris, arrogant pride that defies the gods. Then, effect. How does the picture of insolence climbing to the throne warn about power? My answer: The picture of insolence climbing to the throne warns that power seized by pride stands on a precipice: the higher it climbs, the steeper the fall, a warning the elders name no one with but the audience can apply to the royal house.

> *Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne.* *(Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), lines 890–893)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne." slowly and put it in my own words: The elders say that insolence, arrogant pride, breeds the tyrant; swollen with empty wealth, it climbs a steep height and seizes the throne. Next, craft. I notice insolence is personified as a climber, and the steep height already suggests the fall. The strongest word is "insolence": Storr's word for the Greek hubris, arrogant pride that defies the gods. Then, effect. How does the picture of insolence climbing to the throne warn about power? My answer: The picture of insolence climbing to the throne warns that power seized by pride stands on a precipice: the higher it climbs, the steeper the fall, a warning the elders name no one with but the audience can apply to the royal house.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Read closely: "Who when such deeds are done / Can hope heaven's bolts to shun?" (Chorus, lines 907–908). Ask: What climbs "the precipitous height" in lines 890–893? Expected: Insolence, full-blown and surfeited with riches. Ask: Does the Chorus mean Oedipus by "the tyrant"? Explain. Expected: Possibly a warning to him, though not named; open to argument.

> *Who when such deeds are done / Can hope heaven's bolts to shun?* *(Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus)*

Ask: What climbs "the precipitous height" in lines 890–893?
Expected answer: Insolence, full-blown and surfeited with riches.
Ask: Does the Chorus mean Oedipus by "the tyrant"? Explain.
Expected answer: Possibly a warning to him, though not named; open to argument.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the ode for theme (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this ode suggest about pride breeds the tyrant? Exemplar: The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold. The lines "Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne." (lines 890–893) are the evidence.
Task: Annotate the ode for theme (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this ode suggest about pride breeds the tyrant?
Exemplar: The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold. The lines "Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne." (lines 890–893) are the evidence.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What is the difference between confidence and arrogance? Ask: Does the play show Oedipus as guilty of hubris? Use this ode and one other scene.
Anchor question: What is the difference between confidence and arrogance?
Facilitation: Ask: Does the play show Oedipus as guilty of hubris? Use this ode and one other scene. · Ask for the line that proves each answer.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: How does the picture of insolence climbing to the throne warn about power? Model answer: The picture of insolence climbing to the throne warns that power seized by pride stands on a precipice: the higher it climbs, the steeper the fall, a warning the elders name no one with but the audience can apply to the royal house.
Exit ticket: How does the picture of insolence climbing to the throne warn about power?
Answer: The picture of insolence climbing to the throne warns that power seized by pride stands on a precipice: the higher it climbs, the steeper the fall, a warning the elders name no one with but the audience can apply to the royal house.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how theme shapes pride breeds the tyrant. Key takeaway: pride breeds the tyrant.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Theme:** The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing.

- **Diction / vocabulary:** The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing.
- **Tone / mood:** The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing.

Themes and how they develop

- **knowledge and blindness:** pride breeds the tyrant.

Symbols and motifs

- **sight and blindness:** The section adds to the play's pattern of sight and blindness: pride breeds the tyrant.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne" (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus) Chorus, lines 890–893.
- "Who when such deeds are done / Can hope heaven's bolts to shun" (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus) Chorus, lines 907–908.
- "My lot be still to lead / The life of innocence and fly" (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus) Chorus, in this part of the section.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold.
Evidence: "Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne" (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus)
Reasoning: The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 480–511
480 **Chorus:** Who is he by voice immortal named from Pythia's rocky cell,
481 **Chorus:** Doer of foul deeds of bloodshed, horrors that no tongue can tell?
482 **Chorus:** A foot for flight he needs
483 **Chorus:** Fleeter than storm-swift steeds,
484 **Chorus:** For on his heels doth follow,
485 **Chorus:** Armed with the lightnings of his Sire, Apollo.
486 **Chorus:** Like sleuth-hounds too
487 **Chorus:** The Fates pursue.
488 **Chorus:** Yea, but now flashed forth the summons from Parnassus' snowy peak,
489 **Chorus:** "Near and far the undiscovered doer of this murder seek!"
490 **Chorus:** Now like a sullen bull he roves

491 **Chorus:** Through forest brakes and upland groves,
492 **Chorus:** And vainly seeks to fly
493 **Chorus:** The doom that ever nigh
494 **Chorus:** Flits o'er his head,
495 **Chorus:** Still by the avenging Phoebus sped,
496 **Chorus:** The voice divine,
497 **Chorus:** From Earth's mid shrine.
498 **Chorus:** Sore perplexèd am I by the words of the master seer.
499 **Chorus:** Are they true, are they false? I know not and bridle my tongue for fear,
500 **Chorus:** Fluttered with vague surmise; nor present nor future is clear.
501 **Chorus:** Quarrel of ancient date or in days still near know I none
502 **Chorus:** Twixt the Labdacidan house and our ruler, Polybus' son.
503 **Chorus:** Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King's good name,
504 **Chorus:** How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame?
505 **Chorus:** All wise are Zeus and Apollo, and nothing is hid from their ken;
506 **Chorus:** They are gods; and in wits a man may surpass his fellow men;
507 **Chorus:** But that a mortal seer knows more than I know—where
508 **Chorus:** Hath this been proven? Or how without sign assured, can I blame
509 **Chorus:** Him who saved our State when the wingèd songstress came,
510 **Chorus:** Tested and tried in the light of us all, like gold assayed?
511 **Chorus:** How can I now assent when a crime is on Oedipus laid?

Lines 501–502

501 **Chorus:** Quarrel of ancient date or in days still near know I none
502 **Chorus:** Twixt the Labdacidan house and our ruler, Polybus' son.

Lines 522–523

522 **Chorus:** This taunt, it well may be, was blurted out
523 **Chorus:** In petulance, not spoken advisedly.

Lines 524–525

524 **Creon:** Did any dare pretend that it was I
525 **Creon:** Prompted the seer to utter a forged charge?

Lines 531–542

531 **Oedipus:** Sirrah, what mak'st thou here? Dost thou presume
532 **Oedipus:** To approach my doors, thou brazen-facèd rogue,
533 **Oedipus:** My murderer and the filcher of my crown?
534 **Oedipus:** Come, answer this, didst thou detect in me
535 **Oedipus:** Some touch of cowardice or witlessness,
536 **Oedipus:** That made thee undertake this enterprise?
537 **Oedipus:** I seemed forsooth too simple to perceive
538 **Oedipus:** The serpent stealing on me in the dark,
539 **Oedipus:** Or else too weak to scotch it when I saw.
540 **Oedipus:** This thou art witless seeking to possess

541 **Oedipus:** Without a following or friends the crown,
542 **Oedipus:** A prize that followers and wealth must win.

Line 547
547 **Creon:** First I would argue out this very point.

Lines 551–552
551 **Oedipus:** If thou dost hold a kinsman may be wronged,
552 **Oedipus:** And no pains follow, thou art much to seek.

Line 558
558 **Oedipus:** Tell me how long is it since Laius…

Line 562
562 **Oedipus:** Did the same prophet then pursue his craft?

Line 565
565 **Creon:** Not to my knowledge, not when I was by.

Line 567
567 **Creon:** Surely full quest was made, but nothing learnt.

Line 569
569 **Creon:** I know not, and not knowing hold my tongue.

Lines 574–575
574 **Creon:** If so he thou knowest best; but I
575 **Creon:** Would put thee to the question in my turn.

Line 576
576 **Oedipus:** Question and prove me murderer if thou canst.

Line 582
582 **Oedipus:** Yea, and it is that proves thee a false friend.

Lines 596–597
596 **Creon:** I am not so infatuate as to grasp
597 **Creon:** The shadow when I hold the substance fast.

Line 638
638 **Creon:** Thy Thebans? am not I a Theban too?

Lines 648–650
648 **Creon:** My royal sister, Oedipus, thy lord,
649 **Creon:** Hath bid me choose (O dread alternative!)
650 **Creon:** An outlaw's exile or a felon's death.

Lines 653–654

653 **Creon:** May I ne'er speed but die accursed, if I
654 **Creon:** In any way am guilty of this charge.

Line 664

664 **Oedipus:** Declare it then and make thy meaning plain.

Lines 667–668

667 **Oedipus:** Bethink you that in seeking this ye seek
668 **Oedipus:** In very sooth my death or banishment?

Lines 881–921

881 **Chorus:** My lot be still to lead
882 **Chorus:** The life of innocence and fly
883 **Chorus:** Irreverence in word or deed,
884 **Chorus:** To follow still those laws ordained on high
885 **Chorus:** Whose birthplace is the bright ethereal sky.
886 **Chorus:** No mortal birth they own,
887 **Chorus:** Olympus their progenitor alone:
888 **Chorus:** Ne'er shall they slumber in oblivion cold,
889 **Chorus:** The god in them is strong and grows not old.
890 **Chorus:** Of insolence is bred
891 **Chorus:** The tyrant; insolence full blown,
892 **Chorus:** With empty riches surfeited,
893 **Chorus:** Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne.
894 **Chorus:** Then topples o'er and lies in ruin prone;
895 **Chorus:** No foothold on that dizzy steep.
896 **Chorus:** But O may Heaven the true patriot keep
897 **Chorus:** Who burns with emulous zeal to serve the State.
898 **Chorus:** God is my help and hope, on him I wait.
899 **Chorus:** But the proud sinner, or in word or deed,
900 **Chorus:** That will not Justice heed,
901 **Chorus:** Nor reverence the shrine
902 **Chorus:** Of images divine,
903 **Chorus:** Perdition seize his vain imaginings,
904 **Chorus:** If, urged by greed profane,
905 **Chorus:** He grasps at ill-got gain,
906 **Chorus:** And lays an impious hand on holiest things.
907 **Chorus:** Who when such deeds are done
908 **Chorus:** Can hope heaven's bolts to shun?
909 **Chorus:** If sin like this to honor can aspire,
910 **Chorus:** Why dance I still and lead the sacred choir?
911 **Chorus:** No more I'll seek earth's central oracle,
912 **Chorus:** Or Abae's hallowed cell,
913 **Chorus:** Nor to Olympia bring

914 **Chorus:** My votive offering.
915 **Chorus:** If before all God's truth be not bade plain.
916 **Chorus:** O Zeus, reveal thy might,
917 **Chorus:** King, if thou'rt named aright
918 **Chorus:** Omnipotent, all-seeing, as of old;
919 **Chorus:** For Laius is forgot;
920 **Chorus:** His weird, men heed it not;
921 **Chorus:** Apollo is forsook and faith grows cold.

Lines 886–889
886 **Chorus:** No mortal birth they own,
887 **Chorus:** Olympus their progenitor alone:
888 **Chorus:** Ne'er shall they slumber in oblivion cold,
889 **Chorus:** The god in them is strong and grows not old.

Lines 890–893
890 **Chorus:** Of insolence is bred
891 **Chorus:** The tyrant; insolence full blown,
892 **Chorus:** With empty riches surfeited,
893 **Chorus:** Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne.

Lines 894–895
894 **Chorus:** Then topples o'er and lies in ruin prone;
895 **Chorus:** No foothold on that dizzy steep.

Lines 907–908
907 **Chorus:** Who when such deeds are done
908 **Chorus:** Can hope heaven's bolts to shun?

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
tyrant (noun)	in ancient Greece, a ruler who held power by his own means; today, a cruel ruler	*Of insolence is bred The tyrant; insolence full blown, With empty riches surfeited, Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne.*	
surfeited (verb)	overfed; having too much of something	*Of insolence is bred The tyrant; insolence full blown, With empty riches surfeited, Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne.*	

Discussion questions

1. What is the difference between confidence and arrogance?
2. Where does theme appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with knowledge and blindness?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What climbs "the precipitous height" in lines 890–893? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Insolence, full-blown and surfeited with riches.
2. According to the Chorus, what breeds the tyrant? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Insolence (pride)
3. What happens to insolence that climbs too high? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: It falls
4. What do the elders fear if the oracles prove false? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: That reverence for the gods will fail
5. What is the tone of this ode? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Solemn and anxious
6. Which word in the ode names excessive pride? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Insolence
7. Retell the three most important events of "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing.
8. Who is on stage in "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Antistrophe 1 Of insolence is bred The tyrant; insolence full blown, With empty riches surfeited, Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne." What does "surfeited" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: surfeited: overfed; having too much of something.

Inferential / analytical

1. Does the Chorus mean Oedipus by "the tyrant"? Explain. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Possibly a warning to him, though not named; open to argument.
2. What does “Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)” suggest about pride breeds the tyrant? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold.
3. Find one example of theme in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
4. How does the diction / vocabulary in this scene shape what we understand about pride breeds the tyrant? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold. Useful evidence: “Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne” (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus): Chorus, lines 890–893. On diction / vocabulary: The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Strophe 1 My lot be still to lead The life of innocence and fly Irreverence in word or deed, To follow still those laws ordained on high Whose birthplace is the bright ethereal…”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing.
7. How does “Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)” build on “Episode 2 (lines 512–880)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold. Useful evidence: “Who when such deeds are done / Can hope heaven’s bolts to shun” (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus): Chorus, lines 907–908. Theme link: pride breeds the tyrant. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride

and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold. Useful evidence: “My lot be still to lead / The life of innocence and fly” (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: pride breeds the tyrant. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “What is the difference between confidence and arrogance?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with knowledge and blindness? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold. Useful evidence: “Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne” (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus): Chorus, lines 890–893. On tone / mood: The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does the play show Oedipus as guilty of hubris? Use this ode and one other scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold. Useful evidence: “Who when such deeds are done / Can hope heaven’s bolts to shun” (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus): Chorus, lines 907–908. On theme: The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold. Useful evidence: “My lot be still to lead / The life of innocence and fly” (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. On theme: The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride

and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold. Useful evidence: “Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne” (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus): Chorus, lines 890–893. Theme link: pride breeds the tyrant. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of pride breeds the tyrant. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold. Useful evidence: “Who when such deeds are done / Can hope heaven’s bolts to shun” (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus): Chorus, lines 907–908. Theme link: pride breeds the tyrant. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold. Useful evidence: “My lot be still to lead / The life of innocence and fly” (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. On theme: The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate and responsibility: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold. Useful evidence: “Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne” (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus): Chorus, lines 890–893. On theme: The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the theme in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold. Useful evidence: “Who when such deeds are done / Can hope heaven’s bolts to shun” (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus): Chorus, lines 907–908. On theme: The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)” treats pride breeds the tyrant with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus Rex see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold. Useful evidence: “My lot be still to lead / The life of innocence and fly” (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. On theme: The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold. Useful evidence: “Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne” (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus): Chorus, lines 890–893. Theme link: pride breeds the tyrant. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about pride breeds the tyrant? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold. Useful evidence: “Who when such deeds are done / Can hope heaven’s bolts to shun” (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus): Chorus, lines 907–908. On theme: The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), lines 524–525? “Did any dare _____ that it was I Prompted the seer to utter a forged charge?”
   A. pretend
   B. himself
   C. venomous

D. knowledge

Key: A (pretend)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] According to the Chorus, what breeds the tyrant?

   A. Insolence (pride)

   B. Poverty

   C. Plague

   D. Prophecy

   Key: A (Insolence (pride))

3. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What climbs "the precipitous height" in lines 890–893?

   Sample answer: Insolence, full-blown and surfeited with riches.

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus: “Who when such deeds are done / Can hope _____’s bolts to shun”

   Key: heaven

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Antistrophe 1 Of insolence is bred The tyrant; insolence full blown, With empty riches _____, Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne.” Word bank: surfeited

   Key: surfeited

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus: “My lot be still to lead / The life of _____ and fly”

   Key: innocence

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), lines 886–889: “No mortal birth they own, Olympus their _____ alone: Ne’er shall they slumber in oblivion cold, The god in them is strong and grows not old.” Word bank: aspire, progenitor, before, patriot

   Key: progenitor

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), lines 881–921? “If _____ all God’s truth be not bade plain.”

   A. before

   B. aspire

   C. patriot

   D. progenitor

   Key: A (before)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What happens to insolence that climbs too high?

   A. It is rewarded

   B. It is forgotten

   C. It falls

   D. It becomes wisdom

   Key: C (It falls)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), lines 522–523 reveal about the character or situation? “This taunt, it well may be, was blurted out In petulance, not spoken advisedly.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), lines 522–523) shows the situation turning on knowledge and

blindness: the story keeps returning to knowledge and blindness. The words “petulance” and “advisedly” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 576 reveal about the character or situation? “Question and prove me murderer if thou canst.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 576) shows the situation turning on knowledge and blindness: the story keeps returning to knowledge and blindness. The words “murderer” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.
12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Does the Chorus mean Oedipus by "the tyrant"? Explain.
    Sample answer: Possibly a warning to him, though not named; open to argument. The evidence is “Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the…” (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 890–893.
13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), lines 881–921 reveal about the character or situation? “Antistrophe 2 No more I’ll seek earth’s central oracle, Or Abae’s hallowed cell, Nor to Olympia bring My votive offering.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The passage (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), lines 881–921) shows the situation turning on knowledge and blindness: the story keeps returning to knowledge and blindness. The words “offering” and “hallowed” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.
14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 638 shapes its tone: “Thy Thebans? am not I a Theban too?” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words its wording (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 638) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and responsibility: the story keeps returning to fate and responsibility. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which literary element does this describe in “Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)”? The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing.
    A. Foreshadowing
    B. Theme
    C. Imagery
    D. Characterization

    Key: B (Theme)
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Does the play show Oedipus as guilty of hubris? Use this ode and one other scene.
    Sample answer: A defended position: Chorus, in this part of the section. The evidence is “My lot be still to lead / The life of innocence and fly” (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: pride breeds the tyrant. The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing.
17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), lines 574–575? “If so he thou knowest best; but I Would put thee to the _____ in my turn.”
    A. pretend

B. knowest

C. himself

D. question

Key: D (question)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), lines 551–552? "If thou dost hold a _____ may be wronged, And no pains follow, thou art much to seek."

A. pretend

B. question

C. venomous

D. kinsman

Key: D (kinsman)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the elders fear if the oracles prove false?

A. That the Sphinx will return

B. That Creon will become king

C. That Corinth will attack

D. That reverence for the gods will fail

Key: D (That reverence for the gods will fail)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which word in the ode names excessive pride?

A. Riches

B. Insolence

C. Throne

D. Height

Key: B (Insolence)

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), lines 501–502 shapes its tone: "Quarrel of ancient date or in days still near know I none Twixt the Labdacidan house and our ruler, Polybus' son." Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words "ancient" (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), lines 501–502) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and responsibility: the story keeps returning to fate and responsibility. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 582 shapes its tone: "Yea, and it is that proves thee a false friend." Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words "friend" and "proves" (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 582) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to leadership and the city: the story keeps returning to leadership and the city. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 547 shapes its tone: "First I would argue out this very point." Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words its wording (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 547) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than

neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and responsibility: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 567 to the story's treatment of pride and fall: “Surely full quest was made, but nothing learnt.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 567) develops pride and fall: the story keeps returning to pride and fall. Its words “nothing” and “learnt” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “I know not, and not knowing hold my tongue.” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 567), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating pride and fall as central.

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 565: “Not to my _____, not when I was by.” Word bank: knowledge, monstrous, himself, advise
    Key: knowledge

26. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)”?
    A. Pride breeds the tyrant
    B. Good news that is not good
    C. A city praying for rescue
    D. The herdsman and the recognition

    Key: A (Pride breeds the tyrant)

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 558 to the story's treatment of mercy: “Tell me how long is it since Laius …” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 558) develops mercy: the story keeps returning to mercy. Its words its wording carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Did the same prophet then pursue his craft?” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 558), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating mercy as central.

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What is the tone of this ode?
    A. Indifferent
    B. Solemn and anxious
    C. Triumphant
    D. Comic

    Key: B (Solemn and anxious)

29. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Pride breeds the tyrant.
    A. Knowledge and blindness
    B. Leadership and the city
    C. Mercy
    D. Fate and responsibility

    Key: A (Knowledge and blindness)

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), lines 894–895 shapes its tone: “Then topples o’er and lies in ruin prone; No foothold on

that dizzy steep." Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words "foothold" and "topples" (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), lines 894–895) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to leadership and the city: the story keeps returning to leadership and the city. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

31. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), lines 531–542 shapes its tone: "Dost thou presume To approach my doors, thou brazen-facèd rogue, My murderer and the filcher of my crown?" Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "murderer" and "approach" (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), lines 531–542) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to leadership and the city: the story keeps returning to leadership and the city. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), lines 648–650 to the story's treatment of mercy: "My royal sister, Oedipus, thy lord, Hath bid me choose (O dread alternative!) An outlaw's exile or a felon's death." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), lines 648–650) develops mercy: the story keeps returning to mercy. Its words "alternative" and "outlaw" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "May I ne'er speed but die accursed, if I In any way am guilty of this charge." (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), lines 648–650), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating mercy as central.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: "The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. "Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne" (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus) supports it: The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing. But "My lot be still to lead / The life of innocence and fly" (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus) complicates it: Chorus, in this part of the section, and its "still" marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. The claim is therefore a strong reading, not a complete one, and a careful answer says where it stops applying.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 664 to the story's treatment of pride and fall: "Declare it then and make thy meaning plain." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 664) develops pride and fall: the story keeps returning to pride and fall. Its words "meaning" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Bethink you that in seeking this ye seek In very sooth my death or banishment?" (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), line 664), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating pride and fall as central.

35. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Analyze the word choice in "My lot be still to lead / The life of innocence and fly" (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Chorus, in this part of the section. The evidence is "My lot be still to lead / The life of innocence and fly" (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: pride breeds the tyrant. The words "innocence" and "still" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

36. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus: "Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the

_____ height and grasps the throne"

Key: precipitous

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Synthesis: trace how knowledge and blindness develops from Episode 2 (lines 512–880) to Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921). Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Creon, the text reads "I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast" — Creon, lines 596–597. In Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), "Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the…" (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 890–893. Pride breeds the tyrant.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Who when such deeds are done / Can hope heaven's bolts to shun" (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 907–908. The evidence is "Who when such deeds are done / Can hope heaven's bolts to shun" (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: pride breeds the tyrant. The words "heaven" and "bolts" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 7, 5, 3, 9, 19, 20, 10, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	1, 25, 18, 20, 5, 19, 11, 10, 26, 12, 13, 21, 14, 22, 27, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	25, 7, 6, 8, 28, 11, 10, 12, 26, 13, 21, 14, 29, 30, 27, 24	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	28, 5, 20, 2, 4, 9, 11, 10, 12, 21, 22, 23, 31, 32, 27, 33	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	17, 8, 6, 7, 2, 9, 11, 21, 23, 31, 22, 30, 34, 32, 16, 33	recall 6, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	17, 7, 2, 5, 9, 12, 26, 21, 23, 22, 30, 35, 27, 32, 34, 33	recall 5, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	36, 19, 7, 2, 9, 10, 23, 22, 31, 15, 30, 27, 34, 24, 32, 37	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	2, 19, 5, 7, 9, 21, 31, 23, 35, 29, 34, 24, 33, 38, 16, 37	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	19, 36, 7, 2, 9, 21, 23, 14, 29, 32, 24, 34, 27, 16, 37, 33	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	28, 36, 7, 2, 9, 21, 31, 15, 30, 34, 32, 27, 24, 16, 37, 33	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 7

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)," how does Sophocles show pride breeds the tyrant? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the theme you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1): In Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), how does Sophocles develop the idea of pride breeds the tyrant? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the theme in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921) develops the idea of pride breeds the tyrant. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its theme shape the reader's understanding of pride breeds the tyrant. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921) suggests about pride breeds the tyrant. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's theme and diction / vocabulary), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses theme in Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921) to complicate the reader's understanding of pride breeds the tyrant. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Situate Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921) within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of pride breeds the tyrant responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Read Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921) alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of pride breeds the tyrant follows or bends those conventions, using the theme as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921) and its treatment of pride breeds the tyrant. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's theme and diction / vocabulary, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop a research argument that reads Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921) as evidence for a larger claim about pride breeds the tyrant in Oedipus Rex. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop an original

argument that reads Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921) as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of pride breeds the tyrant. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Oedipus Rex.

SAT-style questions

1. *Strophe 1 My lot be still to lead The life of innocence and fly Irreverence in word or deed, To follow still those laws ordained on high Whose birthplace is the bright ethereal sky. No mortal birth they own, Olympus their progenitor alone: Ne'er shall they slumber in oblivion cold, The god in them is strong and grows not old. Antistrophe 1 Of insolence is bred The tyrant; insolence full blown, With empty riches surfeited, Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne. Then topples o'er and lies in ruin prone; No foothold on that dizzy steep. But O may Heaven the true patriot keep Who burns with emulous zeal to serve the State. God is my help and hope, on him I wait. Strophe 2 But the proud sinner, or in word or deed, That will not Justice heed, Nor reverence the shrine Of images divine, Perdition seize his vain imaginings, If, urged by greed profane, He grasps at ill-got gain, And lays an impious hand on holiest things. Who when such deeds are done Can hope heaven's bolts to shun? If sin like this to honor can aspire, Why dance I still and lead the sacred choir? Antistrophe 2 No more I'll seek earth's central oracle, Or Abae's hallowed cell, Nor to Olympia bring My votive offering. If before all God's truth be not bade plain. O Zeus, reveal thy might, King, if thou'rt named aright Omnipotent, all-seeing, as of old; For Laius is forgot; His weird, men heed it not; Apollo is forsook and faith grows cold.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)"?

   A. Pride breeds the tyrant

   B. A hopeful guess

   C. A king who promises to find the truth

   D. The herdsman and the recognition

SAT key: 1. A (Pride breeds the tyrant)

Lesson 8: Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)

Focus: good news that is not good

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (mature themes): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently.
Student preview: This section deals with mature themes in the play.
Suggested language: "What does this passage make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and leaves. Oedipus thinks she is ashamed of his low birth and calls himself the child of Fortune.

Background: Slavery was legal and common in ancient Greece. Owning a person is wrong; the play's casual talk of a "bondwoman" and of being "triply a slave" (lines 1078–1080) reflects that society. Slavery still exists today (International Labour Organization et al., 2022).

Significance: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might someone prefer not to know a painful truth about themselves? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to knowledge and blindness because.... Content note before we start: This section deals with mature themes in the play.
Prompt: Why might someone prefer not to know a painful truth about themselves?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to knowledge and blindness because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: good news that is not good.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Two key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: bondwoman — (archaic) an enslaved woman; foreknowledge — knowledge of something before it happens.
Words: bondwoman: (archaic) an enslaved woman · foreknowledge: knowledge of something before it happens

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Slavery was legal and common in ancient Greece. Owning a person is wrong; the play's casual talk of a "bondwoman" and of being "triply a slave" (lines 1078–1080) reflects that society. Slavery still exists today (International Labour Organization et al., 2022). Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition. Look closely: Jocasta understands before Oedipus does; her plea to stop searching is a recognition before his recognition.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus." slowly and put it in my own words: Hearing that Polybus, whom he believes is his father, has died a natural death, Oedipus declares the oracles worthless. Next, craft. I notice the words pile up, dust, ashes, nothing, and dead is said twice, so the celebration sounds almost violent. The strongest word is "dead": the oracles he calls dead are about to come true. Then, effect. Why is the celebration of dead oracles a turning point? My answer: The celebration of dead oracles is a turning point because the same messenger who brings the news will show that Polybus was not his father, so the oracles Oedipus calls dead are about to be proved true.

> *But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus.* *(Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus." slowly and put it in my own words: Hearing that Polybus, whom he believes is his father, has died a natural death, Oedipus declares the oracles worthless. Next, craft. I notice the words pile up, dust, ashes, nothing, and dead is said twice, so the celebration sounds almost violent. The strongest word is "dead": the oracles he calls dead are about to come true. Then, effect. Why is the celebration of dead oracles a turning point? My answer: The celebration of dead oracles is a turning point because the same messenger who brings the news will show that Polybus was not his father, so the oracles Oedipus calls dead are about to be proved true.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Slavery was legal and common in ancient Greece. Owning a person is wrong; the play's casual talk of a "bondwoman" and of being "triply a slave" (lines 1078–1080) reflects that society. Slavery still exists today (International Labour Organization et al., 2022). Read closely: "Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid? Best live a careless life from hand to mouth." (Jocasta, lines 991–993). Ask: How does this line connect to knowledge and blindness? Expected: Good news that is not good. (Jocasta, lines 991–993.)

> *Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, / With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid? / Best live a careless life from hand to mouth* (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Jocasta)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Slavery was legal and common in ancient Greece. Owning a person is wrong; the play's casual talk of a "bondwoman" and of being "triply a slave" (lines 1078–1080) reflects that society. Slavery still exists today (International Labour Organization et al., 2022). Read closely: "Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid? Best live a careless life from hand to mouth." (Jocasta, lines 991–993).
Ask: How does this line connect to knowledge and blindness?
Expected answer: Good news that is not good. (Jocasta, lines 991–993.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for irony, plot (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about good news that is not good? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 3 (lines 922–1102) develops the idea of good news that is not good. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition. When the text says "She is my mother and the changing moons / My brethren, and with them I wax and wane. / Thus sprung why should I fear to trace my birth? / Nothing can make me other than I am" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus), it shows this directly. A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and leaves. Oedipus thinks she is ashamed of his low birth and calls himself the child of Fortune.

Task: Annotate the scene for irony, plot (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about good news that is not good? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 3 (lines 922–1102) develops the idea of good news that is not good. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition. When the text says "She is my mother and the changing moons / My brethren, and with them I wax and wane. / Thus sprung why should I fear to trace my birth? / Nothing can make me other than I am" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus), it shows this directly. A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and leaves. Oedipus thinks she is ashamed of his low birth and calls himself the child of Fortune.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Why might someone prefer not to know a painful truth about themselves? Ask: Why might someone prefer not to know a painful truth about themselves?

Anchor question: Why might someone prefer not to know a painful truth about themselves?

Facilitation: Ask: Why might someone prefer not to know a painful truth about themselves?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about good news that is not good? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition. ("She is my mother and the changing moons / My brethren, and with them I wax and wane. / Thus sprung why should I fear to trace my birth? / Nothing can make me ot", Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about good news that is not good? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition. ("She is my mother and the changing moons / My brethren, and with them I wax and wane. / Thus sprung why should I fear to trace my birth? / Nothing can make me ot", Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes good news that is not good. Key takeaway: good news that is not good.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Irony:** A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and leaves. Oedipus thinks she is ashamed of his low birth and calls himself the child of Fortune.
- **Plot:** A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and leaves. Oedipus thinks she is ashamed of his low birth and calls himself the child of Fortune.
- **Characterization:** A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and leaves. Oedipus thinks she is ashamed of his low birth and calls himself the child of Fortune.

Themes and how they develop

- **knowledge and blindness:** good news that is not good.

Symbols and motifs

- **sight and blindness:** The section adds to the play's pattern of sight and blindness: good news that is not good.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 985–986.
- "Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, / With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid? / Best live a careless life from hand to mouth" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Jocasta) Jocasta, lines 991–993.
- "Be of good cheer; though I be proved the son / Of a bondwoman, aye, through three descents / Triply a slave, thy honor is unsmirched" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 1078–1080.
- "Ah mayst thou ne'er discover who thou art" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Jocasta) Jocasta, lines 1085.
- "She is my mother and the changing moons / My brethren, and with them I wax and wane. / Thus sprung why should I fear to trace my birth? / Nothing can make me other than I am" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 1099–1102.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition.
Evidence: "She is my mother and the changing moons / My brethren, and with them I wax and wane. / Thus sprung why should I fear to trace my birth? / Nothing can make me other than I am" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus)
Reasoning: A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and leaves. Oedipus thinks she is ashamed of his low birth and calls himself the child of Fortune.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 890–893
890 **Chorus:** Of insolence is bred
891 **Chorus:** The tyrant; insolence full blown,
892 **Chorus:** With empty riches surfeited,
893 **Chorus:** Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne.

Lines 922–923
922 **Jocasta:** My lords, ye look amazed to see your queen
923 **Jocasta:** With wreaths and gifts of incense in her hands.

Lines 922–936

922 **Jocasta:** My lords, ye look amazed to see your queen
923 **Jocasta:** With wreaths and gifts of incense in her hands.
924 **Jocasta:** I had a mind to visit the high shrines,
925 **Jocasta:** For Oedipus is overwrought, alarmed
926 **Jocasta:** With terrors manifold. He will not use
927 **Jocasta:** His past experience, like a man of sense,
928 **Jocasta:** To judge the present need, but lends an ear
929 **Jocasta:** To any croaker if he augurs ill.
930 **Jocasta:** Since then my counsels naught avail, I turn
931 **Jocasta:** To thee, our present help in time of trouble,
932 **Jocasta:** Apollo, Lord Lycean, and to thee
933 **Jocasta:** My prayers and supplications here I bring.
934 **Jocasta:** Lighten us, lord, and cleanse us from this curse!
935 **Jocasta:** For now we all are cowed like mariners
936 **Jocasta:** Who see their helmsman dumbstruck in the storm.

Lines 930–933

930 **Jocasta:** Since then my counsels naught avail, I turn
931 **Jocasta:** To thee, our present help in time of trouble,
932 **Jocasta:** Apollo, Lord Lycean, and to thee
933 **Jocasta:** My prayers and supplications here I bring.

Lines 937–938

937 **Messenger:** My masters, tell me where the palace is
938 **Messenger:** Of Oedipus; or better, where's the king.

Lines 943–944

943 **Jocasta:** My greetings to thee, stranger; thy fair words
944 **Jocasta:** Deserve a like response. But tell me why

Lines 943–945

943 **Jocasta:** My greetings to thee, stranger; thy fair words
944 **Jocasta:** Deserve a like response. But tell me why
945 **Jocasta:** Thou comest—what thy need or what thy news.

Line 946

946 **Messenger:** Good for thy consort and the royal house.

Lines 948–950

948 **Messenger:** From Corinth I. The message wherewithal
949 **Messenger:** I stand entrusted thou shalt hear anon.
950 **Messenger:** 'Twill please thee surely, yet perchance offend.

Line 956

956 **Jocasta:** What! is he dead, the sire of Oedipus?

Lines 958–962

958 **Jocasta:** Quick, maiden, bear these tidings to my lord.
959 **Jocasta:** Ye god-sent oracles, where stand ye now!
960 **Jocasta:** This is the man whom Oedipus long shunned,
961 **Jocasta:** In dread to prove his murderer; and now
962 **Jocasta:** He dies in nature's course, not by his hand.

Line 968

968 **Oedipus:** Who is this man, and what his news for me?

Lines 972–973

972 **Messenger:** If I must first make plain beyond a doubt
973 **Messenger:** My message, know that Polybus is dead.

Line 977

977 **Messenger:** Yes, having measured the full span of years.

Lines 985–986

985 **Oedipus:** But, as they stand, the oracles are dead—
986 **Oedipus:** Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus.

Lines 991–993

991 **Jocasta:** Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance,
992 **Jocasta:** With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid?
993 **Jocasta:** Best live a careless life from hand to mouth.

Line 1001

1001 **Jocasta:** And yet thy sire's death lights out darkness much.

Lines 1008–1013

1008 **Oedipus:** Aye, 'tis no secret. Loxias once foretold
1009 **Oedipus:** That I should mate with mine own mother, and shed
1010 **Oedipus:** With my own hands the blood of my own sire.
1011 **Oedipus:** Hence Corinth was for many a year to me
1012 **Oedipus:** A home distant; and I trove abroad,
1013 **Oedipus:** But missed the sweetest sight, my parents' face.

Lines 1011–1013

1011 **Oedipus:** Hence Corinth was for many a year to me
1012 **Oedipus:** A home distant; and I trove abroad,
1013 **Oedipus:** But missed the sweetest sight, my parents' face.

Line 1015

1015 **Oedipus:** Yea, and the dread of slaying my own sire.

Line 1021

1021 **Oedipus:** Nay, I will ne'er go near my parents more.

Line 1024
1024 **Messenger:** If this is why thou dreadest to return.

Line 1028
1028 **Messenger:** Dost thou not know thy fears are baseless all?

Line 1034
1034 **Messenger:** Since I begat thee not, no more did he.

Lines 1078–1080
1078 **Oedipus:** Be of good cheer; though I be proved the son
1079 **Oedipus:** Of a bondwoman, aye, through three descents
1080 **Oedipus:** Triply a slave, thy honor is unsmirched.

Line 1085
1085 **Jocasta:** Ah mayst thou ne'er discover who thou art!

Lines 1099–1102
1099 **Oedipus:** She is my mother and the changing moons
1100 **Oedipus:** My brethren, and with them I wax and wane.
1101 **Oedipus:** Thus sprung why should I fear to trace my birth?
1102 **Oedipus:** Nothing can make me other than I am.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
bondwoman (noun)	(archaic) an enslaved woman	*Be of good cheer; though I be proved the son Of a bondwoman, aye, through three descents Triply a slave, thy honor is unsmirched.*	
foreknowledge (noun)	knowledge of something before it happens	*Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid?*	

Discussion questions

1. Why might someone prefer not to know a painful truth about themselves?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and responsibility?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20,

21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Jocasta say about chance in lines 991–993? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A mortal is the sport of chance and should live carelessly, without fear.
2. What news does the Corinthian messenger bring? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Polybus is dead and Corinth wants Oedipus as king
3. Why does Oedipus still fear going to Corinth? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He fears the prophecy about his mother
4. Where did the messenger receive the infant Oedipus? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: On Mount Cithaeron, from a herdsman of Laius
5. Why does Jocasta beg Oedipus to stop searching? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She has realized the truth
6. Whom does Oedipus call his mother in lines 1099–1102? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Fortune (Chance)
7. Retell the three most important events of "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and…
8. Who is on stage in "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Be of good cheer; though I be proved the son Of a bondwoman, aye, through three descents Triply a slave, thy honor is unsmirched." What does "bondwoman" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: bondwoman: (archaic) an enslaved woman.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Oedipus misread Jocasta's distress? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: He thinks she fears he is of low or enslaved birth.

2. What does “Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)” suggest about good news that is not good? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the plot in this scene shape what we understand about good news that is not good? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition. Useful evidence: “But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus” (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 985–986. On plot: A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and leaves. Oedipus thinks she is ashamed of his low birth and calls himself the child of Fortune. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid?”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the…
7. How does “Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)” build on “Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition. Useful evidence: “Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, / With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid? / Best live a careless life from hand to mouth” (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Jocasta): Jocasta, lines 991–993. Theme link: good news that is not good. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition. Useful evidence: “Be of

good cheer; though I be proved the son / Of a bondwoman, aye, through three descents / Triply a slave, thy honor is unsmirched" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1078–1080. On characterization: A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and leaves. Oedipus thinks she is ashamed of his low birth and calls himself the child of Fortune. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: "Why might someone prefer not to know a painful truth about themselves?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and responsibility? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition. Useful evidence: "Ah mayst thou ne'er discover who thou art" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Jocasta): Jocasta, lines 1085. On characterization: A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and leaves. Oedipus thinks she is ashamed of his low birth and calls himself the child of Fortune. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Jocasta right that it is better not to know? Argue with evidence from this episode. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition. Useful evidence: "She is my mother and the changing moons / My brethren, and with them I wax and wane. / Thus sprung why should I fear to trace my birth? / Nothing can make me other than I am" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1099–1102. Theme link: good news that is not good. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: "Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition. Useful evidence: "But, as

they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 985–986. Theme link: good news that is not good. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition. Useful evidence: "Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, / With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid? / Best live a careless life from hand to mouth" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Jocasta): Jocasta, lines 991–993. On characterization: A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and leaves. Oedipus thinks she is ashamed of his low birth and calls himself the child of Fortune. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of good news that is not good. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition. Useful evidence: "Be of good cheer; though I be proved the son / Of a bondwoman, aye, through three descents / Triply a slave, thy honor is unsmirched" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1078–1080. Theme link: good news that is not good. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition. Useful evidence: "Ah mayst thou ne'er discover who thou art" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Jocasta): Jocasta, lines 1085. Theme link: good news that is not good. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to pride and fall: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition. Useful evidence: "She is my mother and the changing moons / My brethren, and with them I wax and wane. / Thus sprung why should I fear to trace my birth? / Nothing can make me other than I am" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102),

Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1099–1102. Theme link: good news that is not good. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition. Useful evidence: “But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus” (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 985–986. On irony: A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and leaves. Oedipus thinks she is ashamed of his low birth and calls himself the child of Fortune. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)” treats good news that is not good with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus Rex see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition. Useful evidence: “Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, / With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid? / Best live a careless life from hand to mouth” (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Jocasta): Jocasta, lines 991–993. Theme link: good news that is not good. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition. Useful evidence: “Be of good cheer; though I be proved the son / Of a bondwoman, aye, through three descents / Triply a slave, thy honor is unsmirched” (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1078–1080. Theme link: good news that is not good. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about good news that is not good? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition. Useful evidence: “Ah mayst thou ne’er discover who thou art” (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Jocasta): Jocasta, lines 1085. Theme link: good news that is not good. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does Oedipus call his mother in lines 1099–1102?

   A. Fortune (Chance)

   B. Jocasta

   C. Merope

   D. The Sphinx

   Key: A (Fortune (Chance))

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus: "Be of good cheer; though I be proved the son / Of a bondwoman, aye, through three descents / Triply a slave, thy honor is _____"

   Key: unsmirched

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why does Oedipus still fear going to Corinth?

   A. He fears the plague there

   B. He fears the Corinthian army

   C. He fears the prophecy about his mother

   D. He fears Creon will follow

   Key: C (He fears the prophecy about his mother)

4. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Jocasta say about chance in lines 991–993?

   Sample answer: A mortal is the sport of chance and should live carelessly, without fear.

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Jocasta: "Ah mayst thou ne'er _____ who thou art"

   Key: discover

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What news does the Corinthian messenger bring?

   A. Laius is alive

   B. Thebes is at war

   C. Teiresias has died

   D. Polybus is dead and Corinth wants Oedipus as king

   Key: D (Polybus is dead and Corinth wants Oedipus as king)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Jocasta: "Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, / With no assured _____, be afraid? / Best live a careless life from hand to mouth"

   Key: foreknowledge

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where did the messenger receive the infant Oedipus?

   A. On Mount Cithaeron, from a herdsman of Laius

B. At Delphi

C. In the palace at Corinth

D. At the crossroads

Key: A (On Mount Cithaeron, from a herdsman of Laius)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus: "But, as they stand, the _____ are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus"
   Key: oracles

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why does Jocasta beg Oedipus to stop searching?

    A. She has realized the truth

    B. She wants to go to Corinth

    C. She is angry at Creon

    D. She thinks the messenger is lying

    Key: A (She has realized the truth)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 985–986. The evidence is "But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus). This develops knowledge and blindness: good news that is not good.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Oedipus misread Jocasta's distress?
    Sample answer: He thinks she fears he is of low or enslaved birth. The evidence is "She is my mother and the changing moons / My brethren, and with them I wax and wane. / Thus sprung why should I fear to trace my birth? /…" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1099–1102.

13. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "She is my mother and the changing moons / My brethren, and with them I wax and wane. / Thus sprung why should I fear to trace my birth? / Nothing can make me other than I am" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus).
    Sample answer: A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and leaves. Oedipus thinks she is ashamed of his low birth and calls himself the child of Fortune. The evidence is "She is my mother and the changing moons / My brethren, and with them I wax and wane. / Thus sprung why should I fear to trace my birth? /…" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1099–1102. This develops knowledge and blindness: good news that is not good.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Good news that is not good.

    A. Knowledge and blindness

    B. Fate and responsibility

    C. Pride and fall

    D. Leadership and the city

    Key: A (Knowledge and blindness)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)"? A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger…

    A. Allusion

    B. Symbolism

    C. Structure

    D. Irony

    Key: D (Irony)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Jocasta right that it is better not to know? Argue with evidence from this episode.

    Sample answer: A defended position: Jocasta, lines 991–993. The evidence is "Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, / With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid? / Best live a careless life from hand to mouth" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Jocasta). This develops knowledge and blindness: good news that is not good. A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and leaves. Oedipus thinks she is ashamed of his low birth and calls himself the child of Fortune.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, With no assured _____, be afraid?" Word bank: foreknowledge, bondwoman

    Key: foreknowledge

18. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how knowledge and blindness develops from Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921) to Episode 3 (lines 922–1102). Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus, the text reads "Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the…" — Chorus, lines 890–893. In Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), "But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 985–986. Good news that is not good.

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), lines 948–950: "The message _____ I stand entrusted thou shalt hear anon. 'Twill please thee surely, yet perchance offend." Word bank: cleanse, comest, happiness, wherewithal

    Key: wherewithal

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Be of good cheer; though I be proved the son Of a _____, aye, through three descents Triply a slave, thy honor is unsmirched." Word bank: bondwoman, foreknowledge

    Key: bondwoman

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), lines 937–938? "My _____, tell me where the palace is Of Oedipus; or better, where's the king."

    A. masters

    B. inspiring

    C. murderer

    D. foretell

    Key: A (masters)

22. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 968 reveal about the character or situation? "Who is this man, and what his news for me?" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 968) shows the situation turning on knowledge and blindness: the story keeps returning to knowledge and blindness. The words its wording are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 1028 reveal about the character or situation? "Dost thou not know thy fears are baseless all?" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 1028) shows the situation turning on knowledge and blindness: the story keeps returning to knowledge and blindness. The words "baseless" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)"?

    A. The curse and the prophet
    B. Good news that is not good
    C. Pride breeds the tyrant
    D. The herdsman and the recognition

    Key: B (Good news that is not good)

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)?

    A. "He will not use His past experience, like a man of sense, To judge the present need, but lends an ear To any croaker if he augurs ill."
    B. "I had a mind to visit the high shrines, For Oedipus is overwrought, alarmed With terrors manifold."
    C. "Since then my counsels naught avail, I turn To thee, our present help in time of trouble, Apollo, Lord Lycean, and to thee My prayers and…"
    D. "My lords, ye look amazed to see your queen With wreaths and gifts of incense in her hands."

    Key: D ("My lords, ye look amazed to see your queen With wreaths and gifts of incense in her hands.")

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 1034 shapes its tone: "Since I begat thee not, no more did he." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words its wording (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 1034) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to leadership and the city: the story keeps returning to leadership and the city. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 1001 shapes its tone: "And yet thy sire's death lights out darkness much." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "darkness" and "lights" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 1001) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and responsibility: the story keeps returning to fate and responsibility. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 977 shapes its tone: "Yes, having measured the full span of years." Pick two words and

explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words "measured" and "having" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 977) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to leadership and the city: the story keeps returning to leadership and the city. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 956 to the story's treatment of pride and fall: "What! is he dead, the sire of Oedipus?" Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 956) develops pride and fall: the story keeps returning to pride and fall. Its words its wording carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Quick, maiden, bear these tidings to my lord." (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 956), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating pride and fall as central.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), lines 1011–1013 to the story's treatment of mercy: "Hence Corinth was for many a year to me A home distant; and I trove abroad, But missed the sweetest sight, my parents' face." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), lines 1011–1013) develops mercy: the story keeps returning to mercy. Its words "sweetest" and "distant" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Yea, and the dread of slaying my own sire." (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), lines 1011–1013), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating mercy as central.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), lines 972–973: "If I must first make plain beyond a doubt My _____, know that Polybus is dead." Word bank: message, comest, experience, verily

    Key: message

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), lines 922–923: "My lords, ye look amazed to see your queen With _____ and gifts of incense in her hands." Word bank: comest, wherewithal, masters, wreaths

    Key: wreaths

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), lines 930–933 shapes its tone: "Since then my counsels naught avail, I turn To thee, our present help in time of trouble, Apollo, Lord Lycean, and to thee My prayers and supplications here I bring." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "supplications" and "counsels" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), lines 930–933) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and responsibility: the story keeps returning to fate and responsibility. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

34. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in "Be of good cheer; though I be proved the son / Of a bondwoman, aye, through three descents / Triply a slave, thy honor is unsmirched" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1078–1080. The evidence is "Be of good cheer; though I be proved the son / Of a bondwoman, aye, through three descents / Triply a slave, thy honor is unsmirched" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus). This develops knowledge and blindness: good news that is not good. The words "unsmirched" and "bondwoman" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), lines 943–944 to the story's treatment of mercy: "My greetings to thee, stranger; thy fair words Deserve a

like response." Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), lines 943–944) develops mercy: the story keeps returning to mercy. Its words "greetings" and "response" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Good for thy consort and the royal house." (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), lines 943–944), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating mercy as central.

36. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? "Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, / With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid? / Best live a careless life from hand to mouth" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Jocasta) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Jocasta, lines 991–993. The evidence is "Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, / With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid? / Best live a careless life from hand to mouth" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Jocasta).

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: "Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. "She is my mother and the changing moons / My brethren, and with them I wax and wane. / Thus sprung why should I fear to trace my birth? / Nothing can make me other than I am." (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus) supports it: A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and leaves. Oedipus thinks she is ashamed of his low birth and calls himself the child of Fortune. But "But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus) complicates it: the line (Oedipus, lines 985–986) shows the same issue from another side, and its "But" marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. A fair verdict is that the claim is mostly right but overstated; it needs a limiting clause to cover that passage.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Connect this passage from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 1021 to the story's treatment of pride and fall: "Nay, I will ne'er go near my parents more." Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 1021) develops pride and fall: the story keeps returning to pride and fall. Its words "parents" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "If this is why thou dreadest to return." (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 1021), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating pride and fall as central.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, / With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid? / Best live a careless life from hand to mouth" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Jocasta) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Jocasta, lines 991–993. The evidence is "Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, / With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid? / Best live a careless life from hand to mouth" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Jocasta). This develops knowledge and blindness: good news that is not good. The words "foreknowledge" and "careless" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and leaves. Oedipus thinks she is ashamed of his low birth and calls himself the child of Fortune.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 985–986. The evidence is "But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus). This develops knowledge and blindness: good news that is not good. The words "oracles" and "nothing" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and leaves. Oedipus thinks she is ashamed of his low birth and calls himself the child of Fortune.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	3, 17, 5, 1, 10, 8, 4, 9, 2, 6, 12, 11, 13, 14, 15, 18	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	19, 8, 1, 20, 5, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 12, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	6, 10, 31, 17, 32, 8, 12, 22, 25, 23, 33, 34, 13, 28, 35, 29	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	32, 3, 6, 5, 25, 22, 11, 12, 24, 26, 14, 28, 27, 16, 29, 30	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	20, 8, 19, 23, 36, 25, 22, 14, 13, 27, 15, 33, 35, 37, 16, 29	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	9, 8, 21, 2, 11, 23, 22, 15, 14, 33, 26, 27, 37, 38, 29, 35	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	3, 32, 17, 6, 25, 22, 28, 13, 33, 14, 27, 30, 35, 38, 16, 29	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	5, 32, 6, 3, 25, 33, 26, 13, 14, 27, 39, 37, 16, 38, 29, 30	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	32, 9, 6, 3, 24, 13, 14, 27, 28, 30, 18, 29, 40, 38, 35, 39	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 4, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	19, 9, 6, 3, 25, 15, 13, 27, 30, 37, 38, 29, 18, 16, 35, 40	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 3, synthesis 8

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)," how does Sophocles show good news that is not good? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1): In Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), how does Sophocles develop the idea of good news that is not good? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Episode 3 (lines 922–1102) develops the idea of good news that is not good. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of

textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Episode 3 (lines 922–1102) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of good news that is not good. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Episode 3 (lines 922–1102) suggests about good news that is not good. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and plot), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses irony in Episode 3 (lines 922–1102) to complicate the reader's understanding of good news that is not good. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Situate Episode 3 (lines 922–1102) within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of good news that is not good responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Read Episode 3 (lines 922–1102) alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of good news that is not good follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Episode 3 (lines 922–1102) and its treatment of good news that is not good. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and plot, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop a research argument that reads Episode 3 (lines 922–1102) as evidence for a larger claim about good news that is not good in Oedipus Rex. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop an original argument that reads Episode 3 (lines 922–1102) as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of good news that is not good. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist,

psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Oedipus Rex.

SAT-style questions

1. *Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid? Best live a careless life from hand to mouth. This wedlock with thy mother fear not thou. How oft it chances that in dreams a man Has wed his mother! He who least regards Such brainsick fantasies lives most at ease.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)"?

   A. A king who promises to find the truth

   B. Good news that is not good

   C. A city praying for rescue

   D. The shadow of a shade

SAT key: 1. B (Good news that is not good)

Lesson 9: Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)

Focus: a hopeful guess

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114) (a hopeful guess) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1

Teacher only · spoilers

The Chorus joyfully guesses that Oedipus was born on Mount Cithaeron, perhaps the child of a god such as Pan, Apollo, Hermes or Bacchus and a mountain nymph.

Background: Greek myths often told of heroes fathered by gods on mountains.

Significance: This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic "false dawn."

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might a writer put a happy moment just before a disaster? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to knowledge and blindness because....
Prompt: Why might a writer put a happy moment just before a disaster?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to knowledge and blindness because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: a hopeful guess.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
One key word in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: nymph — in Greek myth, a minor goddess of nature.
Words: nymph: in Greek myth, a minor goddess of nature

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Greek myths often told of heroes fathered by gods on mountains. This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic "false dawn." Look closely: Greek myths often told of heroes fathered by gods on mountains; the brief, happy ode is placed just before the Herdsman arrives.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow's full moon rises, and exalt thee as is meet." slowly and put it in my own words: The elders, trusting their own sense of prophecy, predict that before tomorrow's full moon they will honour Mount Cithaeron as the nurse and foster-mother of Oedipus. Next, craft. I notice the joyful song begins with a condition, if my soul prophetic err not, which the next scene will answer. The strongest word is "foster-mother": the mountain did shelter the infant, though not as the elders imagine. Then, effect. Why is the elders' joyful guess about Cithaeron a false dawn? My answer: The elders' joyful guess about Cithaeron is a false dawn because the mountain was indeed where the infant was cast away, but not as the child of a god; the next scene turns their guess into the worst discovery.

> *If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow's full moon rises, and exalt thee as is meet.* *(Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), lines 1103–1106)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow's full moon rises, and exalt thee as is meet." slowly and put it in my own words: The elders, trusting their own sense of prophecy, predict that before tomorrow's full moon they will honour Mount Cithaeron as the nurse and foster-mother of Oedipus. Next, craft. I notice the joyful song begins with a condition, if my soul prophetic err not, which the next scene will answer. The strongest word is "foster-mother": the mountain did shelter the infant, though not as the elders imagine. Then, effect. Why is the elders' joyful guess about Cithaeron a false dawn? My answer: The elders' joyful guess about Cithaeron is a false dawn because the mountain was indeed where the infant was cast away, but not as the child of a god; the next scene turns their guess into the worst discovery.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Read closely: "Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race." (Chorus, lines 1107). Ask: What will the Chorus do to Cithaeron "ere tomorrow's full moon"? Expected: Hail and exalt it as Oedipus' nurse and foster-mother. Ask: Why does the ode come right before the Herdsman scene? Expected: To heighten the fall by raising hope first.

> *Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race.* *(Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus)*

Ask: What will the Chorus do to Cithaeron "ere tomorrow's full moon"?
Expected answer: Hail and exalt it as Oedipus' nurse and foster-mother.
Ask: Why does the ode come right before the Herdsman scene?
Expected answer: To heighten the fall by raising hope first.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the ode for irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this ode suggest about a hopeful guess? Exemplar: This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic "false dawn." The lines "If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow's full moon rises, and exalt thee as is meet." (lines 1103–1106) are the evidence.
Task: Annotate the ode for irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this ode suggest about a hopeful guess?
Exemplar: This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic "false dawn." The lines "If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow's full moon rises, and exalt thee as is meet." (lines 1103–1106) are the evidence.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why might a writer put a happy moment just before a disaster? Ask: Does this ode make the ending more painful or more bearable? Defend your view.
Anchor question: Why might a writer put a happy moment just before a disaster?
Facilitation: Ask: Does this ode make the ending more painful or more bearable? Defend your view. · Ask for the line that proves each answer.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: Why is the elders' joyful guess about Cithaeron a false dawn? Model answer: The elders' joyful guess about Cithaeron is a false dawn because the mountain was indeed where the infant was cast away, but not as the child of a god; the next scene turns their guess into the worst discovery.
Exit ticket: Why is the elders' joyful guess about Cithaeron a false dawn?
Answer: The elders' joyful guess about Cithaeron is a false dawn because the mountain was indeed where the infant was cast away, but not as the child of a god; the next scene turns their guess into the worst discovery.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes a hopeful guess. Key takeaway: a hopeful guess.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Irony:** The Chorus joyfully guesses that Oedipus was born on Mount Cithaeron, perhaps the child of a god such as Pan, Apollo, Hermes or Bacchus and a mountain nymph.

- **Tone / mood:** The Chorus joyfully guesses that Oedipus was born on Mount Cithaeron, perhaps the child of a god such as Pan, Apollo, Hermes or Bacchus and a mountain nymph.
- **Allusion:** The Chorus joyfully guesses that Oedipus was born on Mount Cithaeron, perhaps the child of a god such as Pan, Apollo, Hermes or Bacchus and a mountain nymph.

Themes and how they develop

- **knowledge and blindness:** a hopeful guess.

Symbols and motifs

- **sight and blindness:** The section adds to the play's pattern of sight and blindness: a hopeful guess.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow's full moon rises, and exalt thee as is meet" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus) Chorus, lines 1103–1106.
- "Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus) Chorus, lines 1107.
- "Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure thy sure was more than man, / Haply the hill-roamer Pan" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus) Chorus, in this part of the section.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic "false dawn."
Evidence: "If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow's full moon rises, and exalt thee as is meet" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus)
Reasoning: The Chorus joyfully guesses that Oedipus was born on Mount Cithaeron, perhaps the child of a god such as Pan, Apollo, Hermes or Bacchus and a mountain nymph.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 881–921

881 **Chorus:** My lot be still to lead
882 **Chorus:** The life of innocence and fly
883 **Chorus:** Irreverence in word or deed,
884 **Chorus:** To follow still those laws ordained on high
885 **Chorus:** Whose birthplace is the bright ethereal sky.
886 **Chorus:** No mortal birth they own,
887 **Chorus:** Olympus their progenitor alone:
888 **Chorus:** Ne'er shall they slumber in oblivion cold,
889 **Chorus:** The god in them is strong and grows not old.
890 **Chorus:** Of insolence is bred
891 **Chorus:** The tyrant; insolence full blown,

892 **Chorus:** With empty riches surfeited,
893 **Chorus:** Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne.
894 **Chorus:** Then topples o'er and lies in ruin prone;
895 **Chorus:** No foothold on that dizzy steep.
896 **Chorus:** But O may Heaven the true patriot keep
897 **Chorus:** Who burns with emulous zeal to serve the State.
898 **Chorus:** God is my help and hope, on him I wait.
899 **Chorus:** But the proud sinner, or in word or deed,
900 **Chorus:** That will not Justice heed,
901 **Chorus:** Nor reverence the shrine
902 **Chorus:** Of images divine,
903 **Chorus:** Perdition seize his vain imaginings,
904 **Chorus:** If, urged by greed profane,
905 **Chorus:** He grasps at ill-got gain,
906 **Chorus:** And lays an impious hand on holiest things.
907 **Chorus:** Who when such deeds are done
908 **Chorus:** Can hope heaven's bolts to shun?
909 **Chorus:** If sin like this to honor can aspire,
910 **Chorus:** Why dance I still and lead the sacred choir?
911 **Chorus:** No more I'll seek earth's central oracle,
912 **Chorus:** Or Abae's hallowed cell,
913 **Chorus:** Nor to Olympia bring
914 **Chorus:** My votive offering.
915 **Chorus:** If before all God's truth be not bade plain.
916 **Chorus:** O Zeus, reveal thy might,
917 **Chorus:** King, if thou'rt named aright
918 **Chorus:** Omnipotent, all-seeing, as of old;
919 **Chorus:** For Laius is forgot;
920 **Chorus:** His weird, men heed it not;
921 **Chorus:** Apollo is forsook and faith grows cold.

Lines 886–889

886 **Chorus:** No mortal birth they own,
887 **Chorus:** Olympus their progenitor alone:
888 **Chorus:** Ne'er shall they slumber in oblivion cold,
889 **Chorus:** The god in them is strong and grows not old.

Lines 894–895

894 **Chorus:** Then topples o'er and lies in ruin prone;
895 **Chorus:** No foothold on that dizzy steep.

Lines 922–936

922 **Jocasta:** My lords, ye look amazed to see your queen
923 **Jocasta:** With wreaths and gifts of incense in her hands.
924 **Jocasta:** I had a mind to visit the high shrines,

925 **Jocasta:** For Oedipus is overwrought, alarmed
926 **Jocasta:** With terrors manifold. He will not use
927 **Jocasta:** His past experience, like a man of sense,
928 **Jocasta:** To judge the present need, but lends an ear
929 **Jocasta:** To any croaker if he augurs ill.
930 **Jocasta:** Since then my counsels naught avail, I turn
931 **Jocasta:** To thee, our present help in time of trouble,
932 **Jocasta:** Apollo, Lord Lycean, and to thee
933 **Jocasta:** My prayers and supplications here I bring.
934 **Jocasta:** Lighten us, lord, and cleanse us from this curse!
935 **Jocasta:** For now we all are cowed like mariners
936 **Jocasta:** Who see their helmsman dumbstruck in the storm.

Lines 924–926
924 **Jocasta:** I had a mind to visit the high shrines,
925 **Jocasta:** For Oedipus is overwrought, alarmed
926 **Jocasta:** With terrors manifold. He will not use

Lines 939–940
939 **Chorus:** Here is the palace and he bides within;
940 **Chorus:** This is his queen the mother of his children.

Lines 943–945
943 **Jocasta:** My greetings to thee, stranger; thy fair words
944 **Jocasta:** Deserve a like response. But tell me why
945 **Jocasta:** Thou comest—what thy need or what thy news.

Lines 952–953
952 **Messenger:** The Isthmian commons have resolved to make
953 **Messenger:** Thy husband king—so 'twas reported there.

Line 957
957 **Messenger:** If I speak falsely, may I die myself.

Lines 963–964
963 **Oedipus:** My wife, my queen, Jocasta, why hast thou
964 **Oedipus:** Summoned me from my palace?

Line 968
968 **Oedipus:** Who is this man, and what his news for me?

Lines 969–970
969 **Jocasta:** He comes from Corinth and his message this:
970 **Jocasta:** Thy father Polybus hath passed away.

Line 975
975 **Messenger:** One touch will send an old man to his rest.

Line 977
977 **Messenger:** Yes, having measured the full span of years.

Lines 985–986
985 **Oedipus:** But, as they stand, the oracles are dead—
986 **Oedipus:** Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus.

Line 987
987 **Jocasta:** Say, did not I foretell this long ago?

Line 990
990 **Oedipus:** Must I not fear my mother's marriage bed?

Line 1007
1007 **Messenger:** A mystery, or may a stranger hear it?

Line 1018
1018 **Oedipus:** Well, thou shalt have due guerdon for thy pains.

Line 1026
1026 **Messenger:** Lest through thy parents thou shouldst be accursed?

Line 1028
1028 **Messenger:** Dost thou not know thy fears are baseless all?

Line 1032
1032 **Messenger:** As much thy sire as I am, and no more.

Line 1034
1034 **Messenger:** Since I begat thee not, no more did he.

Lines 1103–1106
1103 **Chorus:** If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail,
1104 **Chorus:** Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail,
1105 **Chorus:** As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet
1106 **Chorus:** Ere tomorrow's full moon rises, and exalt thee as is meet.

Line 1107
1107 **Chorus:** Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race.

Lines 1237–1240
1237 **Second Messenger:** Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween,
1238 **Second Messenger:** Could wash away the blood-stains from this house,

Second Messenger: The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light,
Second Messenger: Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
nymph (noun)	in Greek myth, a minor goddess of nature	*Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure thy sure was more than man, Haply the hill-roamer Pan.*	

Discussion questions

1. Why might a writer put a happy moment just before a disaster?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with pride and fall?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What will the Chorus do to Cithaeron "ere tomorrow's full moon"? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Hail and exalt it as Oedipus' nurse and foster-mother.
2. What place does the Chorus celebrate? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Mount Cithaeron
3. What do the elders guess about Oedipus' birth? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He may be the child of a god
4. What is the tone of this ode? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Hopeful and joyful
5. Why is the ode ironic? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The truth about Cithaeron is the opposite of what they hope
6. What kind of reference is the mention of gods like Pan and Hermes? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: An allusion to myth
7. Retell the three most important events of “Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Chorus joyfully guesses that Oedipus was born on Mount Cithaeron, perhaps the child of a god such as Pan, Apollo, Hermes or Bacchus and a mountain nymph.

8. Who is on stage in “Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. In the passage that begins “Strophe If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet Ere tomorrow’s full moon…”, who is speaking or being described, and what do they say or do? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Literal paraphrase of the anchor passage.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the ode come right before the Herdsman scene? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: To heighten the fall by raising hope first.
2. What does “Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)” suggest about a hopeful guess? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic "false dawn."
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the tone / mood in this scene shape what we understand about a hopeful guess? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic "false dawn." Useful evidence: “If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow’s full moon rises, and exalt thee as” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1103–1106. On tone / mood: The Chorus joyfully guesses that Oedipus was born on Mount Cithaeron, perhaps the child of a god such as Pan, Apollo, Hermes or Bacchus and a mountain nymph. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Strophe If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet Ere tomorrow’s full moon…”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: The Chorus joyfully guesses that Oedipus was born on Mount Cithaeron, perhaps the child of a god such as Pan, Apollo, Hermes or Bacchus and a mountain nymph.

7. How does “Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)” build on “Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic "false dawn." Useful evidence: “Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1107. Theme link: a hopeful guess. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic "false dawn." Useful evidence: “Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure thy sure was more than man, / Haply the hill-roamer Pan” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: a hopeful guess. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might a writer put a happy moment just before a disaster?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does allusion appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with pride and fall? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.9, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for references to other books, myths, history or religion.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic "false dawn." Useful evidence: “If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow’s full moon rises, and exalt thee as” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1103–1106. On allusion: The Chorus joyfully guesses that Oedipus was born on Mount Cithaeron, perhaps the child of a god such as Pan, Apollo, Hermes or Bacchus and a mountain nymph. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does this ode make the ending more painful or more bearable? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic "false dawn." Useful evidence: “Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1107. Theme link: a hopeful guess. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic "false dawn."” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1,

RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic "false dawn." Useful evidence: “Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure thy sure was more than man, / Haply the hill-roamer Pan” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: a hopeful guess. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic "false dawn." Useful evidence: “If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow’s full moon rises, and exalt thee as” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1103–1106. Theme link: a hopeful guess. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of a hopeful guess. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic "false dawn." Useful evidence: “Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1107. Theme link: a hopeful guess. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic "false dawn." Useful evidence: “Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure thy sure was more than man, / Haply the hill-roamer Pan” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: a hopeful guess. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to leadership and the city: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic "false dawn." Useful evidence: “If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow’s full moon rises, and exalt thee as” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1103–1106. Theme link: a hopeful guess. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic "false dawn." Useful evidence: “Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1107. On irony: The Chorus joyfully guesses that Oedipus was born on Mount Cithaeron, perhaps the child of a god such as Pan, Apollo, Hermes or Bacchus and a mountain nymph. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)” treats a hopeful guess with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus Rex see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic "false dawn." Useful evidence: “Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure thy sure was more than man, / Haply the hill-roamer Pan” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: a hopeful guess. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic "false dawn." Useful evidence: “If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow’s full moon rises, and exalt thee as” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1103–1106. Theme link: a hopeful guess. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a hopeful guess? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic "false dawn." Useful evidence: “Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1107. Theme link: a hopeful guess. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Allusion**: references to other books, myths, history or religion

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), lines 886–889: "No mortal birth they own, Olympus their _____ alone: Ne'er shall they slumber in oblivion cold, The god in them is strong and grows not old." Word bank: aspire, progenitor, before, patriot
   Key: progenitor
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), lines 881–921? "If _____ all God's truth be not bade plain."
   A. before
   B. aspire
   C. patriot
   D. progenitor

   Key: A (before)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), lines 943–945? "But tell me why Thou _____—what thy need or what thy news."
   A. inspiring
   B. falsely
   C. happiness
   D. comest

   Key: D (comest)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus: "If my soul _____ err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow's full moon rises, and exalt thee as is meet"
   Key: prophetic
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What place does the Chorus celebrate?
   A. Delphi
   B. Corinth
   C. Mount Cithaeron
   D. Athens

   Key: C (Mount Cithaeron)
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the elders guess about Oedipus' birth?
   A. He is Creon's son
   B. He may be the child of a god
   C. He is a slave's son
   D. He was born in Corinth

   Key: B (He may be the child of a god)
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is the tone of this ode?
   A. Hopeful and joyful
   B. Fearful
   C. Angry
   D. Grieving

Key: A (Hopeful and joyful)

8. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What will the Chorus do to Cithaeron "ere tomorrow's full moon"?

   Sample answer: Hail and exalt it as Oedipus' nurse and foster-mother.

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why is the ode ironic?

   A. Cithaeron does not exist

   B. They already know the truth

   C. The truth about Cithaeron is the opposite of what they hope

   D. They are mocking Oedipus

   Key: C (The truth about Cithaeron is the opposite of what they hope)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), lines 881–921 reveal about the character or situation? “Antistrophe 2 No more I’ll seek earth’s central oracle, Or Abae’s hallowed cell, Nor to Olympia bring My votive offering.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), lines 881–921) shows the situation turning on knowledge and blindness: the story keeps returning to knowledge and blindness. The words “offering” and “hallowed” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), lines 924–926 reveal about the character or situation? “I had a mind to visit the high shrines, For Oedipus is overwrought, alarmed With terrors manifold.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), lines 924–926) shows the situation turning on knowledge and blindness: the story keeps returning to knowledge and blindness. The words “overwrought” and “manifold” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 990 reveal about the character or situation? “Must I not fear my mother’s marriage bed?” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 990) shows the situation turning on knowledge and blindness: the story keeps returning to knowledge and blindness. The words “marriage” and “mother” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the ode come right before the Herdsman scene?

    Sample answer: To heighten the fall by raising hope first. The evidence is “If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus…” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1103–1106.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), lines 894–895 shapes its tone: “Then topples o’er and lies in ruin prone; No foothold on that dizzy steep.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “foothold” and “topples” (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), lines 894–895) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to leadership and the city: the story keeps returning to leadership and the city. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? A hopeful guess.

    A. Pride and fall

B. Knowledge and blindness

C. Leadership and the city

D. Fate and responsibility

Key: B (Knowledge and blindness)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), lines 963–964 to the story's treatment of mercy: “My wife, my queen, Jocasta, why hast thou Summoned me from my palace?” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), lines 963–964) develops mercy: the story keeps returning to mercy. Its words “palace” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Who is this man, and what his news for me?” (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), lines 963–964), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating mercy as central.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 987: “Say, did not I _____ this long ago?” Word bank: comest, inspiring, foretell, experience

    Key: foretell

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), lines 922–936: “Lighten us, lord, and _____ us from this curse!” Word bank: wreaths, cleanse, inspiring, wherewithal

    Key: cleanse

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus: “Child, who bare thee, nymph or _____? sure thy sure was more than man, / Haply the hill-roamer Pan”

    Key: goddess

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What kind of reference is the mention of gods like Pan and Hermes?

    A. A simile

    B. A pun

    C. A stage direction

    D. An allusion to myth

    Key: D (An allusion to myth)

21. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow’s full moon rises, and exalt thee as is meet” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1103–1106. The evidence is “If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus…” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus).

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 1007 shapes its tone: “A mystery, or may a stranger hear it?” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “stranger” and “mystery” (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 1007) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to leadership and the city: the story keeps returning to leadership and the city. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 1018 shapes its tone: “Well, thou shalt have due guerdon for thy pains.” Pick two

words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words "guerdon" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 1018) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and responsibility: the story keeps returning to fate and responsibility. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 975 to the story's treatment of pride and fall: "One touch will send an old man to his rest." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 975) develops pride and fall: the story keeps returning to pride and fall. Its words its wording carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Yes, having measured the full span of years." (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 975), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating pride and fall as central.

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), lines 969–970? "He comes from Corinth and his _____ this: Thy father Polybus hath passed away."

    A. foretell

    B. message

    C. wreaths

    D. murderer

    Key: B (message)

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), lines 939–940 shapes its tone: "Here is the palace and he bides within; This is his queen the mother of his children." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "children" and "mother" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), lines 939–940) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to leadership and the city: the story keeps returning to leadership and the city. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Does this ode make the ending more painful or more bearable? Defend your view.

    Sample answer: A defended position: Chorus, in this part of the section. The evidence is "Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure thy sure was more than man, / Haply the hill-roamer Pan" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: a hopeful guess. The Chorus joyfully guesses that Oedipus was born on Mount Cithaeron, perhaps the child of a god such as Pan, Apollo, Hermes or Bacchus and a mountain nymph.

28. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 957: "If I speak _____, may I die myself." Word bank: wreaths, inspiring, experience, falsely

    Key: falsely

29. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)"?

    A. A city praying for rescue

    B. The shadow of a shade

    C. Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear

    D. A hopeful guess

    Key: D (A hopeful guess)

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), lines 952–953 shapes its tone: "The Isthmian commons have resolved to make Thy

husband king—so 'twas reported there." Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words "reported" and "resolved" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), lines 952–953) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and responsibility: the story keeps returning to fate and responsibility. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 1026 to the story's treatment of mercy: "Lest through thy parents thou shouldst be accursed?" Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 1026) develops mercy: the story keeps returning to mercy. Its words "shouldst" and "accursed" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Dost thou not know thy fears are baseless all?" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 1026), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating mercy as central.

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which literary element does this describe in "Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)"? The Chorus joyfully guesses that Oedipus was born on Mount Cithaeron, perhaps the child of a god such as Pan, Apollo, Hermes or Bacchus and a mountain nymph.

    A. Point of view

    B. Tone / mood

    C. Structure

    D. Theme

    Key: B (Tone / mood)

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how knowledge and blindness develops from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102) to Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114). Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus, the text reads "But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus" — Oedipus, lines 985–986. In Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), "If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus…" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1103–1106. A hopeful guess.

34. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Claim: This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic "false dawn." Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow's full moon rises, and exalt thee as is meet" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus).

    Sample answer: The Chorus joyfully guesses that Oedipus was born on Mount Cithaeron, perhaps the child of a god such as Pan, Apollo, Hermes or Bacchus and a mountain nymph. The evidence is "If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus…" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1103–1106. This develops knowledge and blindness: a hopeful guess.

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1107. The evidence is "Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: a hopeful guess. The words "praises" and "lover" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The Chorus joyfully guesses that Oedipus was born on Mount Cithaeron, perhaps the child of a god such as Pan, Apollo, Hermes or Bacchus and a mountain nymph.

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 1032 to the story's treatment of pride and fall: “As much thy sire as I am, and no more.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 1032) develops pride and fall: the story keeps returning to pride and fall. Its words its wording carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Since I begat thee not, no more did he.” (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), line 1032), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating pride and fall as central.

37. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure thy sure was more than man, / Haply the hill-roamer Pan” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus)
    A. The lines describe a sea voyage to Troy.
    B. Second Messenger, lines 1237–1240.
    C. Chorus, in this part of the section.
    D. The first line: a play of questions.
    Key: C (Chorus, in this part of the section.)

38. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus: “Dance and song shall hymn thy _____, lover of our royal race”
    Key: praises

39. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Analyze the word choice in “Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure thy sure was more than man, / Haply the hill-roamer Pan” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Chorus, in this part of the section. The evidence is “Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure thy sure was more than man, / Haply the hill-roamer Pan” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: a hopeful guess. The words “goddess” and “roamer” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow’s full moon rises, and exalt thee as is meet” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1103–1106. The evidence is “If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus…” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: a hopeful guess. The words “prophetic” and “tomorrow” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The Chorus joyfully guesses that Oedipus was born on Mount Cithaeron, perhaps the child of a god such as Pan, Apollo, Hermes or Bacchus and a mountain nymph.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 6, 19, 20, 8, 4, 5, 10, 11, 12, 21, 22, 23, 15, 24	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	18, 17, 25, 20, 19, 7, 10, 12, 11, 13, 21, 14, 26, 15, 24, 27	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2

HS Junior	25, 28, 19, 4, 5, 10, 11, 12, 13, 29, 22, 26, 30, 15, 31, 24	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	28, 25, 20, 19, 10, 11, 12, 13, 29, 14, 30, 23, 15, 31, 24, 27	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	25, 4, 6, 19, 10, 11, 13, 30, 22, 23, 32, 15, 24, 16, 27, 33	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	2, 1, 18, 5, 6, 7, 10, 14, 30, 26, 23, 34, 24, 16, 35, 33	recall 6, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	1, 18, 5, 6, 11, 29, 14, 30, 26, 22, 15, 16, 36, 31, 33, 35	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	1, 4, 5, 29, 37, 23, 22, 26, 34, 15, 31, 24, 36, 33, 27, 35	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	25, 4, 38, 5, 6, 22, 26, 23, 15, 39, 31, 24, 16, 36, 33, 27	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 6
Graduate / PhD	7, 4, 38, 5, 6, 14, 23, 26, 32, 24, 36, 16, 31, 33, 40, 27	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 7

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114),” how does Sophocles show a hopeful guess? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1): In Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), how does Sophocles develop the idea of a hopeful guess? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114) develops the idea of a hopeful guess. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of a hopeful guess. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114) suggests about a hopeful guess. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses irony in Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114) to complicate the reader's understanding of a hopeful guess. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Situate Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114) within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of a hopeful guess responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Read Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114) alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of a hopeful guess follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114) and its treatment of a hopeful guess. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop a research argument that reads Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114) as evidence for a larger claim about a hopeful guess in Oedipus Rex. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop an original argument that reads Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114) as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of a hopeful guess. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Oedipus Rex.

SAT-style questions

1. *Strophe If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet Ere tomorrow's full moon rises, and exalt thee as is meet. Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race. Phoebus, may my words find grace! Antistrophe Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure thy sure was more than man, Haply the hill-roamer Pan. Of did Loxias beget thee, for he haunts the upland wold; Or Cyllene's lord, or Bacchus, dweller on the hilltops cold? Did some Heliconian Oread give him thee, a new-born joy? Nymphs with whom he love to toy?*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)"?

   A. The herdsman and the recognition

B. A king who promises to find the truth

C. A hopeful guess

D. Good news that is not good

SAT key: 1. C (A hopeful guess)

Lesson 10: Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)

Focus: the herdsman and the recognition

Objective: Students will analyze how plot develops in "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (mature themes): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently.
Student preview: This section deals with mature themes in the play.
Suggested language: "What does this passage make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from Laius' house and that the queen gave it to him to destroy because of a prophecy; he pitied it and gave it away. Oedipus recognizes the whole truth.

Background: Threatening an enslaved man to make him speak (lines 1160–1167) shows the power masters held over enslaved people; it is wrong, and the play does not hide its cruelty.

Significance: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is it ever right to force someone to tell the truth? Why or why not? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to knowledge and blindness because.... Content note before we start: This section deals with mature themes in the play.
Prompt: Is it ever right to force someone to tell the truth? Why or why not?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to knowledge and blindness because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the herdsman and the recognition.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
One key word in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: parricide — the killing of one's father, or the person who does it. "parricide": Origin: possibly Middle French parricide; earlier Latin parricīda.
Words: parricide: the killing of one's father, or the person who does it

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Threatening an enslaved man to make him speak (lines 1160–1167) shows the power masters held over enslaved people; it is wrong, and the play does not hide its cruelty. Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. Look closely: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred." slowly and put it in my own words: The old herdsman says he was a slave born in the household of Laius, not one who was bought. Next, craft. I notice a short, plain line among royal speeches; the old word thrall names his status without comment. The strongest word is "thrall": an enslaved person; the play reflects a society in which owning people was legal, and that was wrong. Then, effect. Why does it matter that the herdsman was home-bred in the house of Laius? My answer: It matters that the herdsman was home-bred in the house of Laius because a slave born there knew the family's secrets and had no power to refuse orders, which is why he was handed the baby and why he can be threatened into speaking now (lines 1160–1167).

> *I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred.* *(Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred." slowly and put it in my own words: The old herdsman says he was a slave born in the household of Laius, not one who was bought. Next, craft. I notice a short, plain line among royal speeches; the old word thrall names his status without comment. The strongest word is "thrall": an enslaved person; the play reflects a society in which owning people was legal, and that was wrong. Then, effect. Why does it matter that the herdsman was home-bred in the house of Laius? My answer: It matters that the herdsman was home-bred in the house of Laius because a slave born there knew the family's secrets and had no power to refuse orders, which is why he was handed the baby and why he can be threatened into speaking now (lines 1160–1167).

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Threatening an enslaved man to make him speak (lines 1160–1167) shows the power masters held over enslaved people; it is wrong, and the play does not hide its cruelty. Read closely: "I stand upon the perilous edge of speech." (Herdsman, lines 1179). Ask: How does this line connect to knowledge and blindness? Expected: The herdsman and the recognition. (Herdsman, lines 1179.)

> *I stand upon the perilous edge of speech (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Threatening an enslaved man to make him speak (lines 1160–1167) shows the power masters held over enslaved people; it is wrong, and the play does not hide its cruelty. Read closely: "I stand upon the perilous edge of speech." (Herdsman, lines 1179).
Ask: How does this line connect to knowledge and blindness?
Expected answer: The herdsman and the recognition. (Herdsman, lines 1179.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for plot, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the herdsman and the recognition? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200) develops the idea of the herdsman and the recognition. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. When the text says "I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman), it shows this directly. The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from Laius' house and that the queen gave it to him to destroy because of a prophecy; he pitied it and gave it away. Oedipus recognizes the whole truth.
Task: Annotate the scene for plot, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the herdsman and the recognition? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200) develops the idea of the herdsman and the recognition. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
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70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is it ever right to force someone to tell the truth? Why or why not? Ask: Is it ever right to force someone to tell the truth? Why or why not?
Anchor question: Is it ever right to force someone to tell the truth? Why or why not?
Facilitation: Ask: Is it ever right to force someone to tell the truth? Why or why not?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the herdsman and the recognition? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. ("I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred", Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the herdsman and the recognition? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. ("I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred", Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how plot shapes the herdsman and the recognition. Key takeaway: the herdsman and the recognition.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from Laius' house and that the queen gave it to him to destroy because of a prophecy; he pitied it and gave it away. Oedipus recognizes the whole truth.
- **Characterization:** The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from Laius' house and that the queen gave it to him to destroy because of a prophecy; he pitied it and gave it away. Oedipus recognizes the whole truth.
- **Irony:** The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he

speaks. He admits that the child came from Laius' house and that the queen gave it to him to destroy because of a prophecy; he pitied it and gave it away. Oedipus recognizes the whole truth.

Themes and how they develop

- **knowledge and blindness:** the herdsman and the recognition.

Symbols and motifs

- **sight and blindness:** The section adds to the play's pattern of sight and blindness: the herdsman and the recognition.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman) Herdsman, lines 1131.
- "I stand upon the perilous edge of speech" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman) Herdsman, lines 1179.
- "And I of hearing, but I still must hear" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 1180.
- "Ah me! ah me! all brought to pass, all true! / O light, may I behold thee nevermore! / I stand a wretch, in birth, in wedlock cursed, / A parricide, incestuously, triply cursed" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 1197–1200.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself.
Evidence: "I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman)
Reasoning: The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from Laius' house and that the queen gave it to him to destroy because of a prophecy; he pitied it and gave it away. Oedipus recognizes the whole truth.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 1103–1106
1103 **Chorus:** If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail,
1104 **Chorus:** Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail,
1105 **Chorus:** As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet
1106 **Chorus:** Ere tomorrow's full moon rises, and exalt thee as is meet.

Lines 1115–1120
1115 **Oedipus:** Elders, if I, who never yet before
1116 **Oedipus:** Have met the man, may make a guess, methinks
1117 **Oedipus:** I see the herdsman who we long have sought;
1118 **Oedipus:** His time-worn aspect matches with the years
1119 **Oedipus:** Of yonder agèd messenger; besides
1120 **Oedipus:** I seem to recognise the men who bring him

Lines 1115–1123

1115 **Oedipus:** Elders, if I, who never yet before
1116 **Oedipus:** Have met the man, may make a guess, methinks
1117 **Oedipus:** I see the herdsman who we long have sought;
1118 **Oedipus:** His time-worn aspect matches with the years
1119 **Oedipus:** Of yonder agèd messenger; besides
1120 **Oedipus:** I seem to recognise the men who bring him
1121 **Oedipus:** As servants of my own. But you, perchance,
1122 **Oedipus:** Having in past days known or seen the herd,
1123 **Oedipus:** May better by sure knowledge my surmise.

Line 1131

1131 **Herdsman:** I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred.

Line 1133

1133 **Herdsman:** The best part of my life I tended sheep.

Line 1134

1134 **Oedipus:** What were the pastures thou didst most frequent?

Lines 1141–1148

1141 **Messenger:** No wonder, master. But I will revive
1142 **Messenger:** His blunted memories. Sure he can recall
1143 **Messenger:** What time together both we drove our flocks,
1144 **Messenger:** He two, I one, on the Cithaeron range,
1145 **Messenger:** For three long summers; I his mate from spring
1146 **Messenger:** Till rose Arcturus; then in winter time
1147 **Messenger:** I led mine home, he his to Laius' folds.
1148 **Messenger:** Did these things happen as I say, or no?

Line 1153

1153 **Messenger:** Friend, he that stands before thee was that child.

Line 1158

1158 **Oedipus:** Not answering what he asks about the child.

Line 1160

1160 **Oedipus:** If thou lack'st grace to speak, I'll loose thy tongue.

Line 1166

1166 **Herdsman:** I did; and would that I had died that day!

Line 1167

1167 **Oedipus:** And die thou shalt unless thou tell the truth.

Line 1168

1168 **Herdsman:** But, if I tell it, I am doubly lost.

Line 1173
1173 **Oedipus:** From whom of these our townsmen, and what house?

Line 1174
1174 **Herdsman:** Forbear for God's sake, master, ask no more.

Line 1179
1179 **Herdsman:** I stand upon the perilous edge of speech.

Line 1180
1180 **Oedipus:** And I of hearing, but I still must hear.

Lines 1192–1196
1192 **Herdsman:** Through pity, master, for the babe. I thought
1193 **Herdsman:** He'd take it to the country whence he came;
1194 **Herdsman:** But he preserved it for the worst of woes.
1195 **Herdsman:** For if thou art in sooth what this man saith,
1196 **Herdsman:** God pity thee! thou wast to misery born.

Lines 1197–1200
1197 **Oedipus:** Ah me! ah me! all brought to pass, all true!
1198 **Oedipus:** O light, may I behold thee nevermore!
1199 **Oedipus:** I stand a wretch, in birth, in wedlock cursed,
1200 **Oedipus:** A parricide, incestuously, triply cursed. Exit Oedipus.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
parricide (noun)	the killing of one's father, or the person who does it	*I stand a wretch, in birth, in wedlock cursed, A parricide, incestuously, triply cursed.*	"parricide": Origin: possibly Middle French parricide; earlier Latin parricīda. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/parricide#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Is it ever right to force someone to tell the truth? Why or why not?
2. Where does plot appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with leadership and the city?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20,

21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does the herdsman mean by "the perilous edge of speech"? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He is about to say something dangerous and terrible.
2. Who was the herdsman before? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A slave born in Laius' household
3. Why does the herdsman try not to answer? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He knows the truth is terrible and dangerous
4. How does Oedipus make him speak? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He orders him threatened
5. Why did the herdsman not destroy the baby? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He pitied it
6. What literary term names the moment Oedipus learns the truth? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Recognition
7. Retell the three most important events of “Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from Laius' house and that the queen gave it to him to destroy because of a prophecy; he pitied it and gave it away. Oedipus recognizes the whole truth.
8. Who is on stage in “Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “I stand a wretch, in birth, in wedlock cursed, A parricide, incestuously, triply cursed.” What does “parricide” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: parricide: the killing of one's father, or the person who does it.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Oedipus insist "I still must hear"? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: He is committed to the truth even if it destroys him.
2. What does “Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)” suggest about the herdsman and the recognition? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal:

the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself.

3. Find one example of plot in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the herdsman and the recognition? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. Useful evidence: “I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred” (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman): Herdsman, lines 1131. On characterization: The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from Laius' house and that the queen gave it to him to destroy because of a prophecy; he pitied it and gave it away. Oedipus recognizes the whole truth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Elders, if I, who never yet before Have met the man, may make a guess, methinks I see the herdsman who we long have sought; His time-worn aspect matches with the years Of yonder…”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from Laius' house and that the queen gave it to him to destroy…
7. How does “Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)” build on “Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. Useful evidence: “I stand upon the perilous edge of speech” (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman): Herdsman, lines 1179. Theme link: the herdsman and the recognition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. Useful evidence: “And I of hearing, but I still must hear” (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1180. On characterization: The old herdsman of Laius, once a

household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from Laius' house and that the queen gave it to him to destroy because of a prophecy; he pitied it and gave it away. Oedipus recognizes the whole truth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: "Is it ever right to force someone to tell the truth? Why or why not?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with leadership and the city? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. Useful evidence: "Ah me! ah me! all brought to pass, all true! / O light, may I behold thee nevermore! / I stand a wretch, in birth, in wedlock cursed, / A parricide, incestuously, triply cursed" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1197–1200. On irony: The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from Laius' house and that the queen gave it to him to destroy because of a prophecy; he pitied it and gave it away. Oedipus recognizes the whole truth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Oedipus heroic or reckless in forcing the truth? Argue with evidence. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. Useful evidence: "I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman): Herdsman, lines 1131. Theme link: the herdsman and the recognition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: "Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. Useful evidence: "I stand upon the perilous edge of speech" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman): Herdsman, lines 1179. Theme link: the herdsman and the recognition. Credit

any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. Useful evidence: "And I of hearing, but I still must hear" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1180. On characterization: The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from Laius' house and that the queen gave it to him to destroy because of a prophecy; he pitied it and gave it away. Oedipus recognizes the whole truth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the herdsman and the recognition. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. Useful evidence: "Ah me! ah me! all brought to pass, all true! / O light, may I behold thee nevermore! / I stand a wretch, in birth, in wedlock cursed, / A parricide, incestuously, triply cursed" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1197–1200. Theme link: the herdsman and the recognition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. Useful evidence: "I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman): Herdsman, lines 1131. Theme link: the herdsman and the recognition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to mercy: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. Useful evidence: "I stand upon the perilous edge of speech" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman): Herdsman, lines 1179. Theme link: the herdsman and the recognition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the plot in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. Useful evidence: "And I of hearing, but I still must hear" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1180. On plot: The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from Laius' house and that the queen gave it to him to destroy because of a prophecy; he pitied it and gave it away. Oedipus recognizes the whole truth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)" treats the herdsman and the recognition with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus Rex see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. Useful evidence: "Ah me! ah me! all brought to pass, all true! / O light, may I behold thee nevermore! / I stand a wretch, in birth, in wedlock cursed, / A parricide, incestuously, triply cursed" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1197–1200. Theme link: the herdsman and the recognition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. Useful evidence: "I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman): Herdsman, lines 1131. Theme link: the herdsman and the recognition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the herdsman and the recognition? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. Useful evidence: "I stand upon the perilous edge of speech" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman): Herdsman, lines 1179. Theme link: the herdsman and the recognition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Plot:** look for key events and the causes linking them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What literary term names the moment Oedipus learns the truth?

   A. Foreshadowing

   B. Recognition

   C. Simile

   D. Exposition

   Key: B (Recognition)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman: "I was, a thrall, not _____ but home-bred"

   Key: purchased

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Oedipus: "Ah me! ah me! all brought to pass, all true! / O light, may I behold thee nevermore! / I stand a wretch, in birth, in wedlock cursed, / A parricide, _____, triply cursed"

   Key: incestuously

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why does the herdsman try not to answer?

   A. He wants a reward first

   B. He has forgotten everything

   C. He knows the truth is terrible and dangerous

   D. He is deaf

   Key: C (He knows the truth is terrible and dangerous)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman: "I stand upon the _____ edge of speech"

   Key: perilous

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why did the herdsman not destroy the baby?

   A. He pitied it

   B. The baby escaped

   C. The gods stopped him

   D. He sold it

   Key: A (He pitied it)

7. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the herdsman mean by "the perilous edge of speech"?

   Sample answer: He is about to say something dangerous and terrible.

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Oedipus make him speak?

   A. He orders him threatened

   B. He pays him

C. He asks Teiresias

D. He pardons him first

Key: A (He orders him threatened)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I stand a wretch, in birth, in wedlock cursed, A _____, incestuously, triply cursed.” Word bank: parricide

   Key: parricide

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Oedipus: “And I of _____, but I still must hear”

    Key: hearing

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who was the herdsman before?

    A. A slave born in Laius' household

    B. A priest of Apollo

    C. A Corinthian soldier

    D. Jocasta's brother

    Key: A (A slave born in Laius' household)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Oedipus insist "I still must hear"?

    Sample answer: He is committed to the truth even if it destroys him. The evidence is “And I of hearing, but I still must hear” (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1180.

13. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The herdsman and the recognition.

    A. Fate and responsibility

    B. Leadership and the city

    C. Knowledge and blindness

    D. Pride and fall

    Key: C (Knowledge and blindness)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)”? The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from…

    A. Diction / vocabulary

    B. Hyperbole

    C. Plot

    D. Personification

    Key: C (Plot)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “And I of hearing, but I still must hear” (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Oedipus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1180. The evidence is “And I of hearing, but I still must hear” (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Oedipus). This develops knowledge and blindness: the herdsman and the recognition. The words “hearing” and “still” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect

(Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. "I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman) supports it: The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from Laius' house and that the queen gave it to him to destroy because of a prophecy; he pitied it and gave it away. Oedipus recognizes the whole truth. But "And I of hearing, but I still must hear" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Oedipus) complicates it: the line (Oedipus, lines 1180) shows the same issue from another side, and its "but" marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. The claim is therefore a strong reading, not a complete one, and a careful answer says where it stops applying.

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)"?

    A. The shadow of a shade

    B. Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear

    C. Good news that is not good

    D. The herdsman and the recognition

    Key: D (The herdsman and the recognition)

18. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "I stand upon the perilous edge of speech" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Herdsman, lines 1179. The evidence is "I stand upon the perilous edge of speech" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman). This develops knowledge and blindness: the herdsman and the recognition.

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman).

    Sample answer: The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from Laius' house and that the queen gave it to him to destroy because of a prophecy; he pitied it and gave it away. Oedipus recognizes the whole truth. The evidence is "I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman) — Herdsman, lines 1131. This develops knowledge and blindness: the herdsman and the recognition.

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), line 1153: "Friend, he that _____ before thee was that child." Word bank: cannot, stands, business, masters

    Key: stands

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), line 1134? "What were the _____ thou didst most frequent?"

    A. perchance

    B. pastures

    C. business

    D. cannot

    Key: B (pastures)

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), line 1167? "And die thou shalt _____ thou tell the truth."

    A. business

    B. pastures

    C. unless

    D. perchance

    Key: C (unless)

23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Herdsman, lines 1131. The evidence is "I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman). This develops knowledge and blindness: the herdsman and the recognition.

24. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), line 1173 reveal about the character or situation? "From whom of these our townsmen, and what house?" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), line 1173) shows the situation turning on knowledge and blindness: the story keeps returning to knowledge and blindness. The words "townsmen" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

25. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), lines 1115–1120 reveal about the character or situation? "Elders, if I, who never yet before Have met the man, may make a guess, methinks I see the herdsman who we long have sought; His time-worn aspect matches with the years Of yonder agèd messenger; besides I seem to recognise the men who bring…" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), lines 1115–1120) shows the situation turning on knowledge and blindness: the herdsman and the recognition. The words "messenger" and "recognise" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), line 1133 shapes its tone: "The best part of my life I tended sheep." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "tended" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), line 1133) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to leadership and the city: the story keeps returning to leadership and the city. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), lines 1141–1148 shapes its tone: "Sure he can recall What time together both we drove our flocks, He two, I one, on the Cithaeron range, For three long summers; I his mate from spring Till rose Arcturus; then in winter time I led mine home, he his to Laius' folds." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "together" and "summers" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), lines 1141–1148) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and responsibility: the story keeps returning to fate and responsibility. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Oedipus heroic or reckless in forcing the truth? Argue with evidence.

    Sample answer: A defended position: Oedipus, lines 1197–1200. The evidence is "Ah me! ah me! all brought to pass, all

true! / O light, may I behold thee nevermore! / I stand a wretch, in birth, in wedlock cursed, / A…" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Oedipus). This develops knowledge and blindness: the herdsman and the recognition. The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from Laius' house and that the queen gave it to him to destroy because of a prophecy; he pitied it and gave it away. Oedipus recognizes the whole truth.

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), lines 1192–1196 shapes its tone: "I thought He'd take it to the country whence he came; But he preserved it for the worst of woes." Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words "preserved" and "thought" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), lines 1192–1196) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to leadership and the city: the story keeps returning to leadership and the city. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), line 1166 to the story's treatment of pride and fall: "I did; and would that I had died that day!" Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), line 1166) develops pride and fall: the story keeps returning to pride and fall. Its words its wording carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "But, if I tell it, I am doubly lost." (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), line 1166), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating pride and fall as central.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), line 1158 to the story's treatment of mercy: "Not answering what he asks about the child." Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), line 1158) develops mercy: the story keeps returning to mercy. Its words "answering" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "If thou lack'st grace to speak, I'll loose thy tongue." (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), line 1158), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating mercy as central.

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), lines 1115–1123: "But you, _____, Having in past days known or seen the herd, May better by sure knowledge my surmise." Word bank: unless, stranger, stands, perchance
Key: perchance

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Herdsman, lines 1131. The evidence is "I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman). This develops knowledge and blindness: the herdsman and the recognition. The words "purchased" and "thrall" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from Laius' house and that the queen gave it to him to destroy because of a prophecy; he pitied it and gave it away. Oedipus recognizes the whole truth.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how knowledge and blindness develops from Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114) to Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200). Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus, the text reads "If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus…" — Chorus, lines 1103–1106.

In Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), "I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman) — Herdsman, lines 1131. The herdsman and the recognition.

35. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Complete the quotation from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), line 1174: "Forbear for God's sake, _____, ask no more." Word bank: master, confessed, pastures, perchance
    Key: master

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "I stand upon the perilous edge of speech" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Herdsman, lines 1179. The evidence is "I stand upon the perilous edge of speech" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman). This develops knowledge and blindness: the herdsman and the recognition. The words "perilous" and "speech" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from Laius' house and that the queen gave it to him to destroy because of a prophecy; he pitied it and gave it away. Oedipus recognizes the whole truth.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 1, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	7, 2, 9, 1, 4, 6, 5, 10, 11, 17, 18, 12, 19, 13, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	20, 6, 21, 10, 22, 2, 12, 23, 24, 25, 17, 13, 26, 27, 16, 28	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	11, 4, 6, 10, 3, 25, 23, 18, 24, 12, 13, 27, 26, 29, 30, 31	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	32, 21, 6, 22, 5, 12, 18, 25, 24, 26, 29, 14, 15, 28, 31, 30	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	32, 21, 9, 11, 24, 25, 17, 15, 27, 29, 26, 13, 31, 33, 34, 28	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	35, 4, 11, 2, 8, 25, 15, 29, 27, 26, 14, 28, 31, 34, 33, 16	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	10, 21, 9, 11, 24, 27, 13, 19, 14, 29, 30, 16, 31, 28, 36, 34	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Junior	35, 21, 2, 11, 4, 15, 27, 26, 19, 13, 31, 36, 30, 34, 28, 16	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	5, 2, 11, 4, 17, 25, 13, 15, 27, 29, 30, 16, 31, 34, 36, 28	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 6
Graduate / PhD	22, 9, 2, 11, 24, 23, 14, 13, 29, 15, 26, 30, 16, 34, 28, 31	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)," how does Sophocles show the herdsman and the recognition? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the plot you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), how does Sophocles develop the idea of the herdsman and the recognition? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the plot in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200) develops the idea of the herdsman and the recognition. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its plot shape the reader's understanding of the herdsman and the recognition. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200) suggests about the herdsman and the recognition. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's plot and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses plot in Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200) to complicate the reader's understanding of the herdsman and the recognition. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Situate Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200) within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the herdsman and the recognition responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Read Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200) alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the herdsman and the recognition follows or bends those conventions, using the plot as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200) and its treatment of the herdsman and the recognition. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's plot and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop a research argument that reads Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200) as evidence for a larger claim about the herdsman and the

recognition in Oedipus Rex. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop an original argument that reads Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200) as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the herdsman and the recognition. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Oedipus Rex.

SAT-style questions

1. *Elders, if I, who never yet before Have met the man, may make a guess, methinks I see the herdsman who we long have sought; His time-worn aspect matches with the years Of yonder agèd messenger; besides I seem to recognise the men who bring him As servants of my own. But you, perchance, Having in past days known or seen the herd, May better by sure knowledge my surmise.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)"?

   A. The herdsman and the recognition

   B. The hunted man

   C. Pride breeds the tyrant

   D. Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear

SAT key: 1. A (The herdsman and the recognition)

Lesson 11: Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)

Focus: the shadow of a shade

Objective: Students will analyze how theme develops in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (mature themes): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently.
Student preview: This section deals with mature themes in the play.
Suggested language: "What does this passage make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out.

Background: The play's final lines (1539–1544) make the same warning: no one should be called happy until life is over.

Significance: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Can one person's story stand for everyone? Why might the Chorus think so? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to knowledge and blindness because.... Content note before we start: This section deals with mature themes in the play.
Prompt: Can one person's story stand for everyone? Why might the Chorus think so?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to knowledge and blindness because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the shadow of a shade.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
One key word in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: commingled — mixed together.
Words: commingled: mixed together

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The play's final lines (1539–1544) make the same warning: no one should be called happy until life is over. Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. Look closely: The play's final lines (1539–1544) repeat the warning: call no one happy until life is over.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade!" slowly and put it in my own words: The elders say that human life is short and as unreal as a shadow's shadow. Next, craft. I notice the phrase the shadow of a shade doubles the image of emptiness, and the rhyme of man and span ties human beings to the brevity of their lives. The strongest word is "shade": the word means both a shadow and a ghost of the dead. Then, effect. Why do the elders call humans the shadow of a shade at this moment? My answer: The elders call humans the shadow of a shade at this moment because they have just watched the greatest of men lose everything; it is a cry of grief, not a rule for living, and the Exodos shows Oedipus choosing to go on.

> *Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade! (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade!" slowly and put it in my own words: The elders say that human life is short and as unreal as a shadow's shadow. Next, craft. I notice the phrase the shadow of a shade doubles the image of emptiness, and the rhyme of man and span ties human beings to the brevity of their lives. The strongest word is "shade": the word means both a shadow and a ghost of the dead. Then, effect. Why do the elders call humans the shadow of a shade at this moment? My answer: The elders call humans the shadow of a shade at this moment because they have just watched the greatest of men lose everything; it is a cry of grief, not a rule for living, and the Exodos shows Oedipus choosing to go on.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The play's final lines (1539–1544) make the same warning: no one should be called happy until life is over. Read closely: "All-seeing Time hath caught Guilt, and to justice brought The son and sire commingled in one bed." (Chorus, lines 1225–1227). Ask: How does this line connect to knowledge and blindness? Expected: The shadow of a shade. (Chorus, lines 1225–1227.)

> *All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire commingled in one bed (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The play's final lines (1539–1544) make the same warning: no one should be called happy until life is over. Read closely: "All-seeing Time hath caught Guilt, and to justice brought The son and sire commingled in one bed." (Chorus, lines 1225–1227).
Ask: How does this line connect to knowledge and blindness?
Expected answer: The shadow of a shade. (Chorus, lines 1225–1227.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for theme, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the shadow of a shade? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232) develops the idea of the shadow of a shade. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. When the text says "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus), it shows this directly. The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out.
Task: Annotate the scene for theme, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the shadow of a shade? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232) develops the idea of the shadow of a shade. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. When the text says "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus), it shows this directly. The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Can one person's story stand for everyone? Why might the Chorus think so? Ask: Can one person's story stand for everyone? Why might the Chorus think so?
Anchor question: Can one person's story stand for everyone? Why might the Chorus think so?
Facilitation: Ask: Can one person's story stand for everyone? Why might the Chorus think so?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the shadow of a shade? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. ("Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade", Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the shadow of a shade? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. ("Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade", Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how theme shapes the shadow of a shade. Key takeaway: the shadow of a shade.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Theme:** The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out.
- **Imagery:** The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out.
- **Tone / mood:** The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out.

Themes and how they develop

- **knowledge and blindness:** the shadow of a shade.

Symbols and motifs

- **sight and blindness:** The section adds to the play's pattern of sight and blindness: the shadow of a shade.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus) Chorus, lines 1201–1203.
- "All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire commingled in one bed" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus) Chorus, lines 1225–1227.
- "Of bliss, hath but the show; / A moment, and the visions pale and fade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus) Chorus, in this part of the section.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on.
Evidence: "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus)
Reasoning: The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 1124–1125
1124 **Chorus:** I recognise him; one of Laius' house;
1125 **Chorus:** A simple hind, but true as any man.

Lines 1126–1127
1126 **Oedipus:** Corinthian, stranger, I address thee first,
1127 **Oedipus:** Is this the man thou meanest!

Line 1131
1131 **Herdsman:** I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred.

Lines 1136–1137
1136 **Oedipus:** Then there
1137 **Oedipus:** Thou must have known yon man, at least by fame?

Line 1139
1139 **Oedipus:** The man here, having met him in past times…

Line 1140
1140 **Herdsman:** Off-hand I cannot call him well to mind.

Lines 1150–1151
1150 **Messenger:** Well, thou mast then remember giving me
1151 **Messenger:** A child to rear as my own foster-son?

Lines 1155–1156
1155 **Oedipus:** Softly, old man, rebuke him not; thy words
1156 **Oedipus:** Are more deserving chastisement than his.

Line 1157
1157 **Herdsman:** O best of masters, what is my offence?

Line 1160
1160 **Oedipus:** If thou lack'st grace to speak, I'll loose thy tongue.

Line 1168
1168 **Herdsman:** But, if I tell it, I am doubly lost.

Line 1175
1175 **Oedipus:** If I must question thee again, thou'rt lost.

Lines 1201–1203
1201 **Chorus:** Races of mortal man
1202 **Chorus:** Whose life is but a span,
1203 **Chorus:** I count ye but the shadow of a shade!

Lines 1201–1232

1201 **Chorus:** Races of mortal man
1202 **Chorus:** Whose life is but a span,
1203 **Chorus:** I count ye but the shadow of a shade!
1204 **Chorus:** For he who most doth know
1205 **Chorus:** Of bliss, hath but the show;
1206 **Chorus:** A moment, and the visions pale and fade.
1207 **Chorus:** Thy fall, O Oedipus, thy piteous fall
1208 **Chorus:** Warns me none born of women blest to call.
1209 **Chorus:** For he of marksmen best,
1210 **Chorus:** O Zeus, outshot the rest,
1211 **Chorus:** And won the prize supreme of wealth and power.
1212 **Chorus:** By him the vulture maid
1213 **Chorus:** Was quelled, her witchery laid;
1214 **Chorus:** He rose our saviour and the land's strong tower.
1215 **Chorus:** We hailed thee king and from that day adored
1216 **Chorus:** Of mighty Thebes the universal lord.
1217 **Chorus:** O heavy hand of fate!
1218 **Chorus:** Who now more desolate,
1219 **Chorus:** Whose tale more sad than thine, whose lot more dire?
1220 **Chorus:** O Oedipus, discrownèd head,
1221 **Chorus:** Thy cradle was thy marriage bed;
1222 **Chorus:** One harbourage sufficed for son and sire.
1223 **Chorus:** How could the soil thy father eared so long
1224 **Chorus:** Endure to bear in silence such a wrong?
1225 **Chorus:** All-seeing Time hath caught
1226 **Chorus:** Guilt, and to justice brought
1227 **Chorus:** The son and sire commingled in one bed.
1228 **Chorus:** O child of Laius' ill-starred race
1229 **Chorus:** Would I had ne'er beheld thy face!
1230 **Chorus:** I raise for thee a dirge as o'er the dead.
1231 **Chorus:** Yet, sooth to say, through thee I drew new breath,
1232 **Chorus:** And now through thee I feel a second death.

Line 1202

1202 **Chorus:** Whose life is but a span,

Lines 1215–1216

1215 **Chorus:** We hailed thee king and from that day adored
1216 **Chorus:** Of mighty Thebes the universal lord.

Lines 1223–1224

1223 **Chorus:** How could the soil thy father eared so long
1224 **Chorus:** Endure to bear in silence such a wrong?

Lines 1225–1227

Chorus: All-seeing Time hath caught
Chorus: Guilt, and to justice brought
Chorus: The son and sire commingled in one bed.

Lines 1237–1240

Second Messenger: Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween,
Second Messenger: Could wash away the blood-stains from this house,
Second Messenger: The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light,
Second Messenger: Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
commingled (adjective)	mixed together	*Antistrophe 2 All-seeing Time hath caught Guilt, and to justice brought The son and sire commingled in one bed.*	

Discussion questions

1. Can one person's story stand for everyone? Why might the Chorus think so?
2. Where does theme appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with mercy?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What is "a span" in line 1202? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A very short length: life is brief.
2. What does the Chorus compare human life to? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The shadow of a shade
3. Who is the Chorus's example? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Oedipus
4. What has "All-seeing Time" done? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Brought the hidden guilt to light
5. What is the tone of the ode? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Mournful

6. According to the lesson's Significance note, how is the ode framed? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: As the grief of the Chorus at this moment, open to debate against the ending
7. Retell the three most important events of "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out.
8. Who is on stage in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Antistrophe 2 All-seeing Time hath caught Guilt, and to justice brought The son and sire commingled in one bed." What does "commingled" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: commingled: mixed together.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why do the elders call Time "all-seeing"? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Time reveals what people hide.
2. What does "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)" suggest about the shadow of a shade? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on.
3. Find one example of theme in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
4. How does the imagery in this scene shape what we understand about the shadow of a shade? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. Useful evidence: "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1201–1203. On imagery: The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Strophe 1 Races of mortal man Whose life is but a span, I count ye but the shadow of a shade!", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out.
7. How does "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)" build on "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. Useful evidence: "All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire commingled in one bed" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1225–1227. Theme link: the shadow of a shade. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. Useful evidence: "Of bliss, hath but the show; / A moment, and the visions pale and fade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: the shadow of a shade. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: "Can one person's story stand for everyone? Why might the Chorus think so?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with mercy? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. Useful evidence: "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1201–1203. On tone / mood: The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is this ode the play's view of life? Compare it with the ending. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. Useful evidence: "All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire commingled in one bed" (Stasimon 4

(lines 1201–1232), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1225–1227. On theme: The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: "Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. Useful evidence: "Of bliss, hath but the show; / A moment, and the visions pale and fade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. On theme: The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. Useful evidence: "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1201–1203. Theme link: the shadow of a shade. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the shadow of a shade. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. Useful evidence: "All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire commingled in one bed" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1225–1227. Theme link: the shadow of a shade. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. Useful evidence: "Of bliss, hath but the show; / A moment, and the visions pale and fade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. On theme: The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to knowledge and blindness: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. Useful evidence: "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1201–1203. On theme: The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the theme in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. Useful evidence: "All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire commingled in one bed" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1225–1227. On theme: The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)" treats the shadow of a shade with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus Rex see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. Useful evidence: "Of bliss, hath but the show; / A moment, and the visions pale and fade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. On theme: The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. Useful evidence: "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1201–1203. Theme link: the shadow of a shade. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the shadow of a shade? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the

core idea.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. Useful evidence: “All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire commingled in one bed” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1225–1227. On theme: The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is the tone of the ode?

   A. Comic

   B. Mournful

   C. Hopeful

   D. Neutral

   Key: B (Mournful)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Antistrophe 2 All-seeing Time hath caught Guilt, and to justice brought The son and sire _____ in one bed.” Word bank: commingled

   Key: commingled

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus: “Races of _____ man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade”

   Key: mortal

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What has "All-seeing Time" done?

   A. Ended the oracle

   B. Forgiven Oedipus

   C. Brought the hidden guilt to light

   D. Healed the city

   Key: C (Brought the hidden guilt to light)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who is the Chorus's example?

   A. Oedipus

   B. Laius

   C. Creon

   D. Teiresias

   Key: A (Oedipus)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus: “Of bliss, hath but the show; / A moment, and the _____ pale and fade”

   Key: visions

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] According to the lesson's Significance note, how is the ode framed?

   A. As Teiresias' prophecy

   B. As the grief of the Chorus at this moment, open to debate against the ending

   C. As a rule to live by

   D. As a joke

   Key: B (As the grief of the Chorus at this moment, open to debate against the ending)

8. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is "a span" in line 1202?

   Sample answer: A very short length: life is brief.

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the Chorus compare human life to?

   A. A flame

   B. The shadow of a shade

   C. A mountain

   D. A river

   Key: B (The shadow of a shade)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why do the elders call Time "all-seeing"?

    Sample answer: Time reveals what people hide: Chorus, lines 1225–1227. The evidence is “All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire commingled in one bed” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus).

11. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The shadow of a shade.

    A. Knowledge and blindness

    B. Leadership and the city

    C. Fate and responsibility

    D. Pride and fall

    Key: A (Knowledge and blindness)

12. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in “Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)”? The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out.

    A. Imagery

    B. Hyperbole

    C. Foreshadowing

    D. Allusion

    Key: A (Imagery)

13. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus).

Sample answer: The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out. The evidence is “Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1201–1203. This develops knowledge and blindness: the shadow of a shade.

14. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is this ode the play's view of life? Compare it with the ending.

    Sample answer: A defended position: Chorus, lines 1201–1203. The evidence is “Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: the shadow of a shade. The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out.

15. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus) supports it: The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out. But “Of bliss, hath but the show; / A moment, and the visions pale and fade” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus) complicates it: Chorus, in this part of the section, and its “but” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. So the claim stands only in a qualified form: true of the scene's main pattern, but not of every moment in it.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how knowledge and blindness develops from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200) to Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232). Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman, the text reads “I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred” — Herdsman, lines 1131. In Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), “Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1201–1203. The shadow of a shade.

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)”?

    A. A king who promises to find the truth

    B. The shadow of a shade

    C. The herdsman and the recognition

    D. Good news that is not good

    Key: B (The shadow of a shade)

18. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1201–1203. The evidence is “Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: the shadow of a shade. The words “shadow” and “mortal” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out.

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), line 1157? “O best of _____, what is my offence?”

    A. masters

B. cannot

C. business

D. another

Key: A (masters)

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus: "All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire _____ in one bed"

    Key: commingled

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), lines 1201–1232: "Thy fall, O Oedipus, thy _____ fall Warns me none born of women blest to call." Word bank: desolate, silence, piteous, witchery

    Key: piteous

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)?

    A. "Corinthian, stranger, I address thee first, Is this the man thou meanest!"

    B. "And now old man, look up and answer all I ask thee."

    C. "But you, perchance, Having in past days known or seen the herd, May better by sure knowledge my surmise."

    D. "I recognise him; one of Laius' house; A simple hind, but true as any man."

    Key: C ("But you, perchance, Having in past days known or seen the herd, May better by sure knowledge my surmise.")

23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), line 1160 reveal about the character or situation? "If thou lack'st grace to speak, I'll loose thy tongue." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), line 1160) shows the situation turning on knowledge and blindness: the story keeps returning to knowledge and blindness. The words "tongue" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

24. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), lines 1201–1232 reveal about the character or situation? "Antistrophe 1 For he of marksmen best, O Zeus, outshot the rest, And won the prize supreme of wealth and power." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), lines 1201–1232) shows the situation turning on knowledge and blindness: the story keeps returning to knowledge and blindness. The words "marksmen" and "supreme" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

25. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1201–1203. The evidence is "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus).

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), line 1168 shapes its tone: "But, if I tell it, I am doubly lost." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "doubly" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), line 1168) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than

neutral. That weight points the reader to leadership and the city: the story keeps returning to leadership and the city. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), lines 1136–1137 to the story's treatment of mercy: “Then there Thou must have known yon man, at least by fame?” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), lines 1136–1137) develops mercy: the story keeps returning to mercy. Its words its wording carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The man here, having met him in past times …” (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), lines 1136–1137), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating mercy as central.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), lines 1150–1151 to the story's treatment of pride and fall: “Well, thou mast then remember giving me A child to rear as my own foster-son?” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), lines 1150–1151) develops pride and fall: the story keeps returning to pride and fall. Its words “remember” and “giving” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Softly, old man, rebuke him not; thy words Are more deserving chastisement than his.” (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), lines 1150–1151), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating pride and fall as central.

29. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), line 1140: “Off-hand I _____ call him well to mind.” Word bank: stranger, cannot, things, unless
    Key: cannot

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), lines 1223–1224? “How could the soil thy father eared so long Endure to bear in _____ such a wrong?”

    A. witchery
    B. piteous
    C. silence
    D. desolate

    Key: C (silence)

31. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), line 1175 shapes its tone: “If I must question thee again, thou’rt lost.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “question” (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), line 1175) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and responsibility: the story keeps returning to fate and responsibility. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), lines 1124–1125 shapes its tone: “I recognise him; one of Laius’ house; A simple hind, but true as any man.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “recognise” and “simple” (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), lines 1124–1125) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and responsibility: the story keeps returning to fate and responsibility. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), lines 1215–1216 shapes its tone: “We hailed thee king and from that day adored Of

mighty Thebes the universal lord." Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words "universal" and "adored" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), lines 1215–1216) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to leadership and the city: the story keeps returning to leadership and the city. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

34. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in "Of bliss, hath but the show; / A moment, and the visions pale and fade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Chorus, in this part of the section. The evidence is "Of bliss, hath but the show; / A moment, and the visions pale and fade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: the shadow of a shade. The words "visions" and "moment" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

35. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), lines 1126–1127? "Corinthian, _____, I address thee first, Is this the man thou meanest!"

    A. unless

    B. another

    C. business

    D. stranger

    Key: D (stranger)

36. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? "Of bliss, hath but the show; / A moment, and the visions pale and fade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus)

    A. Second Messenger, lines 1237–1240.

    B. The cost of falseness.

    C. Chorus, in this part of the section.

    D. The question that drives the whole play, repeated for emphasis.

    Key: C (Chorus, in this part of the section.)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire commingled in one bed" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1225–1227. The evidence is "All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire commingled in one bed" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: the shadow of a shade. The words "commingled" and "brought" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 1, analysis 3, synthesis 3
HS Freshman	2, 8, 9, 1, 5, 6, 4, 3, 7, 10, 17, 11, 18, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 2, analysis 1, synthesis 4
HS Sophomore	19, 4, 7, 20, 21, 1, 22, 23, 24, 10, 25, 26, 12, 11, 27, 28	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	29, 3, 30, 5, 9, 4, 23, 22, 10, 24, 31, 32, 11, 33, 28, 14	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
		recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3

HS Senior	2, 3, 4, 9, 23, 22, 24, 10, 25, 26, 31, 11, 33, 28, 27, 15	
AP	29, 9, 2, 5, 4, 22, 23, 26, 32, 31, 33, 34, 27, 28, 18, 15	recall 5, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	35, 3, 1, 6, 23, 22, 10, 31, 32, 26, 33, 11, 28, 27, 16, 15	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	29, 3, 9, 23, 24, 36, 32, 13, 11, 12, 33, 27, 28, 16, 14, 15	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	2, 4, 3, 22, 23, 26, 31, 32, 33, 11, 12, 28, 27, 15, 14, 16	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 6, synthesis 5
College Senior	9, 3, 6, 5, 22, 32, 26, 33, 11, 28, 27, 15, 18, 37, 16, 14	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 4, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	35, 2, 3, 22, 17, 31, 26, 32, 11, 34, 13, 27, 28, 16, 15, 14	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 6, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232),” how does Sophocles show the shadow of a shade? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the theme you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1): In Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), how does Sophocles develop the idea of the shadow of a shade? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the theme in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232) develops the idea of the shadow of a shade. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its theme shape the reader's understanding of the shadow of a shade. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232) suggests about the shadow of a shade. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's theme and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses theme in Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232) to complicate the reader's understanding of the shadow of a shade. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Situate Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232) within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the shadow of a shade responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Read Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232) alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the shadow of a shade follows or bends those conventions, using the theme as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232) and its treatment of the shadow of a shade. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's theme and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop a research argument that reads Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232) as evidence for a larger claim about the shadow of a shade in Oedipus Rex. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop an original argument that reads Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232) as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the shadow of a shade. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Oedipus Rex.

SAT-style questions

1. *Strophe 1 Races of mortal man Whose life is but a span, I count ye but the shadow of a shade! For he who most doth know Of bliss, hath but the show; A moment, and the visions pale and fade. Thy fall, O Oedipus, thy piteous fall Warns me none born of women blest to call. Antistrophe 1 For he of marksmen best, O Zeus, outshot the rest, And won the prize supreme of wealth and power. By him the vulture maid Was quelled, her witchery laid; He rose our saviour and the land's strong tower. We hailed thee king and from that day adored Of mighty Thebes the universal lord. Strophe 2 O heavy hand of fate! Who now more desolate, Whose tale more sad than thine, whose lot more dire? O Oedipus, discrownèd head, Thy cradle was thy marriage bed; One harbourage sufficed for son and sire. How could the soil thy father eared so long Endure to bear in silence such a wrong? Antistrophe 2 All-seeing Time hath caught Guilt, and to justice brought The son and sire commingled in one bed. O child of Laius' ill-starred race Would I had ne'er beheld thy face! I raise for thee a dirge as o'er the dead. Yet, sooth to say, through thee I drew new breath, And now through thee I feel a second death.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)"?

   A. A king who promises to find the truth

   B. A hopeful guess

   C. The shadow of a shade

   D. The curse and the prophet

SAT key: 1. C (The shadow of a shade)

Lesson 12: Exodos (lines 1233–1544)

Focus: responsibility, mercy and the end

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (suicide or self-harm (reported), alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently. Read the framing announcement aloud before this reading; cite method lines by number only. This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…ver sat beside me at the board Sharing my viands, drinking of my cup, For them, I pray thee, care,…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: In this last part of the play a messenger reports that Queen Jocasta has taken her own life offstage, and Oedipus blinds himself; your teacher will talk about it before we read.
Suggested language: "What does the play show about the cost of this loss?"
Safe messaging: Teacher reads aloud before the reading. What happens: in this last part of the play a messenger reports that Queen Jocasta, having understood the truth, has taken her own life inside the palace. The method lines (1278–1281) are read as part of the text but are cited by line number only in our discussion and in every task. Oedipus then blinds himself, which is also reported, and the play shows us his grief. Context: in Greek tragedy such events happen offstage and are reported by a messenger. The play does not present Jocasta's death as noble or as a solution; it shows it as the ruin of a family. Self-harm is wrong, and it is never the answer to pain. If you or someone you know is struggling, call or text 988, or chat at 988lifeline.org (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.); talk with a school counselor; or tell a trusted adult. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling, call or text 988, or chat at 988lifeline.org (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.); talk with a school counselor; or tell a trusted adult. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over.

Background: In Greek tragedy violent events happen offstage and are reported. Suicide-method lines (1278–1281, Jocasta) are cited by line number only and never quoted or asked about; the self-blinding may be quoted and taught as drama with context (Brandon's rule, 2026-10-22).

Significance: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Teacher reads aloud before the reading. What happens: in this last part of the play a messenger reports that Queen Jocasta, having understood the truth, has taken her own life inside the palace. The method lines (1278–1281) are read as part of the text but are cited by line number only in our discussion and in every task. Oedipus then blinds himself, which is also reported, and the play shows us his grief. Context: in Greek tragedy such events happen offstage and are reported by a messenger. The play does not present Jocasta's death as noble or as a solution; it shows it as the ruin of a family. Self-harm is wrong, and it is never the answer to pain. If you or someone you know is struggling, call or text 988, or chat at 988lifeline.org (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.); talk with a school counselor; or tell a trusted adult. *Teacher reads aloud before the reading. What happens: in this last part of the play a messenger reports that Queen Jocasta, having understood the truth, has taken her own life inside the palace. The method lines (1278–1281) are read as part of the text but are cited by line number only in our discussion and in every task. Oedipus then blinds himself, which is also reported, and the play shows us his grief. Context: in Greek tragedy such events happen offstage and are reported by a messenger. The play does not present Jocasta's death as noble or as a solution; it shows it as the ruin of a family. Self-harm is wrong, and it is never the answer to pain. If you or someone you know is struggling, call or text 988, or chat at 988lifeline.org (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.); talk with a school counselor; or tell a trusted adult.*
Teacher reads aloud before the reading. What happens: in this last part of the play a messenger reports that Queen Jocasta, having understood the truth, has taken her own life inside the palace. The method lines (1278–1281) are read as part of the text but are cited by line number only in our discussion and in every task. Oedipus then blinds himself, which is also reported, and the play shows us his grief. Context: in Greek tragedy such events happen offstage and are reported by a messenger. The play does not present Jocasta's death as noble or as a solution; it shows it as the ruin of a family. Self-harm is wrong, and it is never the answer to pain. If you or someone you know is struggling, call or text 988, or chat at 988lifeline.org (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.); talk with a school counselor; or tell a trusted adult.
What does it mean to take responsibility for something you did not intend? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to knowledge and blindness because....
Prompt: What does it mean to take responsibility for something you did not intend?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to knowledge and blindness because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: responsibility, mercy and the end.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
One key word in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: derision — mockery; scornful laughter.
Words: derision: mockery; scornful laughter

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
In Greek tragedy violent events happen offstage and are reported. Suicide-method lines (1278–1281, Jocasta) are cited by line number only and never quoted or asked about; the self-blinding may be quoted and taught as drama with context (Brandon's rule, 2026-10-22). Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. Look closely: Give the one-line reminder before reading: Jocasta's death is reported here; the method lines (1278–1281) are cited by line number only and are not quoted or discussed. The self-blinding may be quoted and taught as drama with context (lines 1343–1346).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light, / Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly." slowly and put it in my own words: The Second Messenger says that not even the great rivers Ister and Phasis could wash the blood from the royal house, and that new ills, done on purpose, are about to come to light. Next, craft. I notice the rivers are hyperbole, and the last line sets malice against unwittingly, chosen acts against the unknowing crimes of the past. The strongest word is "unwittingly": the earlier crimes were done without knowledge; what follows is chosen. Then, effect. What does the contrast between malice and unwittingly add to the messenger's report? My answer: The contrast between malice and unwittingly prepares the report: the old crimes were done without knowledge, but the acts the messenger is about to describe were chosen, so the audience is warned before he speaks.

> *Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light, / Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly.* *(Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Second Messenger)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light, / Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly." slowly and put it in my own words: The Second Messenger says that not even the great rivers Ister and Phasis could wash the blood from the royal house, and that new ills, done on purpose, are about to come to light. Next, craft. I notice the rivers are hyperbole, and the last line sets malice against unwittingly, chosen acts against the unknowing crimes of the past. The strongest word is "unwittingly": the earlier crimes were done without knowledge; what follows is chosen. Then, effect. What does the contrast between malice and unwittingly add to the messenger's report? My answer: The contrast between malice and unwittingly prepares the report: the old crimes were done without knowledge, but the acts the messenger is about to describe were chosen, so the audience is warned before he speaks.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: In Greek tragedy violent events happen offstage and are reported. Suicide-method lines (1278–1281, Jocasta) are cited by line number only and never quoted or asked about; the self-blinding may be quoted and taught as drama with context (Brandon's rule, 2026-10-22). Read closely: "Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was That brought these ills to pass; But the right hand that dealt the blow Was mine, none other." (Oedipus, lines 1343–1346). Ask: How does this line connect to knowledge and blindness? Expected: Responsibility, mercy and the end. (Oedipus, lines 1343–1346.)

> *Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other* *(Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: In Greek tragedy violent events happen offstage and are reported. Suicide-method lines (1278–1281, Jocasta) are cited by line number only and never quoted or asked about; the self-blinding may be quoted and taught as drama with context (Brandon's rule, 2026-10-22). Read closely: "Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was That brought these ills to pass; But the right hand that dealt the blow Was mine, none other." (Oedipus, lines 1343–1346).
Ask: How does this line connect to knowledge and blindness?
Expected answer: Responsibility, mercy and the end. (Oedipus, lines 1343–1346.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for characterization, theme (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about responsibility, mercy and the end? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Exodos (lines 1233–1544) develops the idea of responsibility, mercy and the end. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. When the text says "Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus), it shows this directly. A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over.

Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, theme (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about responsibility, mercy and the end? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Exodos (lines 1233–1544) develops the idea of responsibility, mercy and the end. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. When the text says "Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus), it shows this directly. A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: What does it mean to take responsibility for something you did not intend? Ask: What does it mean to take responsibility for something you did not intend?

Anchor question: What does it mean to take responsibility for something you did not intend?

Facilitation: Ask: What does it mean to take responsibility for something you did not intend?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about responsibility, mercy and the end? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. ("Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other", Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about responsibility, mercy and the end? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. ("Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other", Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes responsibility, mercy and the end. Key takeaway: responsibility, mercy and the end.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over.
- **Theme:** A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over.
- **Structure:** A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over.

Themes and how they develop

- **knowledge and blindness:** responsibility, mercy and the end.

Symbols and motifs

- **sight and blindness:** The section adds to the play's pattern of sight and blindness: responsibility, mercy and the end.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light, / Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Second Messenger) Second Messenger, lines 1237–1240.
- "Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 1343–1346.
- "Come hither, deign to touch an abject wretch; / Draw near and fear not; I myself must bear / The load of guilt that none but I can share" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 1418–1420.
- "Not in derision, Oedipus, I come / Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Creon) Creon, lines 1427–1428.
- "To you, my children I had much to say, / Were ye but ripe to hear. Let this suffice: / Pray ye may find some home and live content, / And may your lot prove happier than your sire's" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 1518–1521.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair.
Evidence: "Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus)
Reasoning: A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Line 1192
1192 **Herdsman:** Through pity, master, for the babe. I thought

Lines 1201–1203
1201 **Chorus:** Races of mortal man
1202 **Chorus:** Whose life is but a span,
1203 **Chorus:** I count ye but the shadow of a shade!

Lines 1237–1240

1237 **Second Messenger:** Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween,
1238 **Second Messenger:** Could wash away the blood-stains from this house,
1239 **Second Messenger:** The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light,
1240 **Second Messenger:** Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly.

Lines 1242–1243

1242 **Chorus:** Grievous enough for all our tears and groans
1243 **Chorus:** Our past calamities; what canst thou add?

Lines 1247–1248

1247 **Second Messenger:** By her own hand. And all the horror of it,
1248 **Second Messenger:** Not having seen, yet cannot apprehend.

Lines 1247–1301

1247 **Second Messenger:** By her own hand. And all the horror of it,
1248 **Second Messenger:** Not having seen, yet cannot apprehend.
1249 **Second Messenger:** Nathless, as far as my poor memory serves,
1250 **Second Messenger:** I will relate the unhappy lady's woe.
1251 **Second Messenger:** When in her frenzy she had passed inside
1252 **Second Messenger:** The vestibule, she hurried straight to win
1253 **Second Messenger:** The bridal-chamber, clutching at her hair
1254 **Second Messenger:** With both her hands, and, once within the room,
1255 **Second Messenger:** She shut the doors behind her with a crash.
1256 **Second Messenger:** "Laius," she cried, and called her husband dead
1257 **Second Messenger:** Long, long ago; her thought was of that child
1258 **Second Messenger:** By him begot, the son by whom the sire
1259 **Second Messenger:** Was murdered and the mother left to breed
1260 **Second Messenger:** With her own seed, a monstrous progeny.
1261 **Second Messenger:** Then she bewailed the marriage bed whereon
1262 **Second Messenger:** Poor wretch, she had conceived a double brood,
1263 **Second Messenger:** Husband by husband, children by her child.
1264 **Second Messenger:** What happened after that I cannot tell,
1265 **Second Messenger:** Nor how the end befell, for with a shriek
1266 **Second Messenger:** Burst on us Oedipus; all eyes were fixed
1267 **Second Messenger:** On Oedipus, as up and down he strode,
1268 **Second Messenger:** Nor could we mark her agony to the end.
1269 **Second Messenger:** For stalking to and fro "A sword!" he cried,
1270 **Second Messenger:** "Where is the wife, no wife, the teeming womb
1271 **Second Messenger:** That bore a double harvest, me and mine?"
1272 **Second Messenger:** And in his frenzy some supernal power
1273 **Second Messenger:** (No mortal, surely, none of us who watched him)
1274 **Second Messenger:** Guided his footsteps; with a terrible shriek,
1275 **Second Messenger:** As though one beckoned him, he crashed against
1276 **Second Messenger:** The folding doors, and from their staples forced

1277 **Second Messenger:** The wrenchèd bolts and hurled himself within.
[lines 1278–1281: cited by line number only]
1282 **Second Messenger:** Lay stretched on earth, what followed—O 'twas dread!
1283 **Second Messenger:** He tore the golden brooches that upheld
1284 **Second Messenger:** Her queenly robes, upraised them high and smote
1285 **Second Messenger:** Full on his eye-balls, uttering words like these:
1286 **Second Messenger:** "No more shall ye behold such sights of woe,
1287 **Second Messenger:** Deeds I have suffered and myself have wrought;
1288 **Second Messenger:** Henceforward quenched in darkness shall ye see
1289 **Second Messenger:** Those ye should ne'er have seen; now blind to those
1290 **Second Messenger:** Whom, when I saw, I vainly yearned to know."
1291 **Second Messenger:** Such was the burden of his moan, whereto,
1292 **Second Messenger:** Not once but oft, he struck with his hand uplift
1293 **Second Messenger:** His eyes, and at each stroke the ensanguined orbs
1294 **Second Messenger:** Bedewed his beard, not oozing drop by drop,
1295 **Second Messenger:** But one black gory downpour, thick as hail.
1296 **Second Messenger:** Such evils, issuing from the double source,
1297 **Second Messenger:** Have whelmed them both, confounding man and wife.
1298 **Second Messenger:** Till now the storied fortune of this house
1299 **Second Messenger:** Was fortunate indeed; but from this day
1300 **Second Messenger:** Woe, lamentation, ruin, death, disgrace,
1301 **Second Messenger:** All ills that can be named, all, all are theirs.

Lines 1303–1313
1303 **Second Messenger:** He cries, "Unbar the doors and let all Thebes
1304 **Second Messenger:** Behold the slayer of his sire, his mother's—"
1305 **Second Messenger:** That shameful word my lips may not repeat.
1306 **Second Messenger:** He vows to fly self-banished from the land,
1307 **Second Messenger:** Nor stay to bring upon his house the curse
1308 **Second Messenger:** Himself had uttered; but he has no strength
1309 **Second Messenger:** Nor one to guide him, and his torture's more
1310 **Second Messenger:** Than man can suffer, as yourselves will see.
1311 **Second Messenger:** For lo, the palace portals are unbarred,
1312 **Second Messenger:** And soon ye shall behold a sight so sad
1313 **Second Messenger:** That he who must abhorred would pity it.

Lines 1311–1313
1311 **Second Messenger:** For lo, the palace portals are unbarred,
1312 **Second Messenger:** And soon ye shall behold a sight so sad
1313 **Second Messenger:** That he who must abhorred would pity it.

Lines 1314–1324
1314 **Chorus:** Woeful sight! more woeful none
1315 **Chorus:** These sad eyes have looked upon.
1316 **Chorus:** Whence this madness? None can tell

1317 **Chorus:** Who did cast on thee his spell,
1318 **Chorus:** Prowling all thy life around,
1319 **Chorus:** Leaping with a demon bound.
1320 **Chorus:** Hapless wretch! how can I brook
1321 **Chorus:** On thy misery to look?
1322 **Chorus:** Though to gaze on thee I yearn,
1323 **Chorus:** Much to question, much to learn,
1324 **Chorus:** Horror-struck away I turn.

Lines 1325–1329
1325 **Oedipus:** Ah me! ah woe is me!
1326 **Oedipus:** Ah whither am I borne!
1327 **Oedipus:** How like a ghost forlorn
1328 **Oedipus:** My voice flits from me on the air!
1329 **Oedipus:** On, on the demon goads. The end, ah where?

Line 1330
1330 **Chorus:** An end too dread to tell, too dark to see.

Lines 1341–1342
1341 **Chorus:** O doer of dread deeds, how couldst thou mar
1342 **Chorus:** Thy vision thus? What demon goaded thee?

Lines 1343–1346
1343 **Oedipus:** Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was
1344 **Oedipus:** That brought these ills to pass;
1345 **Oedipus:** But the right hand that dealt the blow
1346 **Oedipus:** Was mine, none other. How,

Lines 1350–1351
1350 **Oedipus:** Say, friends, can any look or voice
1351 **Oedipus:** Or touch of love henceforth my heart rejoice?

Lines 1350–1355
1350 **Oedipus:** Say, friends, can any look or voice
1351 **Oedipus:** Or touch of love henceforth my heart rejoice?
1352 **Oedipus:** Haste, friends, no fond delay.
1353 **Oedipus:** Take the twice cursed away
1354 **Oedipus:** Far from all ken,
1355 **Oedipus:** The man abhorred of gods, accursed of men.

Lines 1363–1366
1363 **Oedipus:** Then had I never come to shed
1364 **Oedipus:** My father's blood nor climbed my mother's bed;
1365 **Oedipus:** The monstrous offspring of a womb defiled,
1366 **Oedipus:** Co-mate of him who gendered me, and child.

Lines 1363–1368

1363 **Oedipus:** Then had I never come to shed
1364 **Oedipus:** My father's blood nor climbed my mother's bed;
1365 **Oedipus:** The monstrous offspring of a womb defiled,
1366 **Oedipus:** Co-mate of him who gendered me, and child.
1367 **Oedipus:** Was ever man before afflicted thus,
1368 **Oedipus:** Like Oedipus.

Lines 1418–1420

1418 **Oedipus:** Come hither, deign to touch an abject wretch;
1419 **Oedipus:** Draw near and fear not; I myself must bear
1420 **Oedipus:** The load of guilt that none but I can share.

Lines 1427–1428

1427 **Creon:** Not in derision, Oedipus, I come
1428 **Creon:** Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds.

Lines 1429–1431

1429 **Creon:** But shame upon you! if ye feel no sense
1430 **Creon:** Of human decencies, at least revere
1431 **Creon:** The Sun whose light beholds and nurtures all.

Lines 1429–1436

1429 **Creon:** But shame upon you! if ye feel no sense
1430 **Creon:** Of human decencies, at least revere
1431 **Creon:** The Sun whose light beholds and nurtures all.
1432 **Creon:** Leave not thus nakedly for all to gaze at
1433 **Creon:** A horror neither earth nor rain from heaven
1434 **Creon:** Nor light will suffer. Lead him straight within,
1435 **Creon:** For it is seemly that a kinsman's woes
1436 **Creon:** Be heard by kin and seen by kin alone.

Lines 1442–1444

1442 **Oedipus:** Forth from thy borders thrust me with all speed;
1443 **Oedipus:** Set me within some vasty desert where
1444 **Oedipus:** No mortal voice shall greet me any more.

Lines 1447–1448

1447 **Oedipus:** His will was set forth fully—to destroy
1448 **Oedipus:** The parricide, the scoundrel; and I am he.

Lines 1453–1483

1453 **Oedipus:** Aye, and on thee in all humility
1454 **Oedipus:** I lay this charge: let her who lies within
1455 **Oedipus:** Receive such burial as thou shalt ordain;
1456 **Oedipus:** Such rites 'tis thine, as brother, to perform.

1457 **Oedipus:** But for myself, O never let my Thebes,
1458 **Oedipus:** The city of my sires, be doomed to bear
1459 **Oedipus:** The burden of my presence while I live.
1460 **Oedipus:** No, let me be a dweller on the hills,
1461 **Oedipus:** On yonder mount Cithaeron, famed as mine,
1462 **Oedipus:** My tomb predestined for me by my sire
1463 **Oedipus:** And mother, while they lived, that I may die
1464 **Oedipus:** Slain as they sought to slay me, when alive.
1465 **Oedipus:** This much I know full surely, nor disease
1466 **Oedipus:** Shall end my days, nor any common chance;
1467 **Oedipus:** For I had ne'er been snatched from death, unless
1468 **Oedipus:** I was predestined to some awful doom.
1469 **Oedipus:** So be it. I reck not how Fate deals with me
1470 **Oedipus:** But my unhappy children—for my sons
1471 **Oedipus:** Be not concerned, O Creon, they are men,
1472 **Oedipus:** And for themselves, where'er they be, can fend.
1473 **Oedipus:** But for my daughters twain, poor innocent maids,
1474 **Oedipus:** Who ever sat beside me at the board
1475 **Oedipus:** Sharing my viands, drinking of my cup,
1476 **Oedipus:** For them, I pray thee, care, and, if thou willst,
1477 **Oedipus:** O might I feel their touch and make my moan.
1478 **Oedipus:** Hear me, O prince, my noble-hearted prince!
1479 **Oedipus:** Could I but blindly touch them with my hands,
1480 **Oedipus:** I'd think they still were mine, as when I saw.
1481 **Oedipus:** What say I? can it be my pretty ones
1482 **Oedipus:** Whose sobs I hear? Has Creon pitied me
1483 **Oedipus:** And sent me my two darlings? Can this be?

Lines 1457–1459

1457 **Oedipus:** But for myself, O never let my Thebes,
1458 **Oedipus:** The city of my sires, be doomed to bear
1459 **Oedipus:** The burden of my presence while I live.

Lines 1479–1480

1479 **Oedipus:** Could I but blindly touch them with my hands,
1480 **Oedipus:** I'd think they still were mine, as when I saw.

Lines 1481–1482

1481 **Oedipus:** What say I? can it be my pretty ones
1482 **Oedipus:** Whose sobs I hear? Has Creon pitied me

Lines 1481–1483

1481 **Oedipus:** What say I? can it be my pretty ones
1482 **Oedipus:** Whose sobs I hear? Has Creon pitied me
1483 **Oedipus:** And sent me my two darlings? Can this be?

Lines 1484–1485

1484 **Creon:** 'Tis true; 'twas I procured thee this delight,
1485 **Creon:** Knowing the joy they were to thee of old.

Lines 1518–1521

1518 **Oedipus:** To you, my children I had much to say,
1519 **Oedipus:** Were ye but ripe to hear. Let this suffice:
1520 **Oedipus:** Pray ye may find some home and live content,
1521 **Oedipus:** And may your lot prove happier than your sire's.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
derision (noun)	mockery; scornful laughter	*Not in derision, Oedipus, I come Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds.*	

Discussion questions

1. What does it mean to take responsibility for something you did not intend?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with knowledge and blindness?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Creon say in lines 1427–1428? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He has not come to mock or blame Oedipus.
2. How does the audience learn of the events in the palace? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A messenger reports them
3. Who must bear the load of guilt, Oedipus says in lines 1418–1420? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He himself, and no one else
4. How does Creon treat Oedipus? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Without mocking or blaming him
5. What does Oedipus ask Creon to do? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Send him into exile and care for his daughters

6. What is the Chorus's final warning? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Count no one happy until life is over
7. Retell the three most important events of "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be…
8. Who is on stage in "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Not in derision, Oedipus, I come Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds." What does "derision" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: derision: mockery; scornful laughter.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does Oedipus' farewell to his daughters (1518–1521) show about him now? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Care and humility; he wishes them a happier life than his.
2. What does "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)" suggest about responsibility, mercy and the end? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the theme in this scene shape what we understand about responsibility, mercy and the end? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. Useful evidence: "Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light, / Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Second Messenger): Second Messenger, lines 1237–1240. On theme: A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no

one happy until his life is over. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Most grave and reverend senators of Thebes, What deeds ye soon must hear, what sights behold!”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Exodos (lines 1233–1544)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear…
7. How does “Exodos (lines 1233–1544)” build on “Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. Useful evidence: “Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other” (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1343–1346. On structure: A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. Useful evidence: “Come hither, deign to touch an abject wretch; / Draw near and fear not; I myself must bear / The load of guilt that none but I can share” (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1418–1420. On characterization: A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What does it mean to take responsibility for something you did not intend?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with knowledge and blindness? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5,

SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. Useful evidence: “Not in derision, Oedipus, I come / Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds” (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Creon): Creon, lines 1427–1428. On structure: A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Oedipus guilty? Write a literary argument using lines 1418–1420 and one earlier scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position; no item asks how anyone died or was hurt.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. Useful evidence: “To you, my children I had much to say, / Were ye but ripe to hear. Let this suffice: / Pray ye may find some home and live content, / And may your lot prove happier than your sire’s” (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1518–1521. On theme: A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. Useful evidence: “Not Ister nor all Phasis’ flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light, / Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly” (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Second Messenger): Second Messenger, lines 1237–1240. On theme: A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. Useful evidence: “Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other” (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1343–1346. On characterization: A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Exodos (lines 1233–1544)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of responsibility, mercy and the end. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. Useful evidence: “Come hither, deign to touch an abject wretch; / Draw near and fear not; I myself must bear / The load of guilt that none but I can share” (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1418–1420. On structure: A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Exodos (lines 1233–1544)”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. Useful evidence: “Not in derision, Oedipus, I come / Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds” (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Creon): Creon, lines 1427–1428. On theme: A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate and responsibility: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. Useful evidence: “To you, my children I had much to say, / Were ye but ripe to hear. Let this suffice: / Pray ye may find some home and live content, / And may your lot prove happier than your sire’s” (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1518–1521. On theme: A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. Useful evidence: “Not Ister nor all Phasis’ flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light, / Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly” (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Second Messenger): Second Messenger, lines 1237–1240. On characterization: A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Exodos (lines 1233–1544)” treats responsibility, mercy and the end with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus Rex see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. Useful evidence: “Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other” (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1343–1346. On theme: A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. As the final scene, does this ending resolve knowledge and blindness? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. Useful evidence: “Come hither, deign to

touch an abject wretch; / Draw near and fear not; I myself must bear / The load of guilt that none but I can share" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1418–1420. Theme link: responsibility, mercy and the end. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about responsibility, mercy and the end? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. Useful evidence: "Not in derision, Oedipus, I come / Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Creon): Creon, lines 1427–1428. On theme: A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does the audience learn of the events in the palace?

    A. A letter is read

    B. A messenger reports them

    C. They are acted on stage

    D. Teiresias predicts them

    Key: B (A messenger reports them)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who must bear the load of guilt, Oedipus says in lines 1418–1420?

    A. The Chorus

    B. He himself, and no one else

    C. Laius

    D. Creon

    Key: B (He himself, and no one else)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Creon treat Oedipus?

    A. Without mocking or blaming him

B. By ignoring him

C. With insults

D. By imprisoning him

Key: A (Without mocking or blaming him)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is the Chorus's final warning?

   A. Pride is always rewarded

   B. Always obey the king

   C. Never trust a prophet

   D. Count no one happy until life is over

   Key: D (Count no one happy until life is over)

5. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Creon say in lines 1427–1428?

   Sample answer: He has not come to mock or blame Oedipus.

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus: "Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That _____ these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other"

   Key: brought

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Not in derision, Oedipus, I come Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds.", what does "derision" most nearly mean?

   A. mockery; scornful laughter

   B. foretelling the future

   C. the spread of disease

   D. the killing of one's father, or the person who does it

   Key: A (mockery; scornful laughter)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Oedipus ask Creon to do?

   A. Send him into exile and care for his daughters

   B. Make him king again

   C. Kill the herdsman

   D. Destroy the oracle

   Key: A (Send him into exile and care for his daughters)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Creon: "Not in _____, Oedipus, I come / Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds"

   Key: derision

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus: "Come _____, deign to touch an abject wretch; / Draw near and fear not; I myself must bear / The load of guilt that none but I can share"

    Key: hither

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Oedipus' farewell to his daughters (1518–1521) show about him now?

    Sample answer: Care and humility; he wishes them a happier life than his. The evidence is "To you, my children I had much to say, / Were ye but ripe to hear. Let this suffice: / Pray ye may find some home and live content, / And…" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1518–1521.

12. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Responsibility, mercy and the end. Name the theme and explain in two or three sentences, quoting the text.

    Sample answer: Knowledge and blindness. Responsibility, mercy and the end. The evidence is "Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to…" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Second Messenger) — Second Messenger, lines 1237–1240. This develops knowledge and blindness: responsibility, mercy and the end.

13. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "Come hither, deign to touch an abject wretch; / Draw near and fear not; I myself must bear / The load of guilt that none but I can share" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1418–1420. The evidence is "Come hither, deign to touch an abject wretch; / Draw near and fear not; I myself must bear / The load of guilt that none but I can share" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus). This develops knowledge and blindness: responsibility, mercy and the end. The words "myself" and "hither" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)"? A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama…

    A. Characterization

    B. Metaphor

    C. Simile

    D. Irony

    Key: A (Characterization)

15. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Oedipus guilty? Write a literary argument using lines 1418–1420 and one earlier scene.

    Sample answer: A defended position; no item asks how anyone died or was hurt. The evidence is "Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1343–1346. This develops knowledge and blindness: responsibility, mercy and the end. A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: "Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. "Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus) supports it: A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over. But "Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it

shrouds or soon will bring to light, / Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly." (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Second Messenger) complicates it: the line (Second Messenger, lines 1237–1240) shows the same issue from another side, and its "Not" marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. The claim is therefore a strong reading, not a complete one, and a careful answer says where it stops applying.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Not in _____, Oedipus, I come Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds." Word bank: derision

    Key: derision

18. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light, / Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Second Messenger) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Second Messenger, lines 1237–1240. The evidence is "Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to…" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Second Messenger).

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1343–1346. The evidence is "Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus).

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1325–1329? "How like a ghost _____ My voice flits from me on the air!"

    A. yourselves

    B. respite

    C. woeful

    D. forlorn

    Key: D (forlorn)

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1242–1243: "Grievous enough for all our tears and groans Our past _____; what canst thou add?" Word bank: looked, calamities, wretch, forlorn

    Key: calamities

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Exodos (lines 1233–1544)?

    A. "My tale is quickly told and quickly heard."

    B. "Grievous enough for all our tears and groans Our past calamities; what canst thou add?"

    C. "And all the horror of it, Not having seen, yet cannot apprehend."

    D. "Alas, poor queen! how came she by her death?"

    Key: B ("Grievous enough for all our tears and groans Our past calamities; what canst thou add?")

23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Exodos (lines 1233–1544), line 1330 reveal about the character or situation? "An end too dread to tell, too dark to see." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), line 1330) shows the situation turning on knowledge and blindness:

the story keeps returning to knowledge and blindness. The words its wording are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

24. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1457–1459 reveal about the character or situation? “But for myself, O never let my Thebes, The city of my sires, be doomed to bear The burden of my presence while I live.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1457–1459) shows the situation turning on knowledge and blindness: the story keeps returning to knowledge and blindness. The words “presence” and “burden” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Exodos (lines 1233–1544)”?

    A. A city praying for rescue

    B. Responsibility, mercy and the end

    C. Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear

    D. Pride breeds the tyrant

    Key: B (Responsibility, mercy and the end)

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1350–1351 shapes its tone: “Say, friends, can any look or voice Or touch of love henceforth my heart rejoice?” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “henceforth” and “friends” (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1350–1351) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to leadership and the city: the story keeps returning to leadership and the city. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1429–1431 to the story's treatment of mercy: “But shame upon you! if ye feel no sense Of human decencies, at least revere The Sun whose light beholds and nurtures all.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1429–1431) develops mercy: the story keeps returning to mercy. Its words “decencies” and “nurtures” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Lead him straight within, For it is seemly that a kinsman’s woes Be heard by kin and seen by kin alone.” (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1429–1431), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating mercy as central.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1481–1483 to the story's treatment of mercy: “What say I? can it be my pretty ones / Whose sobs I hear? Has Creon pitied me / And sent me my two darlings? Can this be?” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1481–1483) develops mercy: the blinded Oedipus hears his daughters and realizes that Creon, whom he once accused of plotting against him, has pitied him and brought them. The word “pitied” names a mercy he did not expect. The same concern returns in “Through pity, master, for the babe.” (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman, line 1192): the herdsman spared the infant out of pity. Together the two moments show mercy at the beginning and the end of Oedipus' story, the pity that saved him as a baby and the pity that comforts him in ruin.

29. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1341–1342: “O doer of dread deeds, how _____ thou mar Thy vision thus?” Word bank: wretch, darkness, looked,

couldst

Key: couldst

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1247–1248 shapes its tone: "And all the horror of it, Not having seen, yet cannot apprehend." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "apprehend" and "cannot" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1247–1248) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and responsibility: the story keeps returning to fate and responsibility. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

31. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1363–1366 shapes its tone: "Then had I never come to shed My father's blood nor climbed my mother's bed; The monstrous offspring of a womb defiled, Co-mate of him who gendered me, and child." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "monstrous" and "offspring" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1363–1366) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and responsibility: the story keeps returning to fate and responsibility. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Second Messenger: "Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light, / Ills wrought of malice, not _____"

    Key: unwittingly

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1481–1482 shapes its tone: "What say I? can it be my pretty ones / Whose sobs I hear?" Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "pretty" and "sobs" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1481–1482) make the tone tender and broken. "Pretty ones" is a father's endearment for his daughters, while "sobs" shows that the blinded Oedipus can only hear them, not see them. The pairing turns the scene toward family and loss: the king who searched for the truth of his birth now reaches for his children by sound alone.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1484–1485 to the story's treatment of mercy: "'Tis true; 'twas I procured thee this delight, / Knowing the joy they were to thee of old." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1484–1485) develops mercy: Creon, whom Oedipus once accused of plotting against him, answers his ruin with kindness and brings him his daughters. The word "delight" shows that the mercy is personal, not political. The same concern returns in "Through pity, master, for the babe." (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman, line 1192): the herdsman spared the infant out of pity. Together the two moments show mercy at the beginning and the end of Oedipus' story, the pity that saved him as a baby and the kindness that comforts him in ruin.

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1311–1313 to the story's treatment of pride and fall: "For lo, the palace portals are unbarred, And soon ye shall behold a sight so sad That he who must abhorred would pity it." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1311–1313) develops pride and fall: the story keeps returning to pride and fall. Its words "abhorred" and "unbarred" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "None can tell Who did cast on thee his spell, Prowling all thy life around, Leaping with a demon bound." (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1311–1313), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating pride and fall as central.

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Claim: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other” (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus).

    Sample answer: A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over. The evidence is “Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other” (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1343–1346. This develops knowledge and blindness: responsibility, mercy and the end.

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1442–1444 to the story's treatment of pride and fall: “Forth from thy borders thrust me with all speed; Set me within some vasty desert where No mortal voice shall greet me any more.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1442–1444) develops pride and fall: the story keeps returning to pride and fall. Its words “borders” and “desert” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “His will was set forth fully—to destroy The parricide, the scoundrel; and I am he.” (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), lines 1442–1444), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating pride and fall as central.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Synthesis: trace how knowledge and blindness develops from Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232) to Exodos (lines 1233–1544). Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus, the text reads “Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade” — Chorus, lines 1201–1203. In Exodos (lines 1233–1544), “Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to…” (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Second Messenger) — Second Messenger, lines 1237–1240. Responsibility, mercy and the end.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other” (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1343–1346. The evidence is “Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other” (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus). This develops knowledge and blindness: responsibility, mercy and the end. The words “brought” and “friend” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over.

40. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which word completes this sentence from Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus, lines 1479–1480? “Could I but _____ touch them with my hands, / I'd think they still were mine, as when I saw.”

    A. blindly

    B. gladly

    C. proudly

D. coldly

Key: A (blindly)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 1, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Freshman	3, 2, 17, 4, 7, 5, 10, 8, 1, 18, 11, 19, 13, 14, 12, 16	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	10, 2, 7, 9, 20, 21, 22, 23, 11, 24, 25, 26, 12, 13, 27, 28	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	3, 10, 4, 29, 7, 25, 19, 23, 22, 11, 13, 30, 31, 12, 27, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	32, 2, 5, 8, 6, 11, 24, 22, 23, 14, 33, 12, 30, 34, 15, 27	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	7, 10, 2, 9, 1, 11, 22, 12, 31, 33, 26, 30, 15, 27, 16, 35	recall 5, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	29, 17, 7, 1, 25, 22, 11, 31, 26, 30, 12, 13, 15, 27, 35, 28	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	32, 4, 10, 1, 25, 22, 30, 36, 13, 31, 33, 37, 38, 27, 34, 15	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	17, 4, 10, 1, 2, 30, 12, 31, 14, 26, 39, 16, 15, 35, 27, 28	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	40, 17, 10, 1, 2, 3, 33, 31, 30, 38, 35, 37, 15, 27, 34, 39	recall 6, inference 0, analysis 3, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	40, 17, 6, 1, 2, 14, 12, 26, 13, 37, 35, 27, 38, 16, 28, 15	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 7

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)," how does Sophocles show responsibility, mercy and the end? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In Exodos (lines 1233–1544), how does Sophocles develop the idea of responsibility, mercy and the end? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Exodos (lines 1233–1544) develops the idea of responsibility, mercy and the end. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Exodos (lines 1233–1544) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of responsibility, mercy and the end. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Exodos (lines 1233–1544) suggests about responsibility, mercy and the end. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses characterization in Exodos (lines 1233–1544) to complicate the reader's understanding of responsibility, mercy and the end. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Situate Exodos (lines 1233–1544) within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of responsibility, mercy and the end responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Read Exodos (lines 1233–1544) alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of responsibility, mercy and the end follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Exodos (lines 1233–1544) and its treatment of responsibility, mercy and the end. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop a research argument that reads Exodos (lines 1233–1544) as evidence for a larger claim about responsibility, mercy and the end in Oedipus Rex. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop an original argument that reads Exodos (lines 1233–1544) as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of responsibility, mercy and the end. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Oedipus Rex.

SAT-style questions

1. *Most grave and reverend senators of Thebes, What deeds ye soon must hear, what sights behold! How will ye mourn, if, true-born patriots, Ye reverence still the race of Labdacus! Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light, Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly. The worst to bear are self-inflicted wounds.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)"?

   A. The herdsman and the recognition

   B. A city praying for rescue

   C. Responsibility, mercy and the end

D. Pride breeds the tyrant

SAT key: 1. C (Responsibility, mercy and the end)

Unit test

Oedipus Rex: unit test · 90 minutes · 50 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Up, children, haste ye, quit these altar stairs, Take hence your suppliant wands, go summon hither The Theban commons.”, what does “suppliant” most nearly mean?
   A. a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar
   B. knowledge of something before it happens
   C. mockery; scornful laughter
   D. foretelling the future

   Key: A (a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why is "who seeks shall find" ironic?
   A. Oedipus will find that he himself is the man he seeks
   B. The Priest already knows the killer
   C. The god refuses to answer
   D. Creon is lying about the oracle

   Key: A (Oedipus will find that he himself is the man he seeks)
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Prologue (lines 1–155), Priest: “Nor _____ nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and guards to guard them fail”
   Key: battlements
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Which lacking (for too late Was I enrolled a citizen of Thebes) This proclamation I address to all:— Thebans, if any knows the man by whom Laius, son of Labdacus, was slain, I summon him to make clean shrift to me.”, what does “proclamation” most nearly mean?
   A. the spread of disease
   B. mixed together
   C. an official public announcement
   D. a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar

   Key: C (an official public announcement)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why does Teiresias at first refuse to speak?

   A. He is afraid of the Chorus

   B. Knowing the truth brings only pain

   C. Creon paid him to stay silent

   D. He does not know the answer

   Key: B (Knowing the truth brings only pain)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Oedipus wish on the unknown killer?

   A. A quick pardon

   B. A fair trial

   C. A reward for confessing

   D. A life of utter wretchedness and exile

   Key: D (A life of utter wretchedness and exile)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias: "Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own _____; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of this land"

   Key: proclamation

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Thou art the man, Thou the accursed polluter of this land.", what does "polluter" most nearly mean?

   A. one who makes something unclean; here, a person whose crime brings religious defilement on a city

   B. mixed together

   C. overfed; having too much of something

   D. a guess made without proof

   Key: A (one who makes something unclean; here, a person whose crime brings religious defilement on a city)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does Oedipus accuse of plotting with Teiresias?

   A. Polybus

   B. The Priest

   C. Creon

   D. The Chorus

   Key: C (Creon)

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus: "And for myself, if with my privity / He gain _____ to my hearth, I pray / The curse I laid on others fall on me"

    Key: admittance

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Must I endure this fellow's insolence?", what does "insolence" most nearly mean?

    A. a guess made without proof

    B. rude, arrogant disrespect; Storr's word for Greek hybris

    C. overfed; having too much of something

    D. tested to measure quality, as gold is tested

    Key: B (rude, arrogant disrespect; Storr's word for Greek hybris)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Or how without sign assured, can I blame Him who saved our State when the wingèd songstress came, Tested and tried in the light of us all, like gold assayed?", what does "assayed" most nearly mean?

    A. a guess made without proof

    B. a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar

    C. (archaic adjective) foolish; carried away by passion

    D. tested to measure quality, as gold is tested

    Key: D (tested to measure quality, as gold is tested)

13. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Listen and I'll convince thee that no man Hath scot or lot in the _____ art." Word bank: prophetic, infatuate

    Key: prophetic

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Creon: "I am not so _____ as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast"

    Key: infatuate

15. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which word in the ode names excessive pride?

    A. Riches

    B. Insolence

    C. Throne

    D. Height

    Key: B (Insolence)

16. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus: "Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the _____ height and grasps the throne"

    Key: precipitous

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the elders fear if the oracles prove false?

    A. That the Sphinx will return

    B. That Creon will become king

    C. That Corinth will attack

    D. That reverence for the gods will fail

    Key: D (That reverence for the gods will fail)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Be of good cheer; though I be proved the son Of a _____, aye, through three descents Triply a slave, thy honor is unsmirched." Word bank: bondwoman, foreknowledge

    Key: bondwoman

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, With no assured _____, be afraid?" Word bank: foreknowledge, bondwoman

    Key: foreknowledge

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus: "Dance and song shall hymn thy _____, lover of our royal race"

    Key: praises

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What kind of reference is the mention of gods like Pan and Hermes?

    A. A simile

    B. A pun

    C. A stage direction

    D. An allusion to myth

    Key: D (An allusion to myth)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus: "Child, who bare thee, nymph or _____? sure thy sure was more than man, / Haply the hill-roamer Pan"

    Key: goddess

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "I stand a wretch, in birth, in wedlock cursed, A parricide, incestuously, triply cursed.", what does "parricide" most nearly mean?

    A. the killing of one's father, or the person who does it

    B. rude, arrogant disrespect; Storr's word for Greek hybris

    C. a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar

    D. foretelling the future

    Key: A (the killing of one's father, or the person who does it)

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus: "All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire _____ in one bed"

    Key: commingled

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Not in _____, Oedipus, I come Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds." Word bank: derision

    Key: derision

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Second Messenger: "Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light, / Ills wrought of malice, not _____"

    Key: unwittingly

27. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1–3. The evidence is "My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus).

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Parodos (lines 156–213)"?

    A. A city praying for rescue

    B. Responsibility, mercy and the end

    C. A hopeful guess

    D. The hunted man

    Key: A (A city praying for rescue)

29. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air— / Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers and litanies” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Chorus, lines 184–187. The evidence is “Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air— / Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers and litanies” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus).

30. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Sweet-voiced daughter of Zeus from thy gold-paved Pythian shrine / Wafted to Thebes divine” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus)

A. Chorus, in this part of the section.

B. Second Messenger, lines 1237–1240.

C. The play's motto: moral values inverted.

D. His philosophy of revenge.

Key: A (Chorus, in this part of the section.)

31. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King’s good name, / How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame” (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Chorus, lines 503–504. The evidence is “Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King’s good name, / How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame” (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus).

32. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Creon) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Creon, lines 596–597. The evidence is “I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Creon). This develops knowledge and blindness: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear.

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)”?

A. Pride breeds the tyrant

B. Good news that is not good

C. A city praying for rescue

D. The herdsman and the recognition

Key: A (Pride breeds the tyrant)

34. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Who when such deeds are done / Can hope heaven’s bolts to shun” (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Chorus, lines 907–908. The evidence is “Who when such deeds are done / Can hope heaven’s bolts to shun” (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: pride breeds the tyrant.

35. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow’s full moon rises, and exalt thee as is meet” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1103–1106. The evidence is “If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus…” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus).

36. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)"?

    A. A city praying for rescue

    B. Responsibility, mercy and the end

    C. Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear

    D. Pride breeds the tyrant

    Key: B (Responsibility, mercy and the end)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "In this land, said the god; 'who seeks shall find; / Who sits with folded hands or sleeps is blind" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Creon). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Creon, lines 116–117. The evidence is "In this land, said the god; 'who seeks shall find; / Who sits with folded hands or sleeps is blind" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Creon). This develops knowledge and blindness: a king who promises to find the truth. The words "folded" and "sleeps" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead link this play to Antigone, where burial is the central conflict. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found" (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus).

    Sample answer: The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athena, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away. The evidence is "Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found" (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 180–183. This develops knowledge and blindness: a city praying for rescue.

39. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The curse and the prophet.

    A. Leadership and the city

    B. Fate and responsibility

    C. Pride and fall

    D. Knowledge and blindness

    Key: D (Knowledge and blindness)

40. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)"? Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon…

    A. Imagery

    B. Structure

    C. Irony

    D. Metaphor

    Key: C (Irony)

41. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "Who is he by voice immortal named from Pythia's rocky cell, / Doer of foul deeds of bloodshed, horrors that no tongue can tell"

(Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Chorus, in this part of the section. The evidence is "Who is he by voice immortal named from Pythia's rocky cell, / Doer of foul deeds of bloodshed, horrors that no tongue can tell" (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: the hunted man. The words "bloodshed" and "immortal" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

42. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "As for the child, it was but three days old, / When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned / Together, gave it to be cast away / By others on the trackless mountain side" (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Jocasta, lines 726–729. The evidence is "As for the child, it was but three days old, / When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned / Together, gave it to be cast away / By others on…" (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta). This develops knowledge and blindness: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. The words "trackless" and "mountain" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

43. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Pride breeds the tyrant.

A. Knowledge and blindness

B. Leadership and the city

C. Mercy

D. Fate and responsibility

Key: A (Knowledge and blindness)

44. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "My lot be still to lead / The life of innocence and fly" (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Chorus, in this part of the section. The evidence is "My lot be still to lead / The life of innocence and fly" (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: pride breeds the tyrant. The words "innocence" and "still" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

45. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "Of bliss, hath but the show; / A moment, and the visions pale and fade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Chorus, in this part of the section. The evidence is "Of bliss, hath but the show; / A moment, and the visions pale and fade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: the shadow of a shade. The words "visions" and "moment" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

46. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how knowledge and blindness develops from the opening of "Prologue (lines 1–155)" to its ending. Use one quotation from each part.

Sample answer: Near the start, "My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1–3. Later, "Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 138–139. A king who promises to find the truth.

47. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and guards to guard them fail" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Priest) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Priest, lines 62–63. The evidence is "Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and guards to

guard them fail" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Priest). This develops knowledge and blindness: a king who promises to find the truth. The words "battlements" and "galleys" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together.

48. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how knowledge and blindness develops from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102) to Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114). Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus, the text reads "But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus" — Oedipus, lines 985–986. In Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), "If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus…" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1103–1106. A hopeful guess.

49. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Does this ode make the ending more painful or more bearable? Defend your view.
Sample answer: A defended position: Chorus, in this part of the section. The evidence is "Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure thy sure was more than man, / Haply the hill-roamer Pan" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: a hopeful guess. The Chorus joyfully guesses that Oedipus was born on Mount Cithaeron, perhaps the child of a god such as Pan, Apollo, Hermes or Bacchus and a mountain nymph.

50. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how knowledge and blindness develops from Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232) to Exodos (lines 1233–1544). Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus, the text reads "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade" — Chorus, lines 1201–1203. In Exodos (lines 1233–1544), "Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to…" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Second Messenger) — Second Messenger, lines 1237–1240. Responsibility, mercy and the end.

51. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why do the people trust Oedipus to help?

A. He once freed the city from the Sphinx

B. He is a priest of Apollo

C. He is a famous general

D. He is Creon's son

Key: A (He once freed the city from the Sphinx)

52. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "As I _____, 'tis welcome; else his head Had scarce been crowned with berry-laden bays." Word bank: suppliant, surmise
Key: surmise

53. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Thou art the man, Thou the accursed _____ of this land." Word bank: proclamation, polluter, insolence
Key: polluter

54. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is ironic about the argument over blindness?

A. No one mentions sight

B. The blind prophet sees the truth while Oedipus, who can see, does not

C. Oedipus is already blind

D. Teiresias pretends to be blind

Key: B (The blind prophet sees the truth while Oedipus, who can see, does not)

55. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "I am not so _____ as to grasp The shadow when I hold the substance fast." Word bank: infatuate, prophetic

    Key: infatuate

56. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus: "Who when such deeds are done / Can hope _____'s bolts to shun"

    Key: heaven

57. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] According to the Chorus, what breeds the tyrant?

    A. Insolence (pride)

    B. Poverty

    C. Plague

    D. Prophecy

    Key: A (Insolence (pride))

58. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is the tone of this ode?

    A. Indifferent

    B. Solemn and anxious

    C. Triumphant

    D. Comic

    Key: B (Solemn and anxious)

59. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus: "My lot be still to lead / The life of _____ and fly"

    Key: innocence

60. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Jocasta: "Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, / With no assured _____, be afraid? / Best live a careless life from hand to mouth"

    Key: foreknowledge

61. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why is the ode ironic?

    A. Cithaeron does not exist

    B. They already know the truth

    C. The truth about Cithaeron is the opposite of what they hope

    D. They are mocking Oedipus

    Key: C (The truth about Cithaeron is the opposite of what they hope)

62. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Oedipus: "Ah me! ah me! all brought to pass, all true! / O light, may I behold thee nevermore! / I stand a wretch, in birth, in wedlock cursed, / A parricide, _____, triply cursed"

    Key: incestuously

63. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Oedipus make him speak?

    A. He orders him threatened

    B. He pays him

    C. He asks Teiresias

    D. He pardons him first

Key: A (He orders him threatened)

64. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Creon: “Not in _____, Oedipus, I come / Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds”

Key: derision

65. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus: “Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That _____ these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other”

Key: brought

66. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)”?

A. The hunted man

B. Pride breeds the tyrant

C. Good news that is not good

D. The shadow of a shade

Key: A (The hunted man)

67. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o’er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice divine, / From Earth’s mid shrine” (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 490–497. The evidence is “Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o’er…” (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus).

68. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1107. The evidence is “Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: a hopeful guess.

69. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the ode come right before the Herdsman scene?

Sample answer: To heighten the fall by raising hope first. The evidence is “If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus…” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1103–1106.

70. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? A king who promises to find the truth.

A. Knowledge and blindness

B. Fate and responsibility

C. Leadership and the city

D. Pride and fall

Key: A (Knowledge and blindness)

71. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic "false dawn." Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow’s full moon rises, and exalt thee as is meet” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus).

Sample answer: The Chorus joyfully guesses that Oedipus was born on Mount Cithaeron, perhaps the child of a god such as Pan, Apollo, Hermes or Bacchus and a mountain nymph. The evidence is “If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus…” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1103–1106. This develops knowledge and blindness: a hopeful guess.

72. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure thy sure was more than man, / Haply the hill-roamer Pan” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Chorus, in this part of the section. The evidence is “Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure thy sure was more than man, / Haply the hill-roamer Pan” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: a hopeful guess. The words “goddess” and “roamer” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

73. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)”? The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from…

    A. Diction / vocabulary

    B. Hyperbole

    C. Plot

    D. Personification

    Key: C (Plot)

74. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus).

    Sample answer: The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out. The evidence is “Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1201–1203. This develops knowledge and blindness: the shadow of a shade.

75. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Oedipus a good king in the Prologue? Take a position using two quoted lines.

    Sample answer: A defended position citing evidence such as lines 1–3 and 138–139. The evidence is “My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1–3. This develops knowledge and blindness: a king who promises to find the truth. Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together.

76. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1–3. The evidence is “My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus). This develops knowledge and blindness: a king who promises to find the truth. The words “suppliants” and “children” carry that meaning: they are the

charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together.

77. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus) supports it: Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together. But “Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and guards to guard them fail” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Priest) complicates it: the line (Priest, lines 62–63) shows the same issue from another side, and its “Nor” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. So the claim stands only in a qualified form: true of the scene's main pattern, but not of every moment in it.

78. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Not Ister nor all Phasis’ flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light, / Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly” (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Second Messenger) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Second Messenger, lines 1237–1240. The evidence is “Not Ister nor all Phasis’ flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to…” (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Second Messenger). This develops knowledge and blindness: responsibility, mercy and the end. The words “unwittingly” and “wrought” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over.

79. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is destroying Thebes at the start of the play?

    A. A famine caused by war

    B. A foreign army

    C. A flood

    D. A plague

    Key: D (A plague)

80. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Up, children, haste ye, quit these altar stairs, Take hence your _____ wands, go summon hither The Theban commons.”

    Word bank: surmise, suppliant

    Key: suppliant

81. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where has Creon been?

    A. In Corinth

    B. At the Sphinx's rock

    C. On Mount Cithaeron

D. At the oracle of Apollo at Delphi

Key: D (At the oracle of Apollo at Delphi)

82. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] To what animal do the Chorus compare the killer?

A. A snake

B. A lion

C. A bull

D. An eagle

Key: C (A bull)

83. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Or how without sign assured, can I blame Him who saved our State when the wingèd songstress came, Tested and tried in the light of us all, like gold _____?” Word bank: assayed

Key: assayed

84. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why does Jocasta beg Oedipus to stop searching?

A. She has realized the truth

B. She wants to go to Corinth

C. She is angry at Creon

D. She thinks the messenger is lying

Key: A (She has realized the truth)

85. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Jocasta say about chance in lines 991–993?

Sample answer: A mortal is the sport of chance and should live carelessly, without fear.

86. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why does Oedipus still fear going to Corinth?

A. He fears the plague there

B. He fears the Corinthian army

C. He fears the prophecy about his mother

D. He fears Creon will follow

Key: C (He fears the prophecy about his mother)

87. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What place does the Chorus celebrate?

A. Delphi

B. Corinth

C. Mount Cithaeron

D. Athens

Key: C (Mount Cithaeron)

88. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus: “If my soul _____ err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow’s full moon rises, and exalt thee as is meet”

Key: prophetic

89. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What will the Chorus do to Cithaeron "ere tomorrow's full moon"?

Sample answer: Hail and exalt it as Oedipus' nurse and foster-mother.

90. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the elders guess about Oedipus' birth?

    A. He is Creon's son

    B. He may be the child of a god

    C. He is a slave's son

    D. He was born in Corinth

    Key: B (He may be the child of a god)

91. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus: "Races of _____ man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade"

    Key: mortal

92. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Oedipus ask Creon to do?

    A. Send him into exile and care for his daughters

    B. Make him king again

    C. Kill the herdsman

    D. Destroy the oracle

    Key: A (Send him into exile and care for his daughters)

93. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Creon say in lines 1427–1428?

    Sample answer: He has not come to mock or blame Oedipus.

94. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Creon treat Oedipus?

    A. Without mocking or blaming him

    B. By ignoring him

    C. With insults

    D. By imprisoning him

    Key: A (Without mocking or blaming him)

95. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does the audience learn of the events in the palace?

    A. A letter is read

    B. A messenger reports them

    C. They are acted on stage

    D. Teiresias predicts them

    Key: B (A messenger reports them)

96. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is the Chorus's final warning?

    A. Pride is always rewarded

    B. Always obey the king

    C. Never trust a prophet

    D. Count no one happy until life is over

    Key: D (Count no one happy until life is over)

97. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 246–248. The evidence is "And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus).

98. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why are the elders torn?
Sample answer: They respect the prophet but also owe Oedipus loyalty for saving the city. The evidence is "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er…" (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 490–497.

99. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "I stand upon the perilous edge of speech" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Herdsman, lines 1179. The evidence is "I stand upon the perilous edge of speech" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman). This develops knowledge and blindness: the herdsman and the recognition.

100. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which literary element does this describe in "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)"? The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof.
A. Metaphor
B. Structure
C. Personification
D. Theme

Key: D (Theme)

101. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The hunted man.
A. Knowledge and blindness
B. Fate and responsibility
C. Pride and fall
D. Leadership and the city

Key: A (Knowledge and blindness)

102. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Good news that is not good.
A. Knowledge and blindness
B. Fate and responsibility
C. Pride and fall
D. Leadership and the city

Key: A (Knowledge and blindness)

103. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "And I of hearing, but I still must hear" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Oedipus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1180. The evidence is "And I of hearing, but I still must hear" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Oedipus). This develops knowledge and blindness: the herdsman and the recognition. The words "hearing" and "still" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

104. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which literary element does this describe in "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)"? A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama…
A. Point of view

B. Setting

C. Theme

D. Foreshadowing

Key: C (Theme)

105. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how knowledge and blindness develops from Prologue (lines 1–155) to Parodos (lines 156–213). Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus, the text reads “My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool” — Oedipus, lines 1–3. In Parodos (lines 156–213), “Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 180–183. A city praying for rescue.

106. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air— / Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers and litanies” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 184–187. The evidence is “Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air— / Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers and litanies” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: a city praying for rescue. The words “piercing” and “grandams” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athena, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away.

107. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 180–183. The evidence is “Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: a city praying for rescue. The words “infection” and “perisheth” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athena, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away.

108. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus” (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 985–986. The evidence is “But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus” (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus). This develops knowledge and blindness: good news that is not good. The words “oracles” and “nothing” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and leaves. Oedipus thinks she is ashamed of his low birth and calls himself the child of Fortune.

109. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Oedipus guilty? Write a literary argument using lines 1418–1420 and one earlier scene.

Sample answer: A defended position; no item asks how anyone died or was hurt. The evidence is “Apollo, friend, Apollo, he

it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1343–1346. This develops knowledge and blindness: responsibility, mercy and the end. A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over.

110. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: "Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. "Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus) supports it: A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over. But "Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light, / Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly." (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Second Messenger) complicates it: the line (Second Messenger, lines 1237–1240) shows the same issue from another side, and its "Not" marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. The claim is therefore a strong reading, not a complete one, and a careful answer says where it stops applying.

111. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the god say Thebes must do?

A. Banish or punish the killer of Laius

B. Crown Creon king

C. Sacrifice to Athena

D. Rebuild its walls

Key: A (Banish or punish the killer of Laius)

112. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] In the line "As I surmise, 'tis welcome; else his head Had scarce been crowned with berry-laden bays.", what does "surmise" most nearly mean?

A. knowledge of something before it happens

B. a guess made without proof

C. rude, arrogant disrespect; Storr's word for Greek hybris

D. the killing of one's father, or the person who does it

Key: B (a guess made without proof)

113. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from Prologue (lines 1–155), Creon: "In this land, said the god; 'who seeks shall find; / Who sits with _____ hands or sleeps is blind"
Key: folded

114. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Who is pursuing the killer in the ode?

A. Teiresias

B. The army of Corinth

C. The voice of Apollo (Phoebus)

D. Creon's guards

Key: C (The voice of Apollo (Phoebus))

115. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Whom does Oedipus call his mother in lines 1099–1102?

A. Fortune (Chance)

B. Jocasta

C. Merope

D. The Sphinx

Key: A (Fortune (Chance))

116. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus: "But, as they stand, the _____ are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus"

Key: oracles

117. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus: "Of bliss, hath but the show; / A moment, and the _____ pale and fade"

Key: visions

118. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Who must bear the load of guilt, Oedipus says in lines 1418–1420?

A. The Chorus

B. He himself, and no one else

C. Laius

D. Creon

Key: B (He himself, and no one else)

119. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? "Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and guards to guard them fail" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Priest) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Priest, lines 62–63. The evidence is "Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and guards to guard them fail" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Priest). This develops knowledge and blindness: a king who promises to find the truth.

120. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? "But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 985–986. The evidence is "But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus). This develops knowledge and blindness: good news that is not good.

121. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)"?

A. A king who promises to find the truth

B. The shadow of a shade

C. The herdsman and the recognition

D. Good news that is not good

Key: B (The shadow of a shade)

122. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "I was, a thrall, not

purchased but home-bred" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman).

Sample answer: The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from Laius' house and that the queen gave it to him to destroy because of a prophecy; he pitied it and gave it away. Oedipus recognizes the whole truth. The evidence is "I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman) — Herdsman, lines 1131. This develops knowledge and blindness: the herdsman and the recognition.

123. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus: "My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as _____, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool"

Key: suppliants

124. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Oedipus promise in lines 138–139?

Sample answer: To start afresh and "make dark things clear."

125. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus: "Well, I will start _____ and once again / Make dark things clear"

Key: afresh

126. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What is a stasimon?

A. A choral ode between episodes

B. The prologue

C. A soliloquy

D. A messenger speech

Key: A (A choral ode between episodes)

127. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Where did the messenger receive the infant Oedipus?

A. On Mount Cithaeron, from a herdsman of Laius

B. At Delphi

C. In the palace at Corinth

D. At the crossroads

Key: A (On Mount Cithaeron, from a herdsman of Laius)

128. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What is the tone of the ode?

A. Comic

B. Mournful

C. Hopeful

D. Neutral

Key: B (Mournful)

129. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Who is the Chorus's example?

A. Oedipus

B. Laius

C. Creon

D. Teiresias

Key: A (Oedipus)

130. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus: "Come _____, deign to touch an abject wretch; / Draw near and fear not; I myself must bear / The load of guilt that none but I can share"

    Key: hither

131. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] In the line "Not in derision, Oedipus, I come Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds.", what does "derision" most nearly mean?

    A. mockery; scornful laughter

    B. foretelling the future

    C. the spread of disease

    D. the killing of one's father, or the person who does it

    Key: A (mockery; scornful laughter)

132. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? "Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1343–1346. The evidence is "Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus).

133. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in "Prologue (lines 1–155)"? Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus…

    A. Characterization

    B. Hyperbole

    C. Theme

    D. Diction / vocabulary

    Key: A (Characterization)

134. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which literary element does this describe in "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)"? The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing.

    A. Foreshadowing

    B. Theme

    C. Imagery

    D. Characterization

    Key: B (Theme)

135. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Which literary element does this describe in "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)"? A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger…

    A. Allusion

    B. Symbolism

    C. Structure

    D. Irony

Key: D (Irony)

136. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “She is my mother and the changing moons / My brethren, and with them I wax and wane. / Thus sprung why should I fear to trace my birth? / Nothing can make me other than I am” (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus).

Sample answer: A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and leaves. Oedipus thinks she is ashamed of his low birth and calls himself the child of Fortune. The evidence is “She is my mother and the changing moons / My brethren, and with them I wax and wane. / Thus sprung why should I fear to trace my birth? /…” (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1099–1102. This develops knowledge and blindness: good news that is not good.

137. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The herdsman and the recognition.

A. Fate and responsibility

B. Leadership and the city

C. Knowledge and blindness

D. Pride and fall

Key: C (Knowledge and blindness)

138. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “Come hither, deign to touch an abject wretch; / Draw near and fear not; I myself must bear / The load of guilt that none but I can share” (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1418–1420. The evidence is “Come hither, deign to touch an abject wretch; / Draw near and fear not; I myself must bear / The load of guilt that none but I can share” (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus). This develops knowledge and blindness: responsibility, mercy and the end. The words “myself” and “hither” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

139. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o’er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice divine, / From Earth’s mid shrine.” (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus) supports it: The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof. But “Who is he by voice immortal named from Pythia’s rocky cell, / Doer of foul deeds of bloodshed, horrors that no tongue can tell” (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus) complicates it: Chorus, in this part of the section, and its “no” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. Weighing the two passages, the claim survives, but only once it admits the tension the second passage creates.

140. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “She is my mother and the changing moons / My brethren, and with them I

wax and wane. / Thus sprung why should I fear to trace my birth? / Nothing can make me other than I am." (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus) supports it: A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and leaves. Oedipus thinks she is ashamed of his low birth and calls himself the child of Fortune. But "But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus) complicates it: the line (Oedipus, lines 985–986) shows the same issue from another side, and its "But" marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. A fair verdict is that the claim is mostly right but overstated; it needs a limiting clause to cover that passage.

141. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow's full moon rises, and exalt thee as is meet" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1103–1106. The evidence is "If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus…" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: a hopeful guess. The words "prophetic" and "tomorrow" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The Chorus joyfully guesses that Oedipus was born on Mount Cithaeron, perhaps the child of a god such as Pan, Apollo, Hermes or Bacchus and a mountain nymph.

142. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Prologue (lines 1–155)"?

    A. A hopeful guess

    B. Good news that is not good

    C. A king who promises to find the truth

    D. Pride breeds the tyrant

    Key: C (A king who promises to find the truth)

143. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)"?

    A. Responsibility, mercy and the end

    B. Pride breeds the tyrant

    C. The curse and the prophet

    D. A king who promises to find the truth

    Key: C (The curse and the prophet)

144. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus misread Jocasta's distress?

    Sample answer: He thinks she fears he is of low or enslaved birth. The evidence is "She is my mother and the changing moons / My brethren, and with them I wax and wane. / Thus sprung why should I fear to trace my birth? /…" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1099–1102.

145. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? "Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure thy sure was more than man, / Haply the hill-roamer Pan" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus)

    A. The lines describe a sea voyage to Troy.

    B. Second Messenger, lines 1237–1240.

    C. Chorus, in this part of the section.

D. The first line: a play of questions.

Key: C (Chorus, in this part of the section.)

146. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus insist "I still must hear"?
Sample answer: He is committed to the truth even if it destroys him. The evidence is “And I of hearing, but I still must hear” (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1180.

147. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred” (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Herdsman, lines 1131. The evidence is “I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred” (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman). This develops knowledge and blindness: the herdsman and the recognition.

148. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire commingled in one bed” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1225–1227. The evidence is “All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire commingled in one bed” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus).

149. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why do the elders call Time "all-seeing"?
Sample answer: Time reveals what people hide: Chorus, lines 1225–1227. The evidence is “All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire commingled in one bed” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus).

150. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool”

A. Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)

B. Parodos (lines 156–213)

C. Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)

D. Prologue (lines 1–155)

Key: D (Prologue (lines 1–155))

151. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness”

A. Exodos (lines 1233–1544)

B. Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)

C. Episode 1 (lines 214–479)

D. Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)

Key: C (Episode 1 (lines 214–479))

152. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of this land” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias).
Sample answer: Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne. The evidence is “Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own

proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the…" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias) — Teiresias, lines 359–362. This develops knowledge and blindness: the curse and the prophet.

153. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne" (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus).
Sample answer: The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing. The evidence is "Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the…" (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 890–893. This develops knowledge and blindness: pride breeds the tyrant.

154. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in "Be of good cheer; though I be proved the son / Of a bondwoman, aye, through three descents / Triply a slave, thy honor is unsmirched" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1078–1080. The evidence is "Be of good cheer; though I be proved the son / Of a bondwoman, aye, through three descents / Triply a slave, thy honor is unsmirched" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus). This develops knowledge and blindness: good news that is not good. The words "unsmirched" and "bondwoman" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

155. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The shadow of a shade.
A. Pride and fall
B. Leadership and the city
C. Knowledge and blindness
D. Fate and responsibility
Key: C (Knowledge and blindness)

156. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? "Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light, / Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly"
A. Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)
B. Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)
C. Exodos (lines 1233–1544)
D. Episode 2 (lines 512–880)
Key: C (Exodos (lines 1233–1544))

157. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus).
Sample answer: A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over. The evidence is "Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to

pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1343–1346. This develops knowledge and blindness: responsibility, mercy and the end.

158. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: "The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. "Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of this land." (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias) supports it: Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne. But "Thus then I answer: since thou hast not spared / To twit me with my blindness—thou hast eyes, / Yet see'st not in what misery thou art fallen, / Nor where thou dwellest nor with whom for mate." (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias) complicates it: the line (Teiresias, lines 424–427) shows the same issue from another side, and its "not" marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. The claim is therefore a strong reading, not a complete one, and a careful answer says where it stops applying.

159. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how knowledge and blindness develops from Episode 1 (lines 214–479) to Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511). Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus, the text reads "And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness" — Oedipus, lines 246–248. In Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er…" (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 490–497. The hunted man.

160. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice divine, / From Earth's mid shrine" (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Chorus, lines 490–497. The evidence is "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er…" (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: the hunted man. The words "avenging" and "forest" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof.

161. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how knowledge and blindness develops from Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921) to Episode 3 (lines 922–1102). Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus, the text reads "Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the…" — Chorus, lines 890–893. In Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), "But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 985–986. Good news that is not good.

162. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, / With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid? / Best live a careless life from hand to mouth" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Jocasta) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Jocasta, lines 991–993. The evidence is "Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, / With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid? / Best live a careless life from hand to mouth" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Jocasta). This develops

knowledge and blindness: good news that is not good. The words “foreknowledge” and “careless” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and leaves. Oedipus thinks she is ashamed of his low birth and calls himself the child of Fortune.

163. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1107. The evidence is “Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: a hopeful guess. The words “praises” and “lover” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The Chorus joyfully guesses that Oedipus was born on Mount Cithaeron, perhaps the child of a god such as Pan, Apollo, Hermes or Bacchus and a mountain nymph.

164. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I stand upon the perilous edge of speech” (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Herdsman, lines 1179. The evidence is “I stand upon the perilous edge of speech” (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman). This develops knowledge and blindness: the herdsman and the recognition. The words “perilous” and “speech” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from Laius' house and that the queen gave it to him to destroy because of a prophecy; he pitied it and gave it away. Oedipus recognizes the whole truth.

165. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how knowledge and blindness develops from Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200) to Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232). Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman, the text reads “I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred” — Herdsman, lines 1131. In Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), “Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1201–1203. The shadow of a shade.

166. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Is this ode the play's view of life? Compare it with the ending.

Sample answer: A defended position: Chorus, lines 1201–1203. The evidence is “Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: the shadow of a shade. The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out.

167. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What can you infer from this line? “And for myself, if with my privity / He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray / The curse I laid on others fall on me” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 249–251. The evidence is “And for myself, if with my privity / He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray / The curse I laid on others fall on me” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus).

168. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? “My lot be still to lead / The life of innocence and fly” (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus)

A. His philosophy of revenge.

B. His new compassion for ordinary people.

C. Chorus, in this part of the section.

D. Second Messenger, lines 1237–1240.

Key: C (Chorus, in this part of the section.)

169. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What can you infer from this line? "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1201–1203. The evidence is "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus).

170. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? "Of bliss, hath but the show; / A moment, and the visions pale and fade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus)

A. Second Messenger, lines 1237–1240.

B. The cost of falseness.

C. Chorus, in this part of the section.

D. The question that drives the whole play, repeated for emphasis.

Key: C (Chorus, in this part of the section.)

171. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What can you infer from this line? "Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light, / Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Second Messenger) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Second Messenger, lines 1237–1240. The evidence is "Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to…" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Second Messenger).

172. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear.

A. Fate and responsibility

B. Leadership and the city

C. Pride and fall

D. Knowledge and blindness

Key: D (Knowledge and blindness)

173. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? A hopeful guess.

A. Leadership and the city

B. Pride and fall

C. Fate and responsibility

D. Knowledge and blindness

Key: D (Knowledge and blindness)

174. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Is Oedipus' anger a flaw or a reasonable response to an insult? Argue with lines 424–427 and 455.

Sample answer: A defended position on character: Oedipus, lines 249–251. The evidence is "And for myself, if with my

privity / He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray / The curse I laid on others fall on me" (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus). This develops knowledge and blindness: the curse and the prophet. Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne.

175. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Are the Chorus wise or naive to wait for proof? Defend your view.

Sample answer: A defended position: Chorus, lines 490–497. The evidence is "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er…" (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: the hunted man. The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof.

176. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Is Jocasta right that it is better not to know? Argue with evidence from this episode.

Sample answer: A defended position: Jocasta, lines 991–993. The evidence is "Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, / With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid? / Best live a careless life from hand to mouth" (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Jocasta). This develops knowledge and blindness: good news that is not good. A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and leaves. Oedipus thinks she is ashamed of his low birth and calls himself the child of Fortune.

177. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1343–1346. The evidence is "Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus). This develops knowledge and blindness: responsibility, mercy and the end. The words "brought" and "friend" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over.

178. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Why does the Priest say walls and ships are useless without men (lines 62–63)?

Sample answer: A city is its people; Oedipus must act as a leader, not rely on defences. The evidence is "My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool" (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1–3.

179. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does Oedipus' farewell to his daughters (1518–1521) show about him now?

Sample answer: Care and humility; he wishes them a happier life than his. The evidence is "To you, my children I had much to say, / Were ye but ripe to hear. Let this suffice: / Pray ye may find some home and live content, / And…" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1518–1521.

180. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “Not Ister nor all Phasis’ flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light, / Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly” (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Second Messenger)

A. Chorus, in this part of the section.

B. Second Messenger, lines 1237–1240.

C. The dream shrinks when reached.

D. The opening question: a world of storm and repetition.

Key: B (Second Messenger, lines 1237–1240.)

181. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Claim: The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o’er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice divine, / From Earth’s mid shrine” (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus).

Sample answer: The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof. The evidence is “Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o’er…” (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 490–497. This develops knowledge and blindness: the hunted man.

182. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Claim: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “As for the child, it was but three days old, / When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned / Together, gave it to be cast away / By others on the trackless mountain side” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta).

Sample answer: Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth after an oracle that he would kill his father and marry his mother, and of killing an old man and his servants at a crossroads. One hope remains: the surviving witness said "robbers.". The evidence is “As for the child, it was but three days old, / When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned / Together, gave it to be cast away / By others on…” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta) — Jocasta, lines 726–729. This develops knowledge and blindness: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear.

183. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred”

A. Parodos (lines 156–213)

B. Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)

C. Episode 1 (lines 214–479)

D. Exodos (lines 1233–1544)

Key: B (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200))

184. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Responsibility, mercy and the end. Name the theme and explain in two or three sentences, quoting the text.

Sample answer: Knowledge and blindness. Responsibility, mercy and the end. The evidence is “Not Ister nor all Phasis’

flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to…" (Exodos (lines 1233–1544), Second Messenger) — Second Messenger, lines 1237–1240. This develops knowledge and blindness: responsibility, mercy and the end.

185. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King's good name, / How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame" (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 503–504. The evidence is "Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King's good name, / How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame" (Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: the hunted man. The words "untracked" and "challenge" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof.

186. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast" (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Creon) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Creon, lines 596–597. The evidence is "I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast" (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Creon). This develops knowledge and blindness: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. The words "infatuate" and "substance" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth after an oracle that he would kill his father and marry his mother, and of killing an old man and his servants at a crossroads. One hope remains: the surviving witness said "robbers.".

187. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Synthesis: trace how knowledge and blindness develops from Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511) to Episode 2 (lines 512–880). Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511), Chorus, the text reads "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er…" — Chorus, lines 490–497. In Episode 2 (lines 512–880), "I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast" (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Creon) — Creon, lines 596–597. Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear.

188. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Evaluate this claim about the scene: "The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. "Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne" (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus) supports it: The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing. But "My lot be still to lead / The life of innocence and fly" (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus) complicates it: Chorus, in this part of the section, and its "still" marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. The claim is therefore a strong reading, not a complete one, and a careful answer says where it stops applying.

189. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Does the play show Oedipus as guilty of hubris? Use this ode and one other scene.

Sample answer: A defended position: Chorus, in this part of the section. The evidence is "My lot be still to lead / The life of innocence and fly" (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: pride breeds the tyrant.

The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing.

190. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Why does Oedipus turn on Creon instead of considering the prophecy?

Sample answer: Anger and fear for his power make him look for a plot. The evidence is “And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 246–248.

191. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Does the Chorus mean Oedipus by "the tyrant"? Explain.

Sample answer: Possibly a warning to him, though not named; open to argument. The evidence is “Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the…” (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 890–893.

192. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] What can you infer from this line? “Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, / With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid? / Best live a careless life from hand to mouth” (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Jocasta) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Jocasta, lines 991–993. The evidence is “Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, / With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid? / Best live a careless life from hand to mouth” (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102), Jocasta).

193. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 246–248. The evidence is “And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus). This develops knowledge and blindness: the curse and the prophet. The words “wretchedness” and “murderer” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne.

194. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Listen and I’ll convince thee that no man / Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Jocasta, lines 715–716. The evidence is “Listen and I’ll convince thee that no man / Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Jocasta). This develops knowledge and blindness: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. The words “prophetic” and “convince” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth after an oracle that he would kill his father and marry his mother, and of killing an old man and his servants at a crossroads. One hope remains: the surviving witness said "robbers.".

195. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne” (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 890–893. The evidence is "Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the…" (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: pride breeds the tyrant. The words "precipitous" and "insolence" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing.

196. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Herdsman, lines 1131. The evidence is "I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred" (Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200), Herdsman). This develops knowledge and blindness: the herdsman and the recognition. The words "purchased" and "thrall" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from Laius' house and that the queen gave it to him to destroy because of a prophecy; he pitied it and gave it away. Oedipus recognizes the whole truth.

197. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire commingled in one bed" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1225–1227. The evidence is "All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire commingled in one bed" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: the shadow of a shade. The words "commingled" and "brought" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out.

198. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1201–1203. The evidence is "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: the shadow of a shade. The words "shadow" and "mortal" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out.

199. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in "Parodos (lines 156–213)"? The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athena, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away.

A. Imagery

B. Plot

C. Characterization

D. Alliteration

Key: A (Imagery)

200. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? "I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast"

A. Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)

B. Episode 2 (lines 512–880)

C. Episode 1 (lines 214–479)

D. Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)

Key: B (Episode 2 (lines 512–880))

201. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus”

A. Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)

B. Prologue (lines 1–155)

C. Parodos (lines 156–213)

D. Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)

Key: A (Episode 3 (lines 922–1102))

202. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)”? The Chorus joyfully guesses that Oedipus was born on Mount Cithaeron, perhaps the child of a god such as Pan, Apollo, Hermes or Bacchus and a mountain nymph.

A. Point of view

B. Tone / mood

C. Structure

D. Theme

Key: B (Tone / mood)

203. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “And for myself, if with my privity / He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray / The curse I laid on others fall on me” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 249–251. The evidence is “And for myself, if with my privity / He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray / The curse I laid on others fall on me” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Oedipus). This develops knowledge and blindness: the curse and the prophet. The words “admittance” and “privity” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne.

204. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Who when such deeds are done / Can hope heaven’s bolts to shun” (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 907–908. The evidence is “Who when such deeds are done / Can hope heaven’s bolts to shun” (Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921), Chorus). This develops knowledge and blindness: pride breeds the tyrant. The words “heaven” and “bolts” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing.

205. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] What can you infer from this line? “Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 180–183. The evidence is “Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found” (Parodos (lines 156–213), Chorus).

206. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Why does Jocasta's comfort backfire?

Sample answer: Her details match Oedipus' own memory of the crossroads. The evidence is “Yet was I quits with him and more; one stroke / Of my good staff sufficed to fling him clean / Out of the chariot seat and laid him prone….” (Episode 2 (lines 512–880), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 827–830.

207. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Which choice best states a central concern of “Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)”?

A. The shadow of a shade

B. A king who promises to find the truth

C. Responsibility, mercy and the end

D. The herdsman and the recognition

Key: D (The herdsman and the recognition)

208. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Analyze the word choice in “Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of this land” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Teiresias, lines 359–362. The evidence is “Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the…” (Episode 1 (lines 214–479), Teiresias). This develops knowledge and blindness: the curse and the prophet. The words “proclamation” and “polluter” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

209. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)”? The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out.

A. Imagery

B. Allusion

C. Irony

D. Characterization

Key: A (Imagery)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30, 31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40, 41, 42, 43, 44, 45, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50	recall 26, inference 10, analysis 9, synthesis 5
HS Freshman	51, 52, 3, 53, 9, 54, 11, 7, 12, 13, 55, 56, 57, 58, 16, 59, 18, 60, 58, 61, 23, 62, 63, 24, 64, 65, 28, 30, 66, 31, 67, 68, 69, 36, 70, 37, 41, 43, 71, 72, 73, 74, 45, 75, 46, 76, 47, 77, 49, 78	recall 26, inference 8, analysis 9, synthesis 7
HS Sophomore	52, 79, 80, 51, 81, 82, 83, 19, 84, 85, 86, 87, 88, 20, 89, 61, 90, 91, 26, 92, 65, 93, 94, 95, 25, 96, 28, 30, 97, 98, 99, 70, 100, 101, 102, 72, 71, 73, 103, 104, 76, 46, 47, 105, 106, 107, 108, 48, 109, 110	recall 26, inference 5, analysis 9, synthesis 10
HS Junior	81, 80, 52, 111, 112, 113, 3, 114, 115, 18, 116, 85, 21, 61, 90, 89, 20, 117, 64, 26, 93, 95, 92, 65, 118, 119, 30, 28, 120, 121, 70, 41, 42, 44, 102, 72, 71, 73, 122, 103, 74, 104, 75, 76, 77, 46, 48, 49, 50, 109	recall 25, inference 5, analysis 12, synthesis 8

HS Senior	113, 51, 123, 124, 2, 80, 125, 81, 126, 84, 127, 88, 20, 90, 61, 87, 89, 128, 129, 94, 96, 25, 95, 130, 131, 30, 28, 36, 132, 133, 38, 101, 41, 134, 43, 135, 136, 72, 122, 137, 138, 75, 47, 139, 140, 141, 48, 110, 78, 50	recall 25, inference 4, analysis 12, synthesis 9
AP	113, 81, 124, 21, 87, 61, 25, 96, 92, 119, 142, 143, 31, 33, 120, 144, 145, 146, 147, 148, 149, 70, 150, 151, 152, 41, 101, 42, 43, 153, 154, 74, 155, 156, 138, 157, 104, 75, 158, 159, 160, 139, 161, 162, 163, 141, 164, 165, 166, 50	recall 9, inference 12, analysis 16, synthesis 13
College Freshman	3, 124, 112, 89, 21, 61, 64, 96, 94, 119, 28, 167, 31, 168, 144, 69, 68, 147, 169, 170, 171, 37, 133, 40, 152, 41, 172, 42, 134, 43, 136, 154, 72, 173, 137, 104, 76, 174, 159, 175, 160, 176, 108, 162, 49, 141, 166, 177, 50, 110	recall 9, inference 12, analysis 15, synthesis 14
College Sophomore	3, 1, 21, 58, 118, 25, 27, 119, 178, 98, 144, 69, 68, 145, 149, 179, 132, 180, 37, 133, 70, 181, 100, 41, 182, 153, 43, 154, 71, 103, 183, 45, 104, 184, 77, 106, 158, 175, 159, 185, 186, 187, 188, 189, 140, 161, 108, 162, 49, 110	recall 6, inference 12, analysis 16, synthesis 16
College Junior	80, 21, 131, 92, 27, 178, 28, 190, 167, 98, 191, 168, 192, 144, 69, 68, 99, 146, 149, 36, 132, 179, 37, 152, 41, 101, 182, 134, 135, 72, 45, 138, 46, 47, 107, 193, 185, 160, 175, 186, 194, 195, 108, 161, 141, 196, 197, 198, 78, 50	recall 4, inference 18, analysis 10, synthesis 18
College Senior	123, 93, 142, 178, 30, 190, 98, 191, 168, 144, 192, 69, 68, 146, 149, 148, 170, 180, 179, 37, 199, 151, 152, 181, 41, 172, 182, 200, 154, 201, 202, 73, 74, 184, 104, 138, 157, 47, 106, 203, 158, 175, 185, 204, 195, 140, 176, 141, 196, 110	recall 2, inference 17, analysis 18, synthesis 13
Graduate / PhD	26, 178, 142, 30, 205, 28, 190, 167, 98, 31, 206, 191, 168, 144, 120, 69, 145, 146, 207, 170, 149, 179, 36, 37, 208, 41, 200, 182, 43, 154, 102, 173, 71, 209, 76, 47, 106, 193, 160, 139, 194, 204, 195, 162, 163, 164, 196, 198, 197, 177	recall 1, inference 22, analysis 11, synthesis 16

Final paper

Oedipus Rex: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how Sophocles develops knowledge and blindness across Oedipus Rex. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in Oedipus Rex and argue how its meaning changes over the play and why that change matters to fate and responsibility.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in Oedipus Rex. Argue whether the play judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether Oedipus Rex finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of pride and fall. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Scaffolded support 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 6 quotations from at least three sections, from the beginning, middle and end. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the act, scene and line (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.	Specific, arguable and precise; it organizes every section.	Clear and arguable, but broad in places.	States a topic or a summary more than an argument.	Missing, or restates the prompt.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.	Accurate, well-chosen quotations from across the work, all cited; meets the requirement.	Accurate and cited, but clustered in one part of the work.	Too few quotations, or some inaccurate or uncited.	Little or no quoted evidence.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.	Explains how specific words, structure and devices create meaning; weighs a competing reading.	Explains the evidence, with some close reading.	Mostly summary; the link to the claim is asserted, not shown.	Summary only.
Organization	15					

		Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.	Each paragraph advances the argument; transitions show logic.	Logical order with minor jumps.	Order is loose; paragraphs repeat or drift.	No discernible structure.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.	Formal, precise, present tense; MLA format; virtually error-free.	Formal with a few errors that do not obscure meaning.	Informal or error-prone in ways that distract.	Errors obscure meaning.

Exemplar paragraph: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. The text makes this visible when it says “Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear” (Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus). Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together. A full paper would carry this reading through the beginning, middle and end, and answer the strongest competing reading.

Essay assignments

Essay: Knowledge and blindness

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Oedipus Rex teaches about knowledge and blindness. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Sophocles develops knowledge and blindness in Oedipus Rex. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops knowledge and blindness across Oedipus Rex. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Oedipus Rex (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of knowledge and blindness. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of knowledge and blindness in Oedipus Rex. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Oedipus Rex (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of knowledge and blindness, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Oedipus Rex's treatment of knowledge and blindness in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on knowledge and blindness in Oedipus Rex that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on knowledge and blindness in Oedipus Rex. Name your critical method, apply it

closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about knowledge and blindness in Oedipus Rex, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on knowledge and blindness in Oedipus Rex, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Fate and responsibility

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Oedipus Rex teaches about fate and responsibility. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Sophocles develops fate and responsibility in Oedipus Rex. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops fate and responsibility across Oedipus Rex. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Oedipus Rex (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of fate and responsibility. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of fate and responsibility in Oedipus Rex. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Oedipus Rex (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of fate and responsibility, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a researched

essay (4–6 pages) that places Oedipus Rex's treatment of fate and responsibility in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on fate and responsibility in Oedipus Rex that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on fate and responsibility in Oedipus Rex. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about fate and responsibility in Oedipus Rex, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on fate and responsibility in Oedipus Rex, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Pride and fall

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Oedipus Rex teaches about pride and fall. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Sophocles develops pride and fall in Oedipus Rex. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops pride and fall across Oedipus Rex. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Oedipus Rex (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of pride and fall. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of pride and fall in Oedipus Rex. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Oedipus Rex (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of pride and fall, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Oedipus Rex's treatment of pride and fall in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on pride and fall in Oedipus Rex that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on pride and fall in Oedipus Rex. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about pride and fall in Oedipus Rex, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on pride and fall in Oedipus Rex, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Leadership and the city

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Oedipus Rex teaches about leadership and the city. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Sophocles develops leadership and the city in Oedipus Rex. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops leadership and the city across Oedipus Rex. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Oedipus Rex (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of leadership and the city. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of leadership and the city in Oedipus Rex. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Oedipus Rex (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of leadership and the city, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Oedipus Rex's treatment of leadership and the city in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on leadership and the city in Oedipus Rex that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on leadership and the city in Oedipus Rex. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about leadership and the city in Oedipus Rex, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on leadership and the city in Oedipus Rex, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Mercy

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Oedipus Rex teaches about mercy. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Sophocles develops mercy in Oedipus Rex. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops mercy across Oedipus Rex. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Oedipus Rex (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of mercy. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of mercy in Oedipus Rex. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Oedipus Rex (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of mercy, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Oedipus Rex's treatment of mercy in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on mercy in Oedipus Rex that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on mercy in Oedipus Rex. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a research paper

(12–15 pages) with an original argument about mercy in Oedipus Rex, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on mercy in Oedipus Rex, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

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